FRIDAY
October 9, 2026

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BIG REASONS TO BUY

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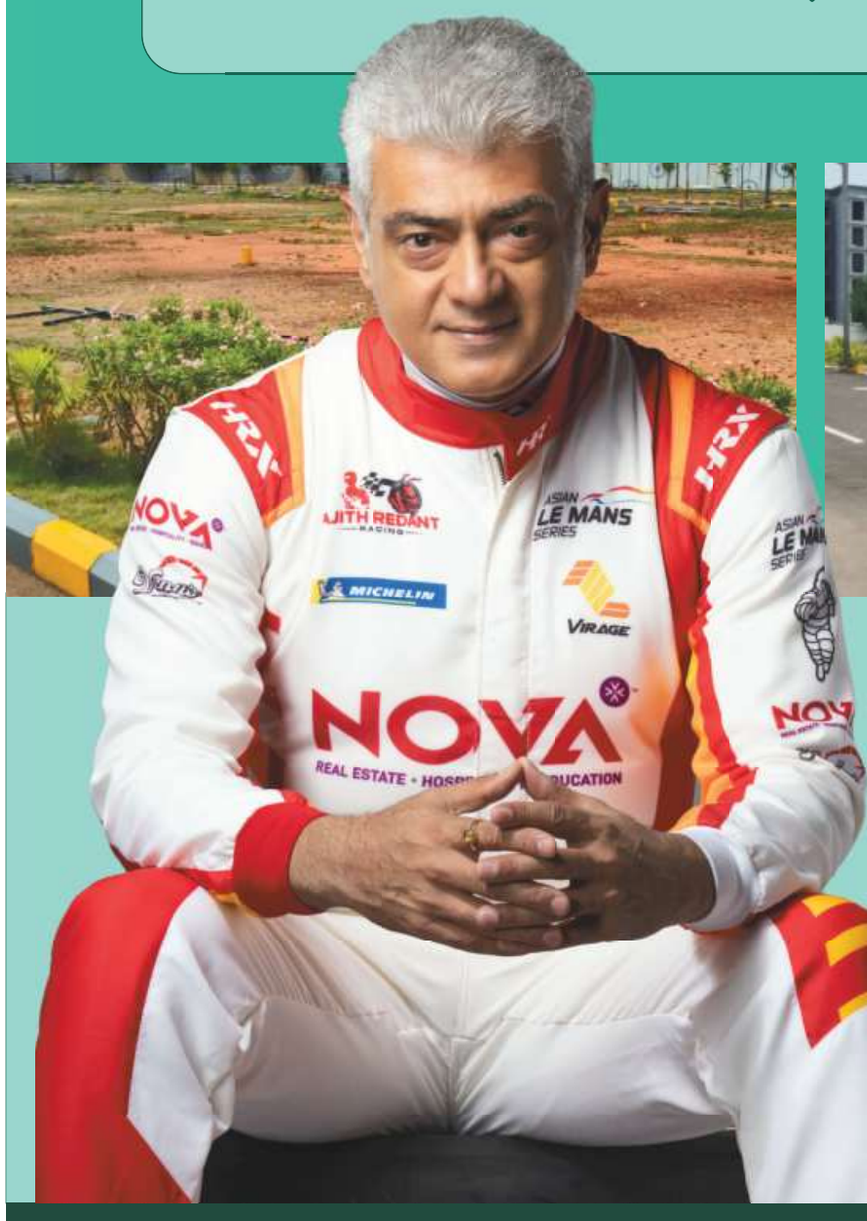

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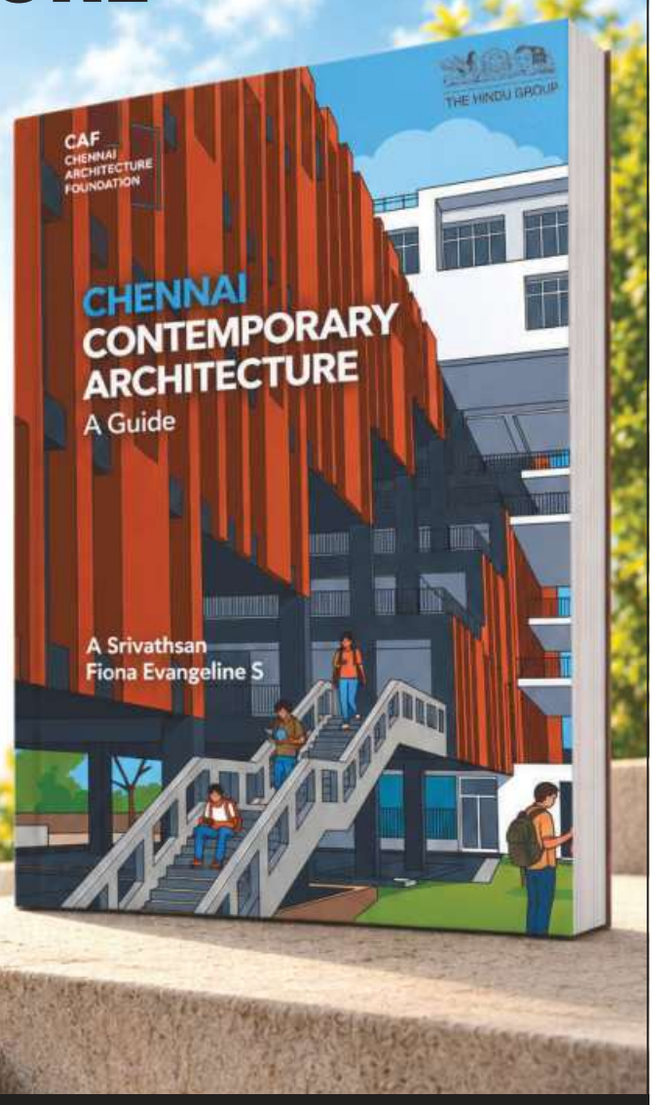

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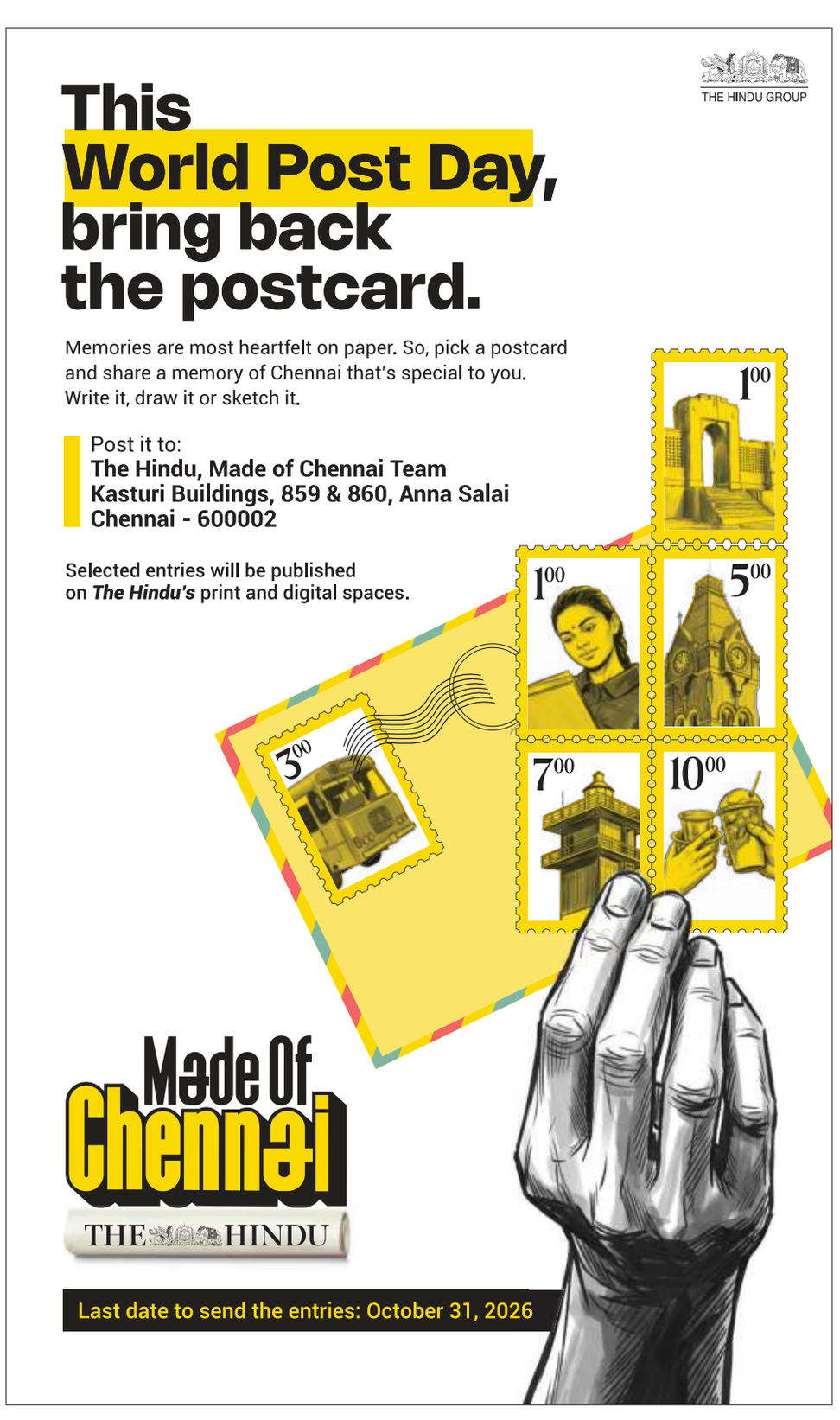
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DOMESTIC PUSH

U.S. freezes green card scheme for big IT firms

WORLD PAGE

TEMPESTUOUS CAREER

Nana Patekar, the rebel of Indian cinema, dies

NEWS » PAGE 12

GENRE-BLENDING OEUVRE

Literature Nobel for Canada's Anne Carson

WORLD PAGE

PARLEY

Rule of law against social customs

Are legal guarantees insufficient in ending untouchability?

OPINION » PAGE 9

SECOND T20I

Team India hopes to make it 2-0 at Ranchi

SPORT » PAGE 13

NEARBY

Vijay produces land sale deed before court

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has produced before the Madras High Court a sale deed to prove that he had purchased land in Kodaikanal in 1997, as declared in his election affidavit. » PAGE 6

Hindi board taken down in Thanjavur

THANJAVUR
Railway authorities removed a name board in Hindi atop the second entrance to the Thanjavur Railway Junction on Thursday, after opposition from various organisations. » PAGE 6

FRIDAY REVIEW » 4 PAGES

GST refund norms eased; officers lose arrest powers

99% of GST rate and process issues addressed, says Union Finance Minister after 57th meeting of the GST Council; measures likely to come into effect from April 1, 2027; rates remain unchanged

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council on Thursday took a slew of decisions in its 57th meeting here to enhance simplification, improve certainty in tax treatment, remove holdups in the processing of input tax credits, and ease the compliance burden on businesses, especially smaller ones.

The council also recommended removing arrest powers of GST officers and increasing the prosecution threshold from ₹1 crore to ₹5 crore.

The general penalty will also be reduced from ₹25,000 to ₹10,000.

"I can say that 99% of issues in GST relating to rates and processes have now been addressed," Nirmala Sitharaman, Union Finance Minister and Chairperson of the GST Council, said following the meeting.

"The door is not closed to further reforms, and those will be taken up as needed, but the bulk of them are now done," she added.

Apart from easing processes related to GST registration and availing of refunds and input tax credits, the council has also eased the litigation-related rules of the tax system, providing relief to small taxpayers. Ms. Sitharaman said that all the changes are expected to come into effect from April 1, 2027, and added that no GST rates were changed during this meeting.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Good and simple

The 57th meeting of the GST council decided to enhance simplification, improve certainty in tax treatment, and ease the compliance burden on small businesses

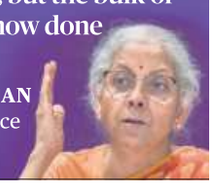
KEY DECISIONS

- Tax officers' power to arrest scrapped
- Prosecution limit increased to **₹5 crore** turnover
- Export of services brought into input tax credit system
- Automated registrations, reduced paperwork, and eased input tax credit processes
- No notices for amounts below **₹10,000**, pending notices to be cancelled

The committee has also decided to examine proposal to allow small taxpayers to file returns once a year

New measures likely to come into force from April 1, 2027

> I can say that 99% of issues in GST relating to rates and processes have now been addressed... The door is not closed to further reforms, and those will be taken up as needed, but the bulk of them are now done
>
> **NIRMALA SITHARAMAN**
> Union Finance Minister



Car falls into sinkhole near Tidel Park

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A car fell into a sinkhole that developed after a section of Rajiv Gandhi Salai caved in near Tidel Park on Thursday.

The incident occurred around 10.50 a.m. amid peak-hour traffic on the IT Corridor.

The SUV was proceeding from Adyar to Taramani when the road caved in, causing the car to land upside down in the pit.

The driver of the vehicle, Praveen, 27, and a 52-year-old woman managed to escape before the vehicle fell into the pit.

Traffic police personnel on duty and motorists rushed to their rescue.

The police cordoned off the stretch and diverted traffic. Chennai Metro Rail Limited has said that its tunnelling work may have caused the road to cave in.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 2

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge addresses media with party leaders and INDIA bloc MPs on Thursday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

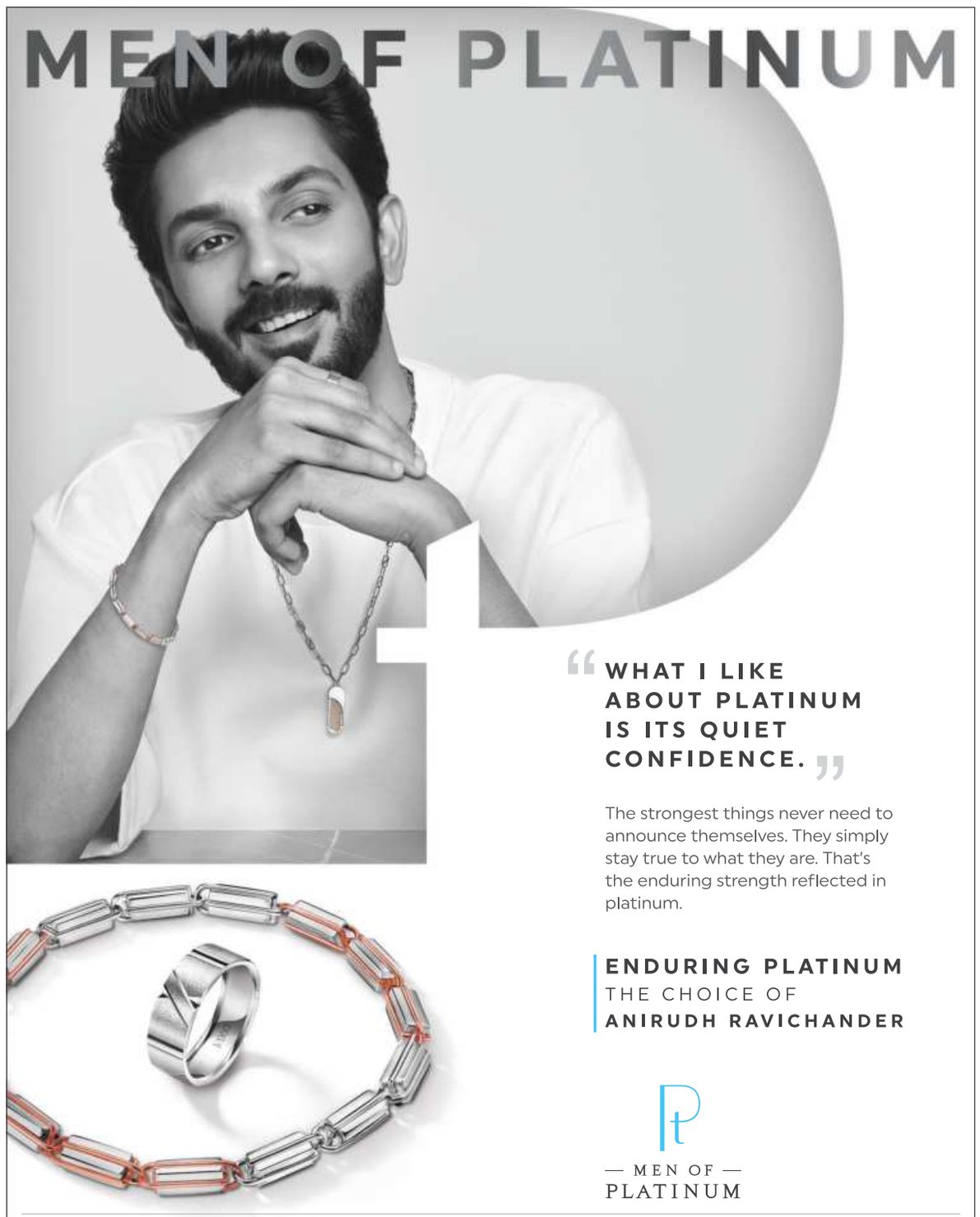
INDIA bloc protests at Rajghat against CEC

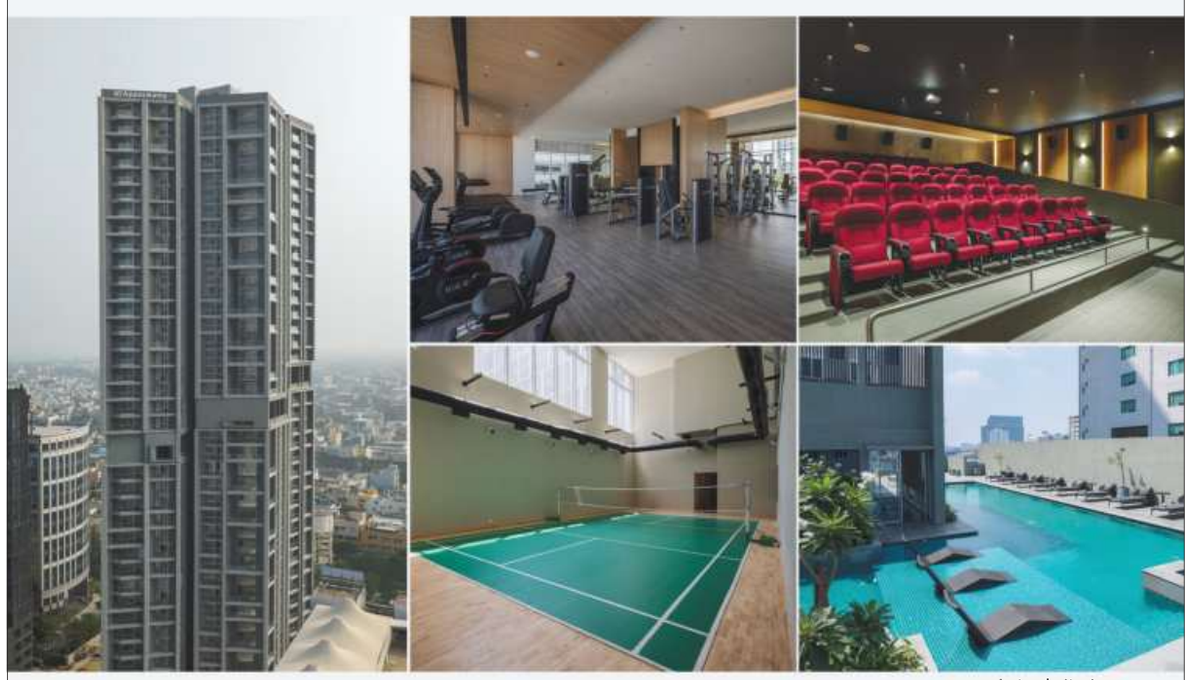
Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

For the third day in a row, leaders of the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) on Thursday protested in Delhi against alleged "vote *chori* (theft)" and demanded the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, staging a symbolic *satyagraha* at Mahatma Gandhi's memorial at Rajghat.

Following two days of face-offs with the police, Opposition leaders protested at Rajghat without the police preventing them from reaching there. They offered floral tributes at the memorial, with Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge saying they "prayed that the BJP government gets the wisdom to stop vote *chori*, remove the CEC, and protect the citizen's right to vote". The INDIA bloc said it will continue its protest on Friday.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10
CRPF TROOPS DEPLOYED
» PAGE 11





INBRIEF

Mass vision screening held in 13 government schools

To mark World Sight Day 2026, Sankara Nethralaya, the Elite School of Optometry, and The Sankara Nethralaya Academy, Chennai, conducted mass vision screening on Wednesday. It screened 6,348 children from 13 government schools in Chennai and Tiruvallur. A total of 622 children were identified with refractive errors, and 73 referred for further care. "Identifying ocular problems early is crucial for healthy living. It is the responsibility of every health care professional to ensure that eye care is integrated with school activities," said N. Anuradha, Principal of the Elite School of Optometry and The Sankara Nethralaya Academy in Chennai.

Chennai nephrologist given lifetime contribution award

Georgi Abraham, president and founder-trustee of TANKER Foundation, and former professor and adviser, Department of Nephrology, The Madras Medical Mission, was given the Dhanvantari Award for Lifetime Contribution at the Conference of the Peritoneal Dialysis Society of India, held in Patna on September 26, a press note said. The award recognises his outstanding contributions to nephrology, kidney care, medical education, and patient welfare. The occasion also marked the release of the book *Management of Peritoneal Dialysis & Related Challenges*, co-authored by Dr. Georgi Abraham, Narayan Prasad, Santosh Varughese, Arun Thomas E.T., and Priya Haridas Anupama, with a foreword by Dr. Ramesh Khanna.

Car falls into sinkhole after road caves in near Tidel Park

The two occupants managed to escape before the car fell into the pit on Rajiv Gandhi Salai. CMRL suspects tunnelling work from Thiruvanmiyur to Taramani for phase II network led to the cave-in

Narrow escape: The car was proceeding from Adyar to Taramani around 10.50 a.m. on Thursday, when it fell into a sinkhole. (Right) The vehicle being removed using a crane. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT, J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A car fell into a sinkhole that developed after a section of Rajiv Gandhi Salai caved in near Tidel Park on Thursday.

The incident occurred around 10.50 a.m. amid peak-hour traffic on the IT Corridor. The SUV was proceeding from Adyar to Taramani when the road caved in, causing the car to land upside down in the pit.

The driver of the vehicle, Praveen, 27, and a 52-year-old woman managed to escape before the vehicle fell into the pit, the police said.

Traffic police personnel on duty and motorists rushed to their rescue.

Mr. Praveen said, "We were proceeding slowly from Indira Nagar in Adyar towards the Tidel Park signal, when the front wheel of our car fell into what appeared to be a small pothole. The front portion of the vehicle then began to sink. Sensing danger, we immediately got out of the car. Passers-by also rushed to our rescue. Within moments, the small hole widened into a huge pit, and our vehicle fell into it. The pit was deep enough to swallow a big vehicle."

The police cordoned off the stretch and diverted traffic. Vehicular movement was affected on Rajiv Gandhi Salai and in adjoining areas.

Cement concrete was poured into the hole after the car was removed using a crane.

"After the hole is filled with concrete and it settles, a steel sheet will be laid on top and vehicles will be allowed to pass," an official said.

Sources in the Tamil Nadu Road Development Company said its engineers conducted a joint inspection with Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board officials and found no leak in the water main at the spot. Moreover, there was no drop in pressure, indicating that the cave-in was not caused by the water main, they said.

They added that the top layers of soil had been disturbed due to underground tunnelling activity by the Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL).

Meanwhile, the CMRL has said that its tunnelling work from Thiruvanmiyur to Taramani may have caused the road to cave in. The incident occurred around 30 metres from the Thiruvanmiyur shaft.

It said the sinkhole surfaced opposite the Elnet Building near the Bhavani Tunnel Boring Machine (TBM), which is currently tunnelling for Corridor 3 of the Phase II network.

Will investigate: CMRL

According to CMRL officials, a loss of face support pressure in the TBM could have resulted in the cave-in. "They should have been more careful while operating the machine. We suspect this to be the issue now. We will investigate further. The vehicle owner will be compensated for the damage caused by the incident," an official said.

In May 2025, a call taxi carrying five passengers fell into a similar pit that had developed on the same road after a cave-in.

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay felicitating medallist Vithya Ramraj at a function organised by SDAT in Chennai on Thursday. R. RAGU

Asian Games medal winners from State felicitated by Vijay

K. Keerthivasan
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay felicitated the State's Asian Games medallists and members of the Indian chess teams that won medals at the Samarkand Chess Olympiad on Thursday evening,

A total of ₹7.65 crore in enhanced incentives was announced for the State's Asian Games medal winners. The gold, silver, and bronze medallists received ₹75 lakh, ₹50 lakh and ₹30 lakh respectively, an increase from the earlier ₹50 lakh, ₹30 lakh, and ₹20 lakh respectively.

The men's team, which won silver, received ₹15 lakh each, while the women's team, which won bronze, received ₹10 lakh each. The awards were presented by Mr. Vijay and Minister for Public Works and Sports Development Aadhav Arjuna.

Mr. Aadhav highlighted the need to build more sporting venues, pointing out that many of the existing facilities were old. "The stadiums that were built during Jayalalithaa's time are very old. We need good infrastructure and rehabilitation centres. There is no centre for physically challenged sportspersons. Our priority is to build a sound ecosystem for sportspersons. With that in mind, we have increased the sports budget. There will be sports events for transgender athletes, and we plan to build sports hostels in all 38 districts," he said.

T.K. Vishal, who won silver in the mixed 4x400m relay and bronze in the men's 4x400m relay, said he was happy to hear that sports hostels would have air-conditioning. "It is a basic need. During my time at the sports hostels, I slept without AC. It affects our recovery," he said.

Baranica Elangovan, who won bronze in the women's pole vault at the Games, thanked the government for providing new pole vaults. "It is with those pole vaults that I won a medal," she said.

PROVISION OF DIGITAL 25W VHF SET

E-Tender Notice No. SNT-04-LMG-2026-27-RT Date: 05-10-2026. Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the President of India are invited for the works as detailed below:- **Tender No. SNT-04-LMG-2026-27-RT. Name of work:** Provision of digital 25W VHF set along with voice logging facility of VHF Radio Communication for Capacity Development on Railway safety in Lumding Division. **Tender Value:** ₹4,71,40,581.78/-. **Earnest Money:** ₹9,42,800/-. **Date & time of closing of tender:** At **15.00** hrs. **& opening at 15.30** hrs. on **27-10-2026.** The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

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S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

For and on behalf of President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager (Engg), Ranchi, South Eastern Railway invites e-tender for the following works: **Sl.No.** 1, **Notice No.** DRMENGGRNC-74-2026, **Name of Work:** P.Way (Track) linking work on Railway formation along with linking to existing line at Tangarbansali yard including supply of ballast at Tangarbansali of Ranchi division. **Tender Value (in ₹):** 6655193.49; **Tender Closing Date & Time:** 28.10.2026 at 15.00 hrs., **EMD Value (in ₹):** 133100.00; **Sl.No.** 2, **Notice No.** DRMENGGRNC-75-2026, **Name of Work:** Construction of Railway formation including blanketing material, side drain & other miscellaneous work for Construction of Full-Length Stabling lines by extending existing short-length track machine siding in Tangarbansali Station Yard (TGB) under jurisdiction of SR DEN SOUTH of Ranchi Division. **Tender Value (in ₹):** 26561358.48; **Tender Closing Date & Time:** 28.10.2026 at 15.00 hrs., **EMD Value (in ₹):** 531200.00; **Sl.No.** 3, **Notice No.** DRMENGGRNC-76-2026, **Name of Work:** Construction of boundary wall at Lohardaga, Piska & Argora to avoid encroachment under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN(South)/RNC. **Tender Value (in ₹):** 30044677.21; **Tender Closing Date & Time:** 29.10.2026 at 15.00 hrs., **EMD Value (in ₹):** 600900.00; **Sl.No.** 4, **Notice No.** DRMENGGRNC-77-2026, **Name of Work:** (i) Ranchi-TORI section: Strengthening of foundation and substructure of Br No 127(5x12.2 m PSC), Repairing of wing wall, bridge protection works & Construction of curtain wall and drop wall with other allied works between Lohardaga (LAD) and Barkichampi (BICI). (ii) Preparation of completion drawing of ongoing and completed bridge works (18 Bridges) under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN (South)/RNC. (2nd Call). **Tender Value (in ₹):** 16046808.85; **Tender Closing Date & Time:** 29.10.2026 at 15.00 hrs., **EMD Value (in ₹):** 320900.00; Tenderers can visit the website **www.ireps.gov.in** for online tendering. **(PR-874)**

CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

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Tom Mediaas / Bharat Kalachar
TODAY OCTOBER AALAPANAI 2026 @ YGP AUDITORIUM, T.NAGAR 5 PM: Students of Sri Sai Nrithyalaya, Aacharya Smt. H N Nandhini Suresh (B/N). 6 PM: Inaugural Function & Award Ceremony - TOM Nritya Tarangini: N. Sweta, Most Talented Dancer of the Year: Harshini R, TOM Nataka Nakshatra: Ganesh Mariyappan, TOM Sangeetha Nakshatra: Parur M K Ananthlakshmi, TOM Nritya Nakshatra: Kiruba Baalajee - Chief Guest: Shri T R Vasudevan. 7 PM: V. Aishwarya, Guru: Dr. Himaja Athul Kumar. 8 PM: Harikatha by Kum. Aadya Venkatesh Disciple of Smt. Vishaka Hari. All are Welcome.

MISCELLANEOUS

Sringeri Bharathi Vidyashram, T. Nagar. Ph: 24348964.
Navarathri Mahotsavam 2026 Commencing Tomorrow, 8.00 a.m Mahabhishekam for Moolavar Sri Saradamba,10.30 a.m Aradhanai of H.H.Jagadguru Sri Sri Candrashekara Bharati Mahaswamigal,Paduka Pooja, 12 Noon Mahadeeparadhanai, Pushpanjali, Mahaprasadam, 5.00 p.m Jagatprasutika Alankaram, 8.30 p.m MahaDeeparadhanai, Ashtavadhana Seva. All Are Welcome.

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Canal desilting stepped up as resumption of Krishna water supply gets delayed

The WRD carries out the desilting of the Kandaleru-Poondi canal and other minor channels linking major reservoirs ahead of the monsoon; the works are being done at a cost of ₹99 lakh

WATER WATCH

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

Improving capacity: Desilting of Kandaleru-Poondi Canal in progress. Krishna water supply to Chennai was stopped last month owing to poor storage in the reservoirs in Andhra Pradesh.

With the resumption of Krishna water supply to Chennai delayed, the Water Resources Department (WRD) has stepped up desilting and cleaning of the Kandaleru-Poondi canal and other minor channels linking major reservoirs, ahead of the Northeast monsoon.

The supply of Krishna water from the Kandaleru reservoir in Andhra Pradesh was halted last month due to inadequate storage in A.P. reservoirs. Poondi reservoir, which is the prime storage point of Krishna water, received nearly 2,250 million cubic feet of water, between July and September this year.

With the KP canal bed now almost dry, the WRD has taken up desilting at vulnerable portions of the 25-km long canal, which carries water from the entry point at Uthukottai in Tiruvallur district to Poondi reservoir. "We decided to make use of the halt in Krishna water flow to step up maintenance and monsoon preparedness works. This will improve free flow of water by a minimum of 10% in the canal," said an official.

The works, being carried out at a cost of ₹99 lakh, are part of the Northeast monsoon preparedness measures.

Officials said silt deposits and vegetation obstructing the water flow are being removed in vulnerable portions of the KP canal near Uthukottai. Portions of the canal bank that were eroded during heavy rainfall last year would also be strengthened.

Similarly, work is under way to clear vegetation from the 25 km-long Link canal, which connects the reservoirs in Poondi and Chembarambakkam. Desilting of the channel was done until earlier this week. However, further work has been stopped as water is now being released from Poondi reservoir to other water bodies in Chembarambakkam and Red Hills to boost their storage.

Work is also simultaneously implemented in two reaches of Feeder canal that carries water to Red Hills reservoir. "Nearly 70% of the work has been completed so far. We will continue clearing floating waste and vegetation from the channels until the end of the NE monsoon," said an official. The WRD has suspended improvement works on portions of the KP canal and Feeder canal owing to ensuing monsoon and plans to resume work in January.

Event held to support inclusive education

Apsara Foundation presenting a cheque to Born2Win at an awareness event in Chennai on Thursday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Apsara Foundation, in association with Apollo Hospitals, organised an awareness programme on inclusive education for children with mental health challenges and transgender individuals in Chennai on Thursday.

The event was led by journalist and social activist Apsara Reddy. Industrialist Deepa Dodla of Dodla Dairy Farms attended as chief guest, along with members of the Good Deeds Club.

The programme focused on creating educational and vocational opportunities for children with autism and Down syndrome, as well as members of the transgender community. Sumithra Prasad, founder of Dorai Foundation, Swetha Sudhakar, founder and director of Born2Win, along with members of the respective organisations also participated.

As part of the initiative, the Apsara Foundation contributed ₹50,000 to Born2Win towards transgender education and laptops, besides distributing Deepavali gifts to children. The Apsara Foundation also plans to donate an ambulance to the Dorai Foundation to support its efforts to reach and assist child survivors of sexual abuse.

Ms. Reddy said the initiative aimed to move beyond one-time assistance and create meaningful opportunities through education and skills training.

This is being done in addition to initiatives related to child rights, she said.

NFDC-NFAI acquires three films of actor Sivaji Ganesan

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The NFDC-National Film Archive of India (NFDC-NFAI), Pune, has received three 35 mm Tamil cinema classic films starring actor Sivaji Ganesan, all directed by A.P. Nagarajan.

Aparna Subramanian, Film Research Officer at the Film and Television Institute of India (FTII) has acquired the three classics.

The films are *Thiruvarutchelvar* (1967), *Thillana Mohanambal* (1968) and *Thiruvilayadal* (1965), and have been acquired in the national collection, according to a press release.

The acquisition of these films has helped in stocking a second surviving print for NFAI, giving greater flexibility in managing the preservation and use of these films.

Timings
CHENNAI

FRIDAY, OCT. 09
RISE 05:59 SET 17:54
RISE 04:37 SET 16:55

SATURDAY, OCT. 10
RISE 05:59 SET 17:54
RISE 05:28 SET 17:34

SUNDAY, OCT. 11
RISE 05:59 SET 17:53
RISE 06:19 SET 18:14

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	35	26
Chennai Airport	36	27
Chennai City	34	26

Chennai Airport Today
35°C The weather will be warm with uneasy afternoon. Night also will be uneasy. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershower to occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable.

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Man held for allowing minor son to ride motorcycle in Perambur

CHENNAI: The police have arrested a 38-year-old man for allowing his minor son to ride his motorcycle in Perambur.

On October 3, a minor was found riding a motorcycle in a dangerous manner near the Corporation Girls Higher Secondary School on Pallikoodam Street in Perambur, causing fear among members of the public. The Pulianthope Traffic Investigation Wing registered a case and began an investigation.

The police conducted an inquiry and found that the motorcycle's owner, Sankarkumar, 38, the minor's father, had knowingly allowed his son to ride the vehicle. The police arrested Sankarkumar and seized the motorcycle.

The police have advised parents and guardians not to encourage or facilitate minors below 18 years of age to drive motor vehicles. Legal action would be taken against parents or guardians who allow minors to drive such vehicles, police said.

THE HINDU
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ISSN 0971 - 751X

INBRIEF

Vascular surgeon honoured with award for excellence

Vascular surgeon N. Sekar was presented with the 'Dr. K.V. Thiruvengadam Award for Health Care Excellence' by the Rotary Club of Madras East, in association with Kauvery Hospital, on Tuesday. Dr. Sekar was recognised for his pioneering work in vascular surgery, his commitment to patient-centred care, and efforts to strengthen vascular services across the region, a release said. Health Secretary Darez Ahamed presented the award. The event was attended by Mayil Vahanan Natarajan, former vice-chancellor of Dr. M.G.R. Medical University; Aravindan Selvaraj, co-founder and executive director of Kauvery Hospital; and senior professionals.

Prelude event for Mindspace REIT Chennai Night Run held

The prelude event to the Mindspace REIT Chennai Night Run 2026 was held on Thursday, ahead of the event on October 17. The run is organsied by SportzPro, in association with the Tamil Nadu Athletic Association (TNAA), and supported by the Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu (SDAT), SIMS Hospital, and State Bank of India, with Mindspace Business Parks REIT headlining the event. The run will start at 7 p.m. from Island Grounds and will include 10K timed run and 4K family run. The fastest runners will be awarded cash prizes. C. Latha, Chairman - Planning & Execution Committee, TNAA; Ramesh Nair, MD and CEO, Mindspace REIT; Asian Games'26 bronze medallist Abinaya Rajarajan; Virugampakkam MLA Sabarinathan R.; Raju Sivaswamy, vice-president, SIMS Hospitals; Vivekanand Choubey, Chief General Manager, SBI, spoke. Registrations are open at www.chennainightrun.com

NGT directs Corporation to ensure uninterrupted processing of C&D waste

The order was passed in a suo motu case initiated based on *The Hindu*'s report in May 2024. The report identified 25 locations in Chennai where C&D waste was being repeatedly dumped

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Recurring problem: The NGT noted that illegal dumping of construction debris continued at public places, roadsides, and canals despite several measures by the Corporation. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

The southern bench of the National Green Tribunal (NGT) has directed the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) to ensure uninterrupted processing of construction and demolition (C&D) waste and make alternative arrangements whenever designated processing facilities shut down. The order dated October 7 was passed in a *suo motu* case initiated based on a *The Hindu* report published in May 2024, which identified 25 locations in Chennai where C&D waste was being repeatedly dumped.

The bench, comprising Justice Pushpa Sathyanarayana and expert member Prashant Gargava, observed that despite several measures by the civic body, illegal dumping of construction debris continued to recur at public places, roadsides, and canals.

The bench noted that the GCC's C&D waste processing facilities at Perungudi and Kodungaiyur had become non-operational in August and December 2024, respectively. This had resulted in the accumulation of collected waste at various locations. It said the civic body must ensure adequate alternative processing capacity so that the temporary closure of a facility does not disrupt the entire waste management system.

According to the GCC's latest report, between February 1 and August 15, 2026, it received 5,884 complaints regarding C&D waste, of which 5,411 had been resolved.

The Corporation identified C&D waste at 3,18,887 locations and removed waste from 3,18,727 locations, leaving 160 locations pending. Of the 1,99,220 tonnes identified for removal, 1,98,887 tonnes had been cleared, leaving 333 tonnes pending.

The GCC has deployed 42 enforcement vehicles and installed CCTV cameras at strategic locations to prevent unauthorised dumping. It also collected ₹1.28 crore in penalties between October 8, 2024, and October 20, 2025.

Long-term solution

The NGT, however, said the recurrence of dumping showed that merely clearing accumulated debris was not a lasting solution and directed the GCC to ensure effective operation of C&D waste processing facilities, put alternative arrangements in place during any disruption, and ensure strict compliance by builders, developers, and those undertaking construction or demolition.

It also directed the TNPCB to ensure that C&D waste collection, transportation, processing, and disposal across Tamil Nadu complied with applicable laws and guidelines.

Dengue cases in city stabilise as hotspots reduce from 590 to 300: Health Minister

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

K.G. Arunraj

Health Minister K.G. Arunraj on Thursday said dengue cases had stabilised in Chennai, and urged residents to destroy mosquito breeding sources on their premises ahead of the onset of Northeast monsoon.

"The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has collected a total of ₹7.5 lakh in fines from owners of buildings where mosquito breeding sources were found in the last two months. Large establishments have been penalised. The fine is ₹10,000 for the first violation and increases with each subsequent violation by the same person," he added.

A total of 21,655 dengue cases had been reported in T.N. from January 1 to October 7. Ten people have died due to dengue during the same period, he said

Medical camps

"On an average, we conduct 1,000 medical camps to screen fever cases across the State every day. A total of 21,655 dengue cases had been reported in the State from January 1 to October 7. Ten people have died due to dengue during the same period. In Chennai, dengue cases have gradually reduced and have stabilised. There is a possibility of another increase in dengue cases after this monsoon. So, we have to be cautious. We will appoint more workers for mosquito control," the Minister said.

Currently, 3,700 workers have been appointed for mosquito control in areas under the GCC. The workers must visit the homes every seven days.

Dengue hotspots in Chennai have decreased from 590 to 300. In Tamil Nadu, 301 dengue cases are being treated in hospitals. Answering questions about the alleged lack of transparency regarding the health condition of Kolathur MLA V.S. Babu, the Minister said the treatment protocol were reviewed by a team of doctors from the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital.

India has set a target of 100 GW of wind energy capacity by 2030, says Union Minister Pralhad Joshi

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Union Minister Pralhad Joshi and Minister for Energy Resources C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar inaugurating Windergy India 2026 on Thursday. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

The Green Energy Corridor Phase-III is set to be the biggest renewable energy project in the world, for which the Centre has allotted ₹54,000 crore, including ₹6,000 for battery energy storage system to prevent wastage of renewable power said Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy Pralhad Joshi at an event at the Chennai Trade Centre on Thursday.

Inaugurating Windergy India 2026 and trade fair, Mr. Joshi said the project would help various States tap renewable energy sources, including wind and solar, at the lowest cost of ₹5 per unit, against the fixed cost of ₹6 for fossil fuel-based power.

In view of the country ambitious target of generating 100 giga watt (GW) of installed wind capacity by 2030, the Indian Wind Turbine Manufacturers' Association (IWTMA) and PDA Ventures Private limited organised the conference on the theme 'Wind-Power India's Energy Resilience'.

Appreciating the IWTMA for the consistent growth shown in the capacity augmentation as well as generation of wind energy, the Union Minister said the country added 90 GW of renewable energy over the past two years, with wind energy contributing a major portion.

Even when the geo-political situation was not conducive to industrial growth, the country witnessed a strong industrial output due to steady growth in energy supply and wanted the State government to come out with a report to help repower the wind turbines of the State, he added.

Energy Resources Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar said the State, being a pioneer in commercial wind energy sector, wanted companies to come forward to set up more wind farms, for which corridors have been identified.

He said the wind turbines that were installed 20 years ago have aged and the State has found out that repowering these wind turbines alone could help in increasing the generation capacity to 6,000 to 7,000 mega watt (MW) within two years.

Citing the high demand for power in recent months, which has led to Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh purchasing power at high cost, Mr. Nirmal Kumar called for a national energy-demand forecasting system to help avoid such expensive purchases.

Mayank Tewari, Additional Secretary, Ministry of New and Renewable Energy, said the State should take steps for setting up offshore wind energy, citing a dearth of land to set up wind power plants. The Union government had identified Gujarat and Tamil Nadu for exploring offshore wind energy projects, he said.

Girish Tanti, Chairman of IWTMA and vice-chairman of Suzlon Group, said the annual installation of wind energy has been growing year on year, with the capacity cumulative addition by 2030 set to cross the target of 100 GW.

Vice-chairman of IWTMA Saravanan Manickam was also present on the occasion.

Constable among two arrested for migrant worker's death after assault

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 24-year-old migrant worker from Uttar Pradesh died after he was allegedly assaulted by two men at Salaiyanur near Sriperumbudur. S. Gnanamoorthy, 33, a traffic police constable, and A. Arif, 26, a grocery shop employee, were arrested on Thursday over the worker's death. Police said an argument broke out between Sailesh and Arif on Tuesday night over the unavailability of pan masala at the shop on the premises owned by the constable. On being alerted about the incident, Gnanamoorthy and Arif allegedly kicked Sailesh and asked him to vacate. Sailesh was found dead on the premises the next morning. Based on an autopsy report, the police concluded that Sailesh died of the injuries caused by the assault.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

A life well lived, a heart forever loved.

We invite you for a celebration of the life of

Dr. Anne Elizabeth Susie Samuel

(known to many as Dr. Susie Baboo / Susie Samuel)

for the wonderful selfless and God fearing life that she led.

Funeral Service at:
CMC Hospital Main Chapel
9th October 2026, 12 noon,
followed by burial at Barneshwaram, Katpadi

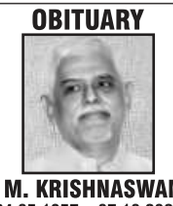
Survived by her family:
Dr. Narsappa Mathew Samuel
Dr. Rekha Samuel
Mr. Anish Mathew Samuel
Mr. Nitil Prasai
Mrs. Vidhubala Anish
Ashish Samuel
Rohan Samuel

DEATH

1930-2026
Shri. T. A. Ramasubramanian
Joint Commissioner of Customs & Central Excise (Retd), grandson of **Sir. T. N. Sivagnanam Pillai** and son of **Shri. T.S. Avudaiappa Pillai** (IAS), hailing from Tirunelveli and Chennai passed away peacefully at home in Chennai on **4-10-2026.** A deeply religious Saivite, principled public servant, affectionate father, brother and uncle, he is mourned deeply by his daughter, **Dr. Laxmi Ramasubramanian** and son-in-law, **Dr. Jochen Albrecht,** relatives, extended family, colleagues and friends. He will be remembered for his love of reading, his extensive knowledge of astrology, his quirky sense of humor, his ceaseless curiosity, and his positive and progressive outlook. Subhasweekaram will be on 16th October in Chennai.
Send messages to:
prof.laxmi@gmail.com

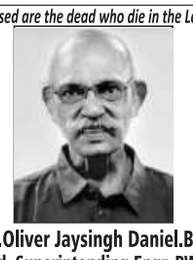
DEATH

OBITUARY



C. M. KRISHNASWAMY
24.05.1957 – 07.10.2026
With profound grief, we announce the passing of our beloved C. M. Krishnaswamy. A man full of life, love and laughter, he will forever remain in our hearts.
Cremation:
Friday, 9 October 2026, at 11:00 AM
Venue:
Besant Nagar Crematorium, Chennai.
Deeply mourned by family and friends.

"Blessed are the dead who die in the Lord"



Er.S.Oliver Jaysingh Daniel.B.E., Retd. Superintending Engr. PWD.
With profound sorrow, we remember our family friend Mr.Daniel, who passed away on 07.10.2026. The Funeral service will be held at CSI St.Thomas English Church,15, Santhome High Road, Chennai - 04. on Friday 09.10.2026 at 11.00 AM
T P Ganesan & Malarvizhi

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
To dedicate a space in this section, Please contact: **044-28576300** from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161 from 10.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.
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DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT

DEATH

In Loving memory of our beloved father
R. GOPALAKRISHNAN
Retd Chief Engineer CPWD An IITian
our living hero who taught us how to live
passed away peacefully on 07-10-2026
in his 87th year
With love Anand Gopal K Prasad & Jayanthi Prasad
CT 9841672014

DEATH

In loving memory of
Dr T R Muralidharan

Departed this life on October 8, 2026
We invite you to pay respects and celebrate the life of a loving doctor, husband, father, and friend.
Geetha Medical Center
6/3, Ayodhya Colony, Velachery, Chennai - 600042.
Viewing at the above address
Funeral around 2pm Today 9th Oct 2026
at Besant Nagar Crematorium
Kakan Nagar, Chennai - 90.

Metro Rail project a historic achievement of DMK govt.: Stalin

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Thursday said the Poonamallee-Porur-Vadapalani Metro Rail corridor would remain a "historic achievement" of the DMK government. Its inauguration is scheduled for October 11.

Recalling his visit to Japan as Deputy Chief Minister to secure funding from the Japan International Cooperation Agency for the project initiated by then Chief Minister M. Karunanidhi, Mr. Stalin said it had proved to be a panacea for traffic congestion in a rapidly growing Chennai and had become a milestone in the city's transport infrastructure.

He said the AIADMK government that succeeded the DMK (in 2001) initially favoured a monorail, but eventually proceeded with the Metro Rail project.

"When the 2015 floods cut off road connectivity in Chennai, lakhs of people were evacuated through Metro trains. It was then that everyone realised the importance of the Metro Rail project," he said.

He alleged that work on the phase II network faced delays during the AIADMK regime (2011-21) and that the DMK government expedited the work after returning to power in 2021.

"We implemented the project without any delay, even though the Centre did not release funds for three years. Whenever I met Prime Minister Narendra Modi, I pressed for the release of funds. Despite its poor financial position, the State government allocated ₹11,762 crore from its own resources. We also obtained ₹6,802 crore in loans from foreign financial institutions and continued the work," he said.

Mr. Stalin said the Centre finally accepted Tamil Nadu's demand in October 2024.

The DMK government had planned to inaugurate the phase II network by the end of 2025, but there was a delay in obtaining the Railway Board's permission for the signalling system, he said.

"As the election dates were announced, we could not go ahead with our plan to inaugurate the project. But I am happy and proud that the Metro project, the child nurtured by me, is now taking its first steps," he further said.

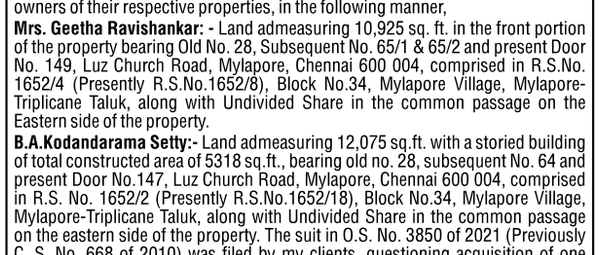
CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
E-TENDER NOTICE

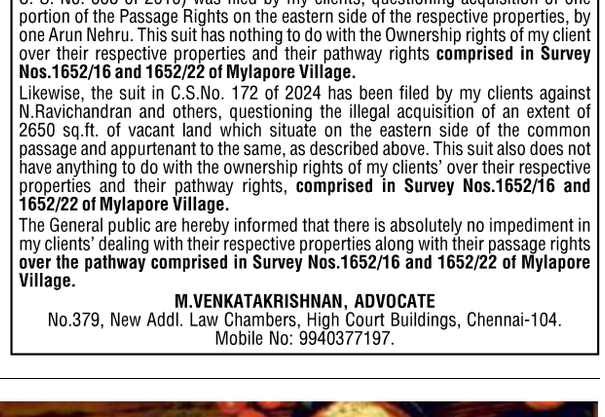
TENDER NOTICE NO.: CLW-DKAE-WC-570-E70CAB-26. E-tenders are invited for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work: **Sl.No.:** [01]. **Tender Notice No.: CLW-DKAE-WC-570- E70CAB-26. Name of the work:** Outsourcing of cab furnishing activities and E-70/CCB panel mounting & its complete connection activities in 209 nos. of WAG-9HC locomotive at DLW/CLW/Dankuni for financial years 2026-27 & 2027-28. **Tender value (Rupees):** 1,55,32,199.95 (Rupees One crore fifty-five lakhs thirty-two thousand one hundred and ninety nine and ninety five paise) only. **Cost of tender document (Rupees):** 5,000.00 (Rupees Five thousand only). **Earnest money (Rupees):** 3,10,700.00 (Rupees Three lakhs ten thousand and seven hundred only). **Period of completion:** 24 (twenty four) months. **NOTE:** (i) Complete details can be seen in the Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** (ii) Contact Number: 03212-230003 (iii) Date of closing of tender submission as 22.10.2026 at 12:00 hrs.
PR7/511 AEE/P/ Dankuni DLW/CLW(WB)
Like us on: www.facebook.com/clwrailways

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
12	CE / Electrical / USTPP-1/ Udangudi	Preventive Breakdown Maintenance of Belt and Pipe System Mechanical Electrical for first two hoppers of all rows

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: **www.tangedco.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in, www.tenders.tn.gov.in**
DIPR/3073/Tender/2026





PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby informed to the general public at large that we are investigating the title to a land parcel admeasuring an extent of 34,934 sq. ft. (0.80 acres), comprised in the following survey numbers, situated at Uthandi Village, Sholinganallur Taluk, Chennai District, forming part of "Tranquil – Phase IV" (hereinafter referred to as the "Schedule Property"), standing in the names of the following owners.

S. No	Present Owner	S. No	Plot No.	Sq. Ft.	Extent in acre
1.	Rajkumar Theatres Private Limited	210/3	1	2406	0.06
2	Rajkumar Theatres Private Limited	210/3	4	2405	0.06
3	Chandran and Southern Resorts and Motels Private Limited.	195/1, 2,3	7A	2556	0.06
4	Shoreline Development Limited	187/5	27A	1177	0.03
5	Shoreline Development Limited	187/5	27B	1223	0.03
6	G Square Realtors Private Limited	194/2	22B	2407	0.06
7	G Square Realtors Private Limited and Sethupathy Electronic Sound Processors Pvt. Ltd.	194/3A & 194/2	23A	2407	0.06
8	G Square Realtors Private Limited & Shoreline Development Limited and Sethupathy Electronic Sound Processors Pvt. Ltd.	194/3A, 194/2 & 187/4A	23B	2407	0.06
9	Shoreline Development Limited and Sethupathy Electronic Sound Processors Pvt. Ltd.	187/3, 187/4A, 194/3A	23C	3326	0.08
10	Sethupathy Electronic Sound Processors Pvt. Ltd.	194/3A	21A	2407	0.06
11	G Square Realtors Private Limited and Sethupathy Electronic Sound Processors Pvt. Ltd.	194/3A & 194/2	21B	2407	0.06
12	G Square Realtors Private Limited and Sethupathy Electronic Sound Processors Pvt. Ltd.	194/3A & 194/2	22A	2407	0.06
13	Chandran, Rajkumar Theatre and Shoreline Development Limited	210/1, 210/2B, 204/1A1 A&195/1	11A	2468	0.06
14	Rajkumar Theatres Private Limited	210/1 & 210/2B	10B	2479	0.06
15	Rajkumar Theatres Private Limited	210/1 & 210/2B	10A	2452	0.06
		TOTAL		**34934**	**0.80**

Any person(s) or entity(ies) (a) having, claiming or asserting to have any rights, title, demands and/or interests in respect of the Schedule Property or any part or portion thereof of any nature whatsoever and/ or any claim by way of, under, or in the nature of sale, share, conveyance, acquisition, partition, transfer, memorandum of understanding, exchange, mortgage, pledge, charge, encumbrance, gift, Will, trust, inheritance, succession, possession, lease, sub-lease, tenancy, maintenance, easement, license, bequeath, bequest, assignment, lien, attachment, decree, award or order of any court of law or authority, development rights, right of way, lis pendens, family arrangement/ settlement, reservation, or under any contract/ agreement/ writing/ document or other disposition, FSI/FAR consumption, or any liability or commitment or otherwise or demand of any nature whatsoever over the Schedule Property or any portion(s) thereof; and/or (b) having any objection(s) of any manner whatsoever are hereby called upon to notify the undersigned in writing of any such claim accompanied with necessary documentary proof of the same within 15 (Fifteen) days from the date of publication of this notice failing which it will be presumed that no one has any right, title, claim or interest, possession of any nature whatsoever in the Schedule Property, and the claim or objection, if any, has been knowingly waived. Any claims or objections received thereafter shall be deemed to be forfeited / waived and shall not be entertained in any manner whatsoever and shall not be binding.

Sd/-
Khaitan And Co LLP
Pirabu Mohan (Partner), Advocates & Solicitors
Dadha Chambers, 9th Floor, New No 250, Old No 268, Avvai Shanmugham Salai,
Royapettah, Chennai-600014. E-mail: pirabu.mohan@khaitanco.com

ANDHRA PRADESH FOREST DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Andhra Pradesh undertaking)
Head Office: 3rd Floor, P.V.S Land Mark, Near APIIC Towers Mangalagiri,
Guntur District, AP-522503: LL.no: 08645-297211 & 08645-2977221
E-mail: vcmd_apfdc@yahoo.co.in, vcmd.apfdcl@gmail.com ,Website: www.apfdcl.ap.gov.in

EUCALYPTUS DEBARKED PULPWOOD SALE NOTICE

Ref.No.OP.001/EDPW/2025-26/Gen/Vol-II/990 Date: 07.10.2026.
Sale of about **3.03 lakh metric tonnes** of **Eucalyptus Debarked Pulpwood** anticipated from Eucalyptus Plantations of A.P. Forest Development Corporation Limited, grouped into (33) units is proposed to be held through e-Tender cum e-Auction on "Konugolu", a Govt. of Andhra Pradesh e-Portal i.e., **"https://www.konugolu.ap.gov.in"** from 12.00 hrs to 14.00 hrs (1st spell) and from 15.00 hrs to 17.00 hrs (2nd spell) on 23.10.2026. Sale Units that remain unsold/unconfirmed will be exposed for sale again on **30.10.2026 & 06.11.2026.** For more details, please visit the websites: **https://www.konugolu.ap.gov.in** & **https://www.apfdcl.ap.gov.in.**
DIPR 5490PP/CL, Dt, 08/10/2026
Sd/- PCCF (HoFF) & Vice Chairman and Managing Director (FAC)

REPLY TO THE PUBLIC NOTICE

The present reply to the Public Notice is issued on behalf of my clients **Mrs.Geetha Ravishankar and Mr. B.A.Kodandarama Setty**, in Reply to the Public Notice issued in The Hindu dated 16.09.2026 by R.Ashwanth, Advocate, on behalf of his client, N.Ravichandran.

My clients, **Geetha Ravishankar and B.A.Kodandarama Setty** are undisputed owners of their respective properties, in the following manner,

Mrs. Geetha Ravishankar: - Land admeasuring 10,925 sq. ft. in the front portion of the property bearing Old No. 28, Subsequent No. 65/1 & 65/2 and present Door No. 149, Luz Church Road, Mylapore, Chennai 600 004, comprised in R.S.No. 1652/4 (Presently R.S.No.1652/8), Block No.34, Mylapore Village, Mylapore-Triplicane Taluk, along with Undivided Share in the common passage on the Eastern side of the property.

B.A.Kodandarama Setty:- Land admeasuring 12,075 sq.ft. with a storied building of total constructed area of 5318 sq.ft., bearing old no. 28, subsequent No. 64 and present Door No.147, Luz Church Road, Mylapore, Chennai 600 004, comprised in R.S. No. 1652/2 (Presently R.S.No.1652/18), Block No.34, Mylapore Village, Mylapore-Triplicane Taluk, along with Undivided Share in the common passage on the eastern side of the property. The suit in O.S. No. 3850 of 2021 (Previously C. S. No. 668 of 2010) was filed by my clients, questioning acquisition of one portion of the Passage Rights on the eastern side of the respective properties, by one Arun Nehru. This suit has nothing to do with the Ownership rights of my client over their respective properties and their pathway rights **comprised in Survey Nos.1652/16 and 1652/22 of Mylapore Village.**

Likewise, the suit in C.S.No. 172 of 2024 has been filed by my clients against N.Ravichandran and others, questioning the illegal acquisition of an extent of 2650 sq.ft. of vacant land which situate on the eastern side of the common passage and appurtenant to the same, as described above. This suit also does not have anything to do with the ownership rights of my clients' over their respective properties and their pathway rights, **comprised in Survey Nos.1652/16 and 1652/22 of Mylapore Village.**

The General public are hereby informed that there is absolutely no impediment in my clients' dealing with their respective properties along with their passage rights **over the pathway comprised in Survey Nos.1652/16 and 1652/22 of Mylapore Village.**

M.VENKATAKRISHNAN, ADVOCATE
No.379, New Addl. Law Chambers, High Court Buildings, Chennai-104.
Mobile No: 9940377197.

The Egg on Our Plate: Protein That Powers and Protects

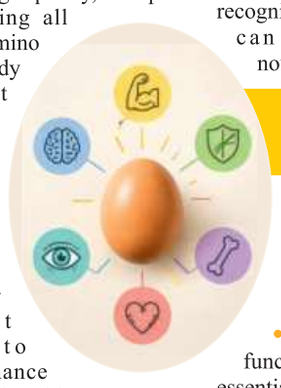
As World Egg Day 2026 celebrates the humble egg, it takes centre stage as a natural source of high-quality protein and essential nutrients that contribute to health, strength and well-being through every stage of life.

From a hurried breakfast and a school lunchbox to a post-workout meal or a family dinner, the egg continues to find its place on plates across homes, cultures and generations. Boiled, scrambled, poached, baked or prepared as an omelette, eggs combine familiar taste, versatility and nutritional value.

This World Egg Day, celebrated on Friday, 9 October 2026, the global theme "Protein that Powers and Protects" highlights the role eggs can play in supporting everyday nutrition and well-being.

A Small Food with a Powerful Nutritional Role

Protein helps the body build, repair and maintain tissues while supporting essential bodily functions. Eggs provide high-quality, complete protein containing all nine essential amino acids that the body needs but cannot produce on its own.



For children, adequate protein supports growth and development. For adults, it contributes to muscle maintenance and repair, while older people can benefit from sufficient protein intake as part of a balanced diet that supports muscle strength and healthy ageing.

Beyond protein, eggs contain nutrients such as vitamin B12, vitamin D, selenium and choline. These contribute to normal bodily functions,including nervous system health, bone health, immune function and energy metabolism.

Powering Everyday Life, One Meal at a Time

Eggs can be a convenient addition to meals for people with different lifestyles. A child can enjoy an egg as part of a nutritious breakfast, while a working professional may choose an egg sandwich or vegetable omelette during a busy day. Those returning from exercise can include eggs in a meal to help meet their protein needs.

Eggs are not limited to breakfast. They can be added to salads, rice dishes, sandwiches, wraps and traditional preparations. From spiced omelettes and boiled eggs to egg curry, their versatility allows them to complement different ingredients and food traditions.

The focus is not on one food replacing a varied diet, but on recognising how accessible ingredients can contribute to everyday nourishment.

Protecting Health Through Essential Nutrients

The "Protects" element of this year's theme draws attention to nutrients in eggs that support the body's normal functions:

- **Choline:** Supports brain function, cell structure and other essential processes.
- **Vitamin B12:** Contributes to normal nervous system function and red blood cell formation.
- **Selenium:** Supports normal immune function and helps protect cells from oxidative stress.
- **Vitamin D:** Plays a role in bone health and normal immune function.
- **Lutein and Zeaxanthin**: Naturally occurring compounds in eggs associated with eye health.

The nutritional value of eggs is best understood within a varied diet that includes vegetables, fruits, whole grains, pulses and other nutrient-rich foods. Nutritional needs differ according to age, health, activity levels and dietary preferences.

From the Kitchen to Every Generation

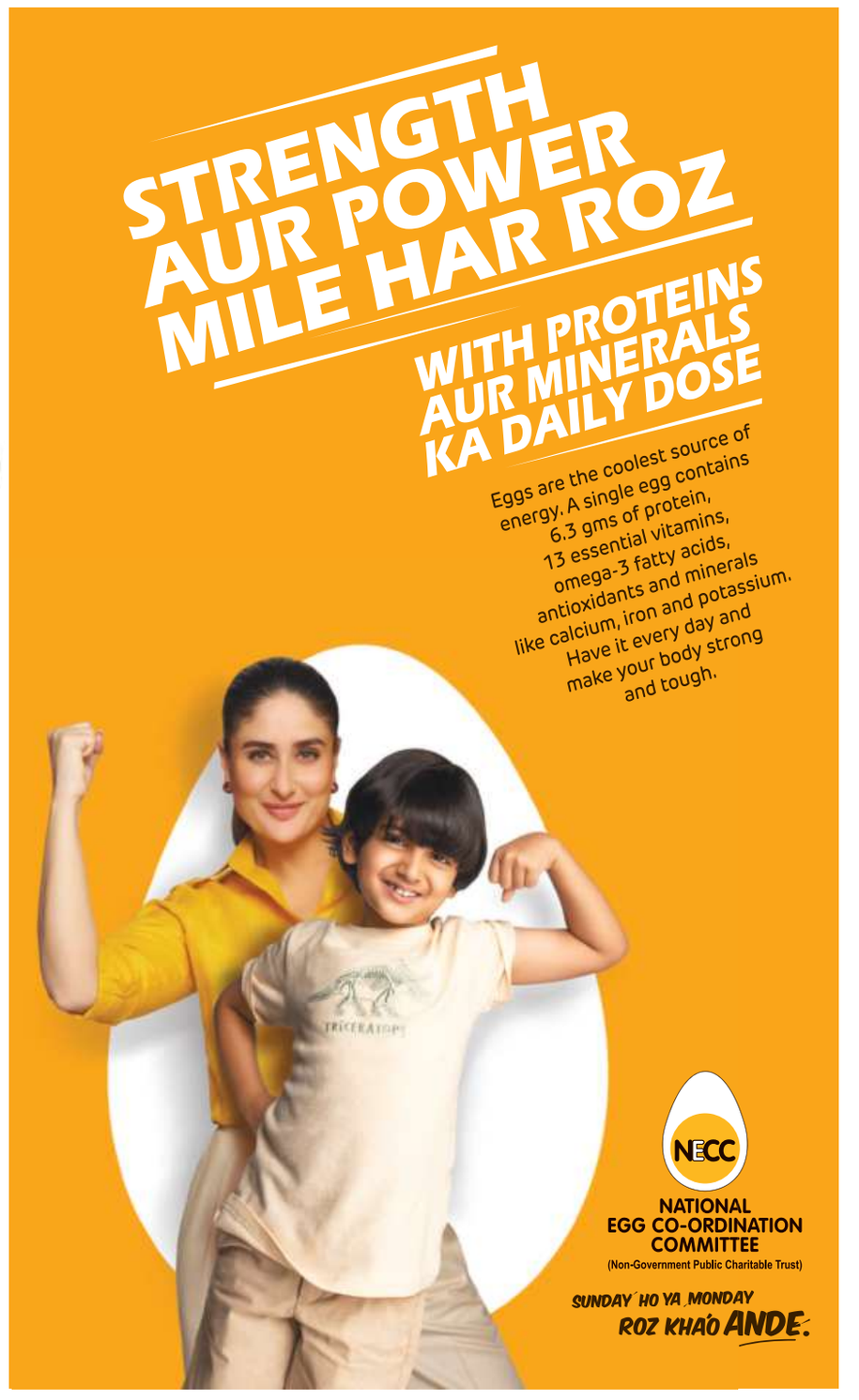
One of the egg's strengths is its ability to fit into different lifestyles. Families can prepare it in multiple ways, while students, professionals and active individuals can include it in quick, nourishing meals. For older adults, eggs offer a convenient and easy-to-prepare source of high-quality protein.

This flexibility has helped eggs become a familiar part of food traditions around the world. Their ease of preparation and adaptability make them a practical ingredient for everyday eating.

A Celebration of Everyday Nutrition

World Egg Day is an opportunity to reflect on the role of nutrition in supporting individuals, families and communities. The egg's combination of high-quality protein, essential nutrients and versatility makes it a valuable addition to a balanced eating pattern. As the world observes World Egg Day 2026, the theme "Protein that Powers and Protects" brings attention to a familiar food that can contribute to nutritional needs across different stages of life.

Whether served as a quick breakfast or part of a traditional family meal, the egg reminds us that healthy eating can begin with simple, consistent choices. ●●●



INBRIEF

BJP slams TVK-led govt. over sexual assault on five-year-old

BJP State president Nainar Nagenthran on Thursday criticised the TVK-led government and the police over a reported sexual assault on a five-year-old child in Gummidipoondi. Expressing shock and angst over the incident, he said such crimes were recurring, and the law and order situation in the State was deteriorating under the TVK-led government. In a social media post, Mr. Nagenthran alleged that the people were forced to nab the culprits on their own owing to the inefficiency of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay. The BJP leader further alleged that the TVK-led government's "administrative debacles and inexperience" were the primary reasons for such incidents.

Palaniswami flays govt. over 'deteriorating' law and order

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Thursday criticised the government over alleged deterioration of the law and order situation in the State. Referring to various reported offences involving violence, Mr. Palaniswami alleged that "blood was flowing on the roads". He condemned some Ministers who, according to him, were blaming the Opposition parties instead of focusing on crime prevention.

Vijay produces Kodaikanal land sale deed before HC

Judge wonders whether an election tribunal can decide title of property when confronted with conflicting documents. Petitioner claims the land was classified as 'Government Poramboke' land

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has produced before the Madras High Court a sale deed to prove that he had purchased 50 cents of land at Vilpatti village in Kodaikanal in 1997, as declared in his election affidavit while contesting from the Perambur Assembly constituency this year.

The sale deed was produced before Justice V. Lakshminarayanan, who is seized of an election petition filed by S. Dinesh, a voter, urging the court to declare Mr. Vijay's victory from the Perambur constituency null and void on the ground of false declarations and misdeclarations in his election affidavit.

In the petition, filed through his counsel on record, V.R. Shanmuganathan, the voter had claimed that the Vilpatti property had actually been classified as 'Government Poramboke' land as per the Village 'A' register, a land record the petitioner had downloaded from the State government's website.

When the judge wanted to know whether he, as the presiding officer of an election tribunal, could decide the title of a property when confronted with conflicting documents, the petitioner's arguing counsel replied: "Definitely MiLord. Your Lordship can render a finding on the issue."

The election petitioner had urged that Vijay's victory from Perambur be declared null and void on the ground of false declarations and misdeclarations in his election affidavit.

"After taking evidence during the course of trial, Your Lordship can decide anything. Your Lordship may even render a finding that yes, the sale deed is correct and the 'A' register is not correct because it is an old record. Your Lordship may conclude whatever you feel is right," he said.

However, the counsel said a decision as to whether the sale deed was right or the 'A' register was not right could not be taken at the present stage when the Chief Minister had filed an application to reject the election petition at the threshold, without even taking it to the stage of trial.

He said the election petitioner had made out a cause of action for conducting a full-fledged trial by listing a number of false declarations and misdeclarations in the election affidavit, which had the effect of influencing the voters' choice, and hence, the application filed by the Chief Minister must be dismissed.

On the judge's question as to whether being in possession of government land would disentitle a person from being a Member of the Legislative Assembly, the counsel said, "I would prefer not to go into that issue. I am confining my argument to the point that the applicant's claim over the Vilpatti property is false."

Vijay's argument

Thereafter, arguing the case on behalf of the Chief Minister, senior counsel Gopal Sankaranarayanan said Mr. Vijay had declared assets worth over ₹600 crore in his election affidavit. "So, if he is wealthy up to ₹630 crore, the question is whether a difference by a few crore would amount to criminalisation of politics," he said.

He went on to state: "Let's presume that there is some strange voter for whom this ₹2 or ₹3 crore may make a difference. Maybe in his mind, he had said that if Mr. Vijay has more than ₹650 crore, I am not going to vote for him. Let's presume that kind of a strange individual resides within this constituency. To that human being, there is a further step that the election petitioner has to take to say that look, here are a bunch of voters who actually have ₹650 crore as a cut-off mark and if it is going to go beyond that, they are not going to vote for him. But there is no such pleading in the election petition."

After the counsel for both sides concluded their oral arguments, Justice Lakshminarayanan directed the Registry to list the case on October 14 for submission of written arguments. The judge said he shall reserve orders on Mr. Vijay's application after the receipt of the written notes.

Venting ire: Parents staging a protest at the Manoor Panchayat Union Primary School in Dindigul district on Thursday.

Faeces found in water tank at government school in Dindigul

The Hindu Bureau
DINDIGUL

In a shocking incident, faeces was reportedly found in a drinking water tank of a government school at Manoor near Palani in Dindigul district. This is the second such incident reported in the district in recent times.

According to the police, over 120 students study at the Manoor Panchayat Union Primary School, located within the Keeranur police station limits.

The incident was reported when the school reopened on October 5 after the quarterly examination break. The headmaster got the water tank cleaned.

The issue was also raised during the Parent-Teacher Association and School Management Committee meeting held at the school on Wednesday. Enraged by the incident, parents staged a protest and accused the school administration of negligence on student safety.

As the situation escalated, Dindigul Superintendent of Police S. Jeyakumar visited the school and inspected the water tank on the premises. He issued instructions to the police to take swift action and arrest those involved in the offence.

Acting on a complaint lodged by the headmaster, the Keeranur police registered a case under the provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS). An investigation is under way.

District education officials also visited the school and held meetings with the parents and the school authorities.

The headmaster said cleaning work had been undertaken to prevent students from drinking water from the contaminated tank, and the issue had been reported to higher authorities.

In August, faeces was found near the water tank of a Government Higher Secondary School at Thangamapatti in the district.

M. Veerapandian

Government should listen to people's concerns, says CPI leader

The Hindu Bureau
KRISHNAGIRI

While it is unfair to expect positive change within four months of a new regime assuming office, the government should pay heed to the common people's concerns, and not depend solely on bureaucrats to decide on public policy, Communist Party of India (CPI) State secretary M. Veerapandian said in Hosur on Thursday.

Addressing the media on the sidelines of a party executive meeting, the CPI leader underlined that the Left parties' support to the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam was not for a government but for democracy, and that the party would always ally with the common people.

Poll promises

There were several sections of the population, including sanitation workers, road workers, nurses, and government doctors and teachers, whose demands and needs had not been met despite being included in poll promises. It was incumbent upon the government to honour those promises, Mr. Veerapandian said.

Hindi name board at Thanjavur Railway Junction removed

The Hindu Bureau
THANJAVUR

Tamil organisations had called for a demonstration against the Hindi name board

Railway authorities removed a name board in Hindi atop the second entrance to the Thanjavur Railway Junction on Thursday, following opposition from various organisations.

Tamil organisations had called for a demonstration at the junction on Thursday. However, when the issue was brought to the notice of the railway authorities on Wednesday night, they said action would be taken on Thursday after consulting senior officials. Meanwhile, the DMK registered its protest and demanded the immediate removal of the Hindi name board.

On Thursday, a group of DMK cadre staged a demonstration at the junction, condemning the placing of the Hindi name board at a prominent location. Thanjavur MP S. Murasoli visited the junction while the railway officials were removing the name board.

Thanking the Southern Railway for removing the board, the Leftists Common Platform said the display of the name board in Hindi atop the second entrance portico, where a replica of the Big Temple tower had been placed, was an act of Hindi imposition.

Diplomatic community should work towards India becoming NSG member, says Kakodkar

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Atomic Energy Commission (AEC) member Anil Kakodkar on Thursday called upon the country's diplomatic community to work towards India becoming a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG).

Mr. Kakodkar was speaking at an international conference on 'Building India's Nuclear Ecosystem – Policy, Technology & Industry', organised by the Indian Institute of Technology-Madras (IIT-M) and the Deccan Centre for International Relations (DCIR) in Chennai.

"We get a lot of uranium now from the international market, thanks to the NSG waiver. But it is only a waiver. It is not membership. That waiver can be turned around without much difficulty. I request all those who are engaged in diplomacy to make sure that we get membership of the NSG because that is what will de-risk the availability of uranium, which is a major risk factor in building such a large programme," Mr. Kakodkar said. He called for accelerating efforts to bring thorium into energy generation.

Atomic Energy Commission member Anil Kakodkar speaking at a conference in Chennai on Thursday. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

Pointing to certain limitations in the Sustainable Harnessing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India Act, 2025 (aka SHANTI Act), Mr. Kakodkar said, "There are justifiable reasons for that. But the question is how does one carry out a nuclear reactor design *de novo* under such a situation? I think we need to put our heads together. I don't find enough clarity on this."

For instance, molten-salt reactor was where back-end activities took place inside the reactor system. But the SHANTI Act would not allow it, legally speaking, he pointed out.

'Renewed momentum'

Former Permanent Representative of India to the United Nations and chair of the DCIR's steering committee, T.S. Tirumurti, said nuclear energy was experiencing a renewed momentum across the world. "Issues such as private capital and advanced manufacturing in international collaborations are increasingly central to the nuclear landscape. India stands at a particularly important juncture in this global story. With ambitious targets for expanding nuclear capacity, a long-standing three-stage programme, and a growing recognition of the need for faster, more cost-effective deployment, we need to actively shape the next chapter of our nuclear journey," he said.

Professor Manu Santhanam from the Department of Civil Engineering at IIT-M said the institute had been incubating several startups.

He expected that some startups would grow in the nuclear sector, given the SHANTI Act which, he said, had paved the way for ideas emerging from youngsters. DCIR Senior Advisor Balasubramanian C. said the global nuclear landscape was witnessing a revival. India stood at a pivotal moment to build a self-reliant, technology-driven nuclear ecosystem, he added.

VCK chief's statements on SIR send mixed signals to party leaders, cadre

U. Udhav Naig
CHENNAI

A senior VCK leader says it is time for Mr. Thirumavalavan to take a clear stand with respect to the alliance

Contradictory statements and positions taken by the Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) on the impact of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls on the results of the recent Assembly elections in the State have surprised and confused political circles, as the VCK continues to be a part of the TVK-led Cabinet.

Participating in a protest against the Election Commission of India in New Delhi recently, VCK president Thol. Thirumavalavan raised doubts over the TVK's electoral victory and attributed it to the SIR process.

"SIR created a three-cornered contest, and that is why we have this result. It is possible that the TVK's victory was owing to the SIR's impact, as in other States," he said, surprising many.

Cause for confusion: Thol. Thirumavalavan has raised doubts over the TVK's electoral victory, and attributed it to the SIR process.

After all, Mr. Thirumavalavan had thrown his weight behind the TVK, which recently contested the bypolls in the Madurantakam and Dharapuram reserved constituencies.

VCK general secretary D. Ravikumar echoed Mr. Thirumavalavan's sentiments. When asked how the VCK could justify its support for the TVK-led government while questioning the Assembly election results, he said, "We have raised concerns about the SIR process not just now, but for the past several months. There is a serious possibility that SIR could have influenced the outcome of the Tamil Nadu Assembly polls, as it has in other States. Major political parties and civil society organisations should conduct a survey, like the CPI (ML) did in Bihar, and verify the deletions and additions."

"Our leader said at the time of the results that, in the constituencies where there had been more deletions, the TVK had won, and where there had been fewer deletions, the other parties had fared better. But this does not automatically mean the TVK benefited from SIR. There needs to be a proper investigation into the SIR process in Tamil Nadu to find out the social composition of the deleted voters," he added.

A senior VCK leader said it was time for Mr. Thirumavalavan to take a clear stand with respect to the alliance. "Our leader needs to communicate to our cadre and supporters where the VCK stands with respect to the TVK. Statements such as these are not helping the party. We should preserve our ideological foundation," he said.

Another VCK leader said, "The statements perhaps reflect the fact that he is not confident about the TVK's electoral fortunes in the future, and its ideological commitment to opposing the BJP/RSS. We should have provided outside support to the TVK in forming the government."

INDIA bloc protest

Meanwhile, Mr. Thirumavalavan said the INDIA bloc's protest in Delhi should evolve into a "people's movement" against EVMs.

In a statement, he said that on Wednesday, over 100 MPs and leaders of the bloc, including Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi, Mallikarjun Kharge, and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, took part in the protest.

He said the protest had strengthened his belief in the need for Opposition parties to work together to "protect the Constitution and the country".

He said the issue went beyond electoral concerns, and criticised Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah, and Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar. The protest should not be limited to demanding the CEC's resignation, but should develop into a mass movement against the Modi government and EVMs, he said.

Vijayapura MLA booked over voters' fake death certificates

The Hindu Bureau
BELAGAVI

The Vijayapura police in Karnataka have registered an FIR against Basanagouda Patil Yatnal, MLA, on the charge of creating false death certificates of voters in a bid to exclude them from the electoral rolls in Vijayapura Assembly constituency. Mr. Yatnal was expelled by the BJP in March 2025.

Officers of the Jala Nagar police station registered an FIR based on a complaint by Abdul Razak Bagwan, vegetable vendor.

Mr. Bagwan alleged that Mr. Yatnal and the booth level agent (BLA) of Vijayapura Assembly Constituency had falsely claimed that he had died, and that his name needs to be struck off the electoral rolls under the special intensive revision (SIR) exercise. Mr. Yatnal had managed to obtain a false death certificate through unfair means, the complainant alleged.

The complainant told the police that he knew of at least seven other persons who Mr. Yatnal had falsely claimed as dead, and had obtained false death certificates for all of them as part of a conspiracy to delete their names by submitting Form 7 .

On October 7, members of the Vijayapura district unit of Mata Kavalu Samiti held a press meet in Bengaluru where persons who were passed off as deceased were presented before presspersons.

Scrap SIR, say Bengaluru protesters

Exercise is being used to delete voters' names and disenfranchise those opposed to BJP, says CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke at the 'People's Tribunal'; YouTuber Dhruv Rathee and actor-activist Prakash Raj criticise CEC Gyanesh Kumar and ECI

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke, YouTuber Dhruv Rathee, and actor-activist Prakash Raj on Thursday staged a protest at Bengaluru's Freedom Park against the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, demanding Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar's resignation and the scrapping of the exercise.

Addressing the protest titled the "People's Tribunal", organised by civil society groups and CJP, Mr. Dipke alleged that the SIR exercise was being used to delete voters' names and disenfranchise those opposed to the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).

Growing support: Dhruv Rathee, Prakash Raj, Abhijeet Dipke, Saurav Das, SFI member Aishe Ghosh, and others at a protest against the SIR at Freedom Park in Bengaluru on Thursday. SUDHAKARA JAIN

He also accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the Election Commission of India (ECI) of undermining democracy.

Mr. Rathee, who was in Bengaluru for his "first protest" against the SIR, called for the resignation of Mr. Kumar, alleging a lack of transparency and accountability on the part of the EC. He said that "vote *chori*" (vote theft) was an issue that affected all citizens, irrespective of their political affiliations.

"I have three questions. Modi, Shah or Gyanesh Kumar can answer to dismiss claims of '*vote chori*' (vote theft) – How were over 75 lakh people removed before the West Bengal elections and then added soon after the elections? These people were on the rolls before the elections and after the elections, but not during the election. What happened in Bihar? Over 40 lakh names were deleted... Who are these people? While in Goa, even though EROs wanted to add names, the ECI did not allow it," he alleged.

Actor Prakash Raj called for the SIR to be scrapped, alleging that it [SIR] is an attack on the dignity and democratic rights of citizens. "They cannot eliminate citizens physically, so they are trying to eliminate them from the electoral rolls," he alleged.

(With PTI inputs)

Cong. leaders held during march in Hyderabad

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Several senior leaders of Telangana Pradesh Congress Committee (TPCC), including Ministers Ponguleti Srinivas Reddy, Ponnam Prabhakar, D. Sridhar Babu, Mohd Azharuddin, Adluri Laxman Kumar and Vakiti Srihari and TPCC president B. Mahesh Kumar Goud were detained by the police on Thursday when they attempted to march towards Lok Bhavan in Hyderabad demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

The *Chalo Lok Bhavan* protest was part of the INDIA bloc's "Save Democracy" campaign against alleged irregularities in the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. TPCC and its political associates Communist Party of India (CPI), Telangana Jana Samithi (TJS) and other parties participated.

Police blockade

Supporters of various political parties gathered at the Indira Gandhi statue near Necklace Road in Hyderabad carrying party flags, and as they moved towards to Lok Bhavan, they raised slogans against Mr. Gyanesh Kumar. The police barricaded the route to Lok Bhavan to prevent the agitating leaders and cadre from reaching Lok Bhavan. Some of the Congress leaders tried to jump the barricades raising slogans but were prevented by the police. They staged a protest at the spot before being detained and shifted to the Panjagutta police station.

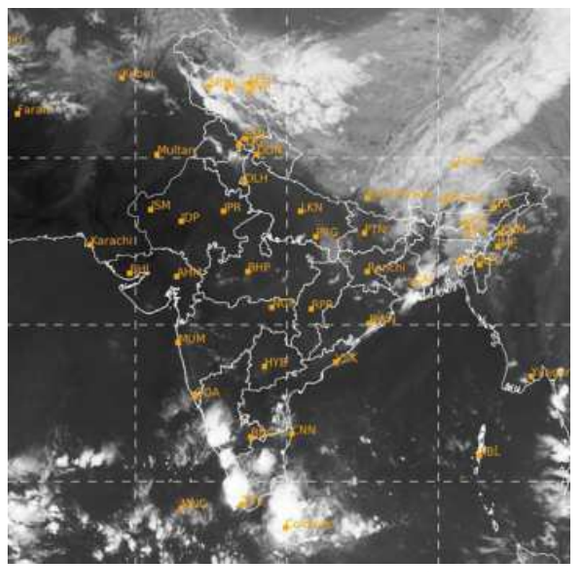
Opposition march: TPCC, CPI, TJS leaders and workers participate in the Congress's 'Chalo Lok Bhavan' protest. G. RAMAKRISHNA

Ministers Ponguleti and Ponnam Prabhakar spoke to the presspersons and said the lack of transparency in the Election Commission of India's functioning was raised by Rahul Gandhi long ago and the recent developments proved them right.

The protests disrupted traffic on the stretch from Khairatabad to Secretariat.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Friday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Uttarakhand, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Keralam and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh and Lakshadweep

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	16.4	33.4	23.0	Kurnool	—	38.2	26.6
Ahmedabad	—	37.6	24.5	Lucknow	0.8	30.2	21.6
Aizawl	—	31.5	21.3	Madurai	—	36.5	26.6
Bengaluru	—	31.1	21.4	Mangaluru	0.2	33.7	25.0
Bhopal	—	35.8	18.0	Mumbai	—	37.6	24.7
Bhubaneswar	—	34.7	23.6	Mysuru	—	31.2	20.0
Chandigarh	—	31.2	24.2	New Delhi	—	35.7	24.1
Chennai	—	36.0	28.2	Patna	15.2	28.5	21.2
Coimbatore	—	34.8	24.4	Port Blair	—	32.0	25.2
Dehradun	10	27.8	18.6	Prayagraj	—	33.4	22.2
Gangtok	0.1	18.7	13.7	Puducherry	—	34.1	26.6
Goa	—	35.0	24.8	Pune	—	35.0	22.0
Guwahati	—	33.3	22.3	Raipur	22.6	34.0	21.4
Hubballi	—	34.0	21.0	Ranchi	—	27.7	18.0
Hyderabad	—	34.5	23.2	Shillong	10.2	22.4	14.4
Imphal	6.4	30.2	19.4	Shimla	12	21.5	12.8
Jaipur	—	36.1	25.2	Srinagar	—	28.2	10.9
Kochi	—	32.0	26.8	Thiruvananthapuram	—	34.2	25.8
Kohima	4	24.6	15.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	36.3	26.0
Kolkata	7.2	34.0	26.6	Vijayawada	—	33.6	26.2
Kozhikode	—	36.4	27.1	Visakhapatnam	—	33.1	26.6

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.80	..71	32	 65	...133	
Bengaluru	...9	..26	67	 59	72	
Chennai	...8	..10	51	 63	61	
Delhi	.18	..65	48	... 179	...260	
Hyderabad	.13	..24	58	 59	...107	
Kolkata	...5	..59	35	... 101	...115	
Lucknow	.35	..14	42	 43	50	
Mumbai	...5	110	41	... 148	...151	
Pune	..—	..73	39	... 139	...130	
Visakhapatnam	.17	..89	22	 60	...119	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Bahadurgarh, Haryana recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 290 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Puducherry recorded a healthy AQI score of 19

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Udayasthamana puja should be held in Guruvayur temple as per old traditions, says SC

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday passed an interim order that the Udayasthamana puja must be held in accordance with the age-old practices of the Guruvayur Sri Krishna Temple in Keralam.

A Bench headed by Justice Aravind Kumar said the faith and sentiments of worshippers must be given precedence over management hurdles.

The petitioners led by P.C. Hary and members of traditional managing families, represented by senior advocate Guru Krishnakumar, had challenged decisions by the Guruvayur devaswom managing committee to alter or reschedule the Udayasthamana puja on Vrishchikam Ekadasi. The management, represented by senior advocates C.A. Sundaram, V. Giri and advocate Rohini Musa, had argued that the performance of the rituals during Ekadasi was faced by logistical challenges posed by the massive influx of devotees on that particular day. The court said it would list the main appeal in December for final hearing.

The petitioners had moved the top court after the Kerala High Court had dismissed their pleas for a direction to the temple devaswom to ensure the conduct of the Udayasthamana puja on Vrishchikam Ekadasi. In October last year, the apex court had passed a similar order allowing the conduct of the pooja on the Ekadasi day which fell in the month of November.

CUK suspends five students for 'disrupting' 2-day seminar

The Hindu Bureau
KASARAGOD

The Central University of Kerala (CUK) on Thursday suspended five students following protests that disrupted a two-day national seminar on *Vande Mataram* that began on the campus on Tuesday.

The Bekal police registered a *suo motu* case against 25 students who allegedly gathered and disrupted proceedings at the seminar.

Tension continued on Wednesday when students protested against the programme's chief organiser. .

HC comes to headmistress' aid after being denied entry to school wearing churidar

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

"A citizen's attire is their choice, and nobody can insist that it conform to society's customs, especially when there is no law backing it," the Kerala High Court has observed.

Justice P.V. Kunhikrishnan was considering a petition by the headmistress of Eeswara Vilasom High School, Kottarakara, Kollam, seeking to disqualify the school's manager for allegedly denying her entry to the school for wearing *churidar-kameez* instead of a sari. She also sought police protection for her remaining tenure at the school.

The court observed that it did not need to direct his disqualification since an inquiry was in progress against the manager. The court directed the Station House Officer, Kottarakara, to ensure that the manager did not impede the petitioner from discharging her duties as the headmistress.

The petitioner claimed that the manager threatened her against wearing *churidar-kameez* to school and allegedly instructed security personnel to deny her entry if she did so.

Later, she had to seek police help to enter the schoo. She cited a circular issued by the Directorate General of Education, stating that she was entitled to wear a churidhar to school.

The court was informed that the District Educational Officer, Kottarakara, and produced a *prima facie* report for disciplinary action against the manager.

Govt. rolls out new 'NoRKA' ID card for returnees

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Keralam government has started the process of issuing the "NoRKA Returnee ID Card".

This identification card is intended for Keralites who have returned after residing outside the State or country for a minimum period of two years. The card will be useful for accessing various government services and for availing themselves of welfare and rehabilitation schemes designed for returning expatriates, general manager of NoRKA-Roots said.

GREATER CHENNAI CORPORATION
Mechanical Engineering Department
M.E.D.C.No.M1/1917 & 1918/2026
e-Tender Notice
e - Tender is invited by the Superintending Engineer (Mech), for the following works as per details furnished below

Various Works in Mechanical Engineering Department

Lowest Work value : Rs.2,38,67,116/- Highest Work value : Rs. 4,73,60,000/-
Lowest EMD : Rs. 2,39,000/- Highest EMD : Rs. 4,74,000/-

For further details please visit https://tntenders.gov.in

Last date and time for bid submission : 28.10.2026, 3.00 P.M.

Tender Opening Date and Time : 28.10.2026, 4.30 P.M.

DIPR/ 3074 /TENDER/2026 Superintending Engineer (Mechanical)

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
11	CE/Electrical/ USTPP-1,Udangudi	Operation and Mechanical Maintenance works of 2 Nos Ship Unloaders Make Model DHHI SUL 2000TPH

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: www.tangedco.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in, www.tenders.tn.gov.in
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Khadi and Village Industries Commission
Ministry of Micro, Small, & Medium Enterprises
Government of India
Zonal Office (South Zone), Vijinapura, Doorvani Nagar, Bengaluru- 560016
Tele./Fax- 080-25660258 E-mail : zosz.kvic@gov.in : Website : www.kvic.gov.in

ENGAGEMENT OF YOUNG PROFESSIONALS ON CONTRACTUAL BASIS

Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) is a Statutory Body established by an Act of Parliament and functioning under the administrative control of Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (Govt. of India). In order to accelerate future growth and transformation challenges, KVIC invites online applications for engagement of :-

Sr. No.	Positions	No. of Vacancies	Place of Posting	Essential Qualification
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3.	Young Professional (Marketing)	1	State Office, KVIC, Chennai.	Post Graduate degree in the relevant field from a recognized University/Institution.
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Director
Zonal Office (South Zone)
KVIC, Bengaluru

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Date of Commencement of online application	:	09.10.2026, 12.00 Noon
Last date for online submission of application	:	15.10.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.

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Adequate response

The RBI policy review will need central assistance to effectively fight inflation

After months of waiting and watching, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)'s Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) has decided to act to try to rein in rising inflation. Its decision to raise interest rates by 25 bps seemed increasingly inevitable. The RBI now projects retail inflation at 4.9% in Q2, higher than its August projection of 4.7%. This is set to rise in Q3 to 6% before easing marginally to 5.7% in Q4. Global oil prices have again crossed $100 a barrel following a brief reprieve. India's oil marketing companies, likely following government instructions, have held off on passing most of this increase on to consumers. However, they cannot withstand such fiscal pressures forever. The impact of higher crude prices has been bad enough, but higher petrol and diesel prices will likely send inflation spiralling. Simultaneously, a deficient monsoon is pushing up food prices and will continue to do so for the rest of the year. When supply-side factors are the primary drivers of inflation, an interest rate hike can only have second-order and largely marginal effects on inflation. In such a scenario, the signal sent by the MPC becomes as important as the actual action. The MPC has used this latest policy review to attempt to dampen inflation expectations, an important area of action. The expectation of high inflation in the near future can often become a self-fulfilling prophecy, independent of the factors driving prices up.

A 25 bps interest rate hike is a careful nudge rather than an inevitably ineffectual bludgeon. The fact that the MPC has changed its stance to 'calibrated tightening' from 'neutral' is the bigger signal. The question no longer is whether the RBI will hike rates in its next meeting in December, but by how much. The message from this stance change is that the central bank will use all the tools at its disposal to keep inflation in check. The RBI also clearly thinks that the economy can withstand such tightening. It has revised upwards its GDP growth forecast for 2026-27 to 7.1% from the 6.7% projected in August. That said, all economic agencies have, even before interest rates were hiked, been predicting a slowdown in the second-half of the year. The growth-inflation trade-off will again test the RBI's deftness. Higher interest rates may also pause the ongoing exodus of Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs), giving the RBI some exchange rate-related breathing room. The central bank has done what it can on inflation so far. The onus is now on the government. It has several tools to control food inflation, such as strategic buffers, import and export controls, anti-hoarding measures, and open market operations. Those need to be used more effectively.

Chance, happenstance

Bias is more than human sociology; life makes choices with definite preferences

Only in imagination, the mathematical imagination, does perfect equality exist. A fair coin has an equal probability of heads and tails, so across many tosses, the expectation is for the proportions to approach 50:50. Laborious demonstrations have shown that this is rarely the case; bias is preloaded into life. Only about 10% of humans are naturally left handed; a species that is a minority can overwhelm a resident population within a few generations. Economists refer to the 'Matthew effect' of the rich getting richer and the Pareto principle, and small accretive effects compounding. This is not just human sociology at work. It has been known since the work of the French chemist Louis Pasteur in 1848 that lifeless molecules can have mirror-image forms, like a left-handed glove and a right-handed glove. Chirality is the term chemists use for this molecular "handedness": a left-handed glove fits the left hand better than the right, even though the two may look like mirror images of one another. Chemists call the resulting predominance of one molecular handedness homochirality, from the Greek words for "same" and "hand". As with hands, almost all amino acids – the building blocks of proteins – exist as two mirrored variants, but only one of them, the 'L' or left-handed version, is found in the proteins in the cells. In the case of sugar molecules, it is the right-handed, or 'D', that are part of human DNA. Despite the various available options, life likes to choose one. In their labs, chemists have been able to create equal numbers of left- and right-handed variants of these mirrored molecules but it turns out that for making pharmaceuticals, it greatly matters which version of a mirrored molecule one uses. The thalidomide drug exists in two mirror-image forms, and their different three-dimensional shapes affect how they interact with biological molecules. Between 1957 and 1961, thalidomide resulted in more than 10,000 babies across the world being born with severe congenital abnormalities.

Henri Kagan and Kenso Soai have been awarded the Nobel Prize in Chemistry for explaining how such homo-chirality may have emerged and devising a reliable method for ensuring that a desired variant of a molecule be synthesised. Kagan's insight has an intriguing parallel with evolutionary biology: small initial differences need not produce proportionately small outcomes. Soai showed that a tiny initial excess of one molecular form can, under the right conditions, be amplified: the product of his reaction catalyses the formation of more products with the same handedness. Other than laying forth a model of how Matthew effects may underlie evolution, their work underlines how the quest to explain natural phenomena, driven by curiosity alone, can yield insights with practical applications to improve lives and also blaze trails for the future.

Flawed by design, exclusionary in impact

Srinivasan Ramani

Pon Vasanth B.A.

For more than 75 years, the defining preoccupation of the Election Commission of India (ECI) has been "inclusion". The first general election of 1951-52 had to enrol an electorate of around 17 crore from scratch, many of whom were illiterate. Successive Commissioners treated universal adult franchise as a promise to be fulfilled rather than just a principle to be stated on paper. India could genuinely be proud of being an electoral democracy where voter turnout among the poor is higher than that among the rich, unlike in many western democracies.

The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls launched by the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) of India, Gyanesh Kumar, has reversed this progressive direction. It was termed an exercise to "purify" the electoral rolls, but in practice, it is riddled with methodological flaws and *ad hoc* rule changes, resulting in the deletion of a large number of genuine voters.

The names of 13.37 crore people were struck off during the draft stage across 30 States and Union Territories in the three phases of the SIR. The figure includes 65 lakh in Bihar, 6.57 crore in the 12 States and Union Territories covered in Phase 2, and 6.15 crore in Phase 3, whose final rolls are yet to be published. The deletion rate doubled as SIR progressed – from 8.3% in Bihar to 12.9% in Phase 2 and 17% in Phase 3 (it was 32.8% in Delhi and 21.7% in Telangana). In Phases 1 and 2, even after names were added back, net deletions were about 6.2 crore.

In Delhi, the draft roll has only 97.54 lakh electors, barely above the 94.95 lakh who voted in the February 2025 Assembly election. In 24 of Delhi's 70 constituencies, the draft roll now has fewer electors than the number who voted in the election. The ECI has in effect conceded the point about disenfranchisement. It has now directed officials to run a "special drive" to enrol anyone "whose name has got left out" – an implicit admission that its rolls are missing eligible voters.

Flaws by design

First, enumeration. The ECI's Manual on Electoral Rolls (2023) describes an intensive revision as a "denovo process without reference to the earlier existing roll" (paragraph 9.3.1); enumerators visit every house and record the particulars of each eligible resident. If a particular elector's citizenship is in doubt, the Manual requires officials to give "probative value" (paragraph 7.4.2) to their presence on the preceding roll, and places the onus on the objector and not the elector.

The SIR inverts this procedure. It shifts enumeration on to electors and presumes that they are ineligible until they can trace themselves or a parent to the last intensive revision conducted more than two decades ago, or produce documents to establish their eligibility in what resembles a citizenship test.

Electors who could not be found, did not receive or return the form, or were unable to fill it – due to illiteracy, for example – were dropped from the draft roll, even if they had voted in the last election. All this was done at breakneck speed, on the eve of elections in several States.

> The Gyanesh Kumar-led Election Commission of India, emboldened by a deferential Supreme Court judgment, has already disenfranchised lakhs of genuine electors through its Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and risks excluding many more

Second, re-entry. A deleted voter cannot be easily restored, even if he or she has merely shifted address within the constituency. They must apply through Form 6 – the application for new voters – as though they had never been on the rolls. Since newly eligible 18-year-olds also use Form 6, the ECI has made it impossible to distinguish new voters from returning voters in the published figures, preventing a proper audit.

Third, "logical discrepancies". Software matched electors against two-decade-old rolls and flagged mismatches for scrutiny. These included spelling differences, more than six voters linked to one ancestor, and parent-child age gaps outside 15 to 45 years, among other arbitrary criteria.

This was first fully applied in West Bengal, where 60 lakh names were flagged and judicial officers deployed by the Supreme Court of India struck off 27 lakh names. Appellate tribunals appointed since then have restored electors in 93% of the cases, bringing back about one lakh names onto the rolls. But by early September – months after the Assembly election – they had disposed of only 1.22 lakh of more than 38 lakh appeals, or 3.2%. Moreover, 16.1 lakh appeals were filed to remove electors whom judicial officers had found eligible. Who authorised this on the ECI's behalf remains unanswered. Meanwhile, another 19.33 lakh electors on Delhi's draft rolls have been flagged for "logical discrepancies".

Fourth, centralisation. Changes to the rolls increasingly flow through the Electoral Roll Officers' Network (ERONet) database, overriding Electoral Registration Officers, who are the statutory authorities on eligibility. State election officials have complained that they cannot see centrally made changes to the rolls in their own constituencies.

Fifth, lack of a baseline. Without the latest Census – which has been delayed by the Centre – there is no firm population baseline to check the rolls. The ECI also dismisses projected population figures as mere estimates. For example, in Tamil Nadu, the final roll of 5.67 crore is about 33 lakh short of the projected 6.02 crore.

The impact of these flaws was drastic but varied across States. In Bihar, where migration for work is overwhelmingly male, more women than men were struck off the rolls, particularly those aged 18-29 years and recorded as "permanently shifted". The gender ratio in the final SIR rolls fell to 892 from 907 in the 2024 Lok Sabha rolls.

In West Bengal, statistical analyses by the Kolkata-based SABAR Institute, a public policy and research organisation, estimated that 65% of those deleted after adjudication for "logical discrepancies" were Muslims, despite Muslims accounting for roughly 27% of the State's population.

A deferential Court

For months, the Court confined itself to managerial interventions on the SIR. It ruled only on May 27, after Phase 2 had ended and Phase 3 was notified, upholding the SIR.

Legal scholars have raised three broad substantive objections to the judgment. First, Section 21(3) permits a special revision "for any constituency or part of a constituency" – an exceptional and targeted power. Yet, the Court allowed the ECI to use it for a State-wide exercise, freeing it from the Registration of Electors Rules governing ordinary revisions.

Second, rather than asking whether a less harmful method, such as door-to-door verification and enrolment, could achieve the same objective, the Court asked only whether the SIR was "manifestly excessive".

Third, the Court sidestepped its own three-judge ruling in *Lal Babu Hussein* (1995), which struck down a "sweeping" revision that demanded citizenship documents from nearly 18,000 residents of Delhi's Matia Mahal. The ruling, also incorporated into the ECI's Manual, held that a name on the electoral roll is presumed valid and can be removed only after notice and a hearing.

Essentially, the Court found that disenfranchisement was not "widespread or systemic" enough to warrant intervention, without specifying what would matter instead. The judgment emboldened the ECI to proceed with the flawed SIR in Phase 3, where deletions have risen sharply.

Dissent from within

Reports revealed that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi recorded at least 14 objections between October 2025 and August 2026. One concerned Form 6 being altered, without amending the rules, requiring applicants to state whether they or their parents or grandparents appeared on the "last SIR" roll. The ECI's response to the revelations was mere window-dressing with some administrative changes. As the two Commissioners constituted a majority, they should have used it to stop these decisions, but did not.

The Court is now hearing petitions concerning West Bengal and Delhi, as well as pleas seeking the CEC's suspension over the ECI's conduct. It should use these proceedings to revisit its judgment on review or before a Constitution Bench. It should halt the SIR and order an audit of rolls finalised so far before any further deletions. Enumeration should return to door-to-door verification by Booth Level Officers, while States going to the polls soon should use their pre-SIR rolls, updated with fresh enrolments.

Anything less would endorse a process that professes time and again that no eligible elector will be left out while patently doing the opposite. It has removed more than a lakh genuine voters for certain, and possibly crores. The ECI, built to widen India's adult franchise, has instead spent more than a year narrowing it.

srinivasan.vr@thehindu.co.in
ponvasanth.ba@thehindu.co.in

Calibrating India's inbound investment framework

Bharat Joshi

Director, ACTL, a logistics company, and the CEO of J Curve Ventures, an advisory firm

Following the successful 18th BRICS Summit, in New Delhi in September, Prime Minister Narendra Modi's planned December visits to Canada and Brussels, where formal free trade agreements (FTAs) are expected to be signed, signal consistency in institutionalising India's global economic footprint. The trade push, alongside domestic structural reforms and a new FTA strategy, has changed India's investment trajectory. Reserve Bank of India data show gross inward foreign direct investment (FDI) reached a record $94.8 billion in FY26. UNCTAD's World Investment Report 2026 notes India as 11th among the world's top FDI destinations, following a 44% rise in inflows.

India follows global trend

However, the report reveals that globally, international project finance remains roughly a quarter below its 2021 peak, a trend India reflects. In greenfield data centre investments (a focal sector across economic partnerships), India attracted approximately $7 billion during the first three quarters of 2025. While this placed India within the top 10, it trailed Thailand and Spain, and sat substantially behind South Korea's $21 billion, the United States's $29 billion, and France's $69 billion. What creates this lag between committed investment and its actual deployment in greenfield projects, particularly in India?

Investors believe incremental reform can ease the challenges behind this lag. In some ways, the remaining 'negotiations' will be internal – between the Centre and States, between the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and line Ministries, or between central rules and State notifications needed to enforce policy. Crucially, resolving these operational bottlenecks would benefit domestic enterprises as much as foreign investors. Commercial dispute resolution is faster than before, but India's courts still had nearly 48 million pending cases as of April, including about six million in High Courts. Reforms such as the Commercial Courts Act, 2015 and the Mediation Act, 2023 have helped, with institutional arbitration increasingly becoming the corporate default. Smaller enterprises, however, still rely on courts. Better staffing of commercial benches and mediation centres remains essential to reducing resolution times.

> Turning investment commitments into projects requires tackling State-level administrative bottlenecks

On the labour codes

This fragmentation is also mirrored in the rollout of the landmark labour codes. Parliament's consolidation of 29 central labour laws into four codes was a legislative milestone, with the Central Rules notified in May 2026. But since labour is on the Concurrent List, implementation depends on State notifications. Gujarat moved swiftly to notify rules under all four codes, while other industrial States are finalising theirs. For enterprises designing national human resource frameworks, this necessitates managing a messy transitional phase of varied State timelines.

On tax certainty, the Taxation Laws (Amendment) Act, 2021 effectively ended the ghost of retrospective tax disputes by withdrawing outstanding demands against entities such as Vodafone and Cairn Energy. The relaunch of the Vivad se Vishwas scheme has also helped reduce the broader direct-tax litigation backlog.

Compliance, however, has required recalibration. Mandatory BIS certification under Quality Control Orders (QCOs) was designed to safeguard consumers, but the framework expanded extensively. The Gauba Committee found QCOs had grown from fewer than 70 to nearly 790, covering raw materials and intermediate goods. For imported components, compliance costs rose to ₹20 lakh, with six- to eight-month certification timelines disrupting domestic MSME supply chains. In response, the government withdrew QCOs on critical intermediate goods, including PVC, aluminium and zinc, providing relief to manufacturers.

India's modern trade pacts now introduce binding investment targets. The EFTA agreement sets a historic $100-billion target, but investor-protection mechanisms remain a work in progress. As the India-EFTA TEPA lacks an independent bilateral investment dispute mechanism, Switzerland is separately negotiating a bilateral investment treaty. This could inform negotiations with the EU and the U.K.

Further, speeds remain uneven. The DPIIT is the nodal agency but not the decision-maker on approvals. A revised SOP issued in May 2026 sets a 12-week deadline, but compliance remains uneven. However, large-scale projects such as Tata Electronics' semiconductor facility in Dholera, Gujarat, demonstrate how effective administrative coordination can accelerate capital deployment.

Reform lessons from successes

India's reform agenda can draw lessons from past successes. Singapore's CECA has facilitated over $195 billion in cumulative FDI since 2000, including $19.8 billion last year. Its non-discrimination and investor-protection frameworks are a useful blueprint for treaty negotiations. Domestically, the mobile-phone industry shows the potential of coordinated policy: production has grown 33-fold since FY15, from ₹180 billion to ₹6.27 trillion, while exports reached ₹2.59 trillion. India is now the world's second-largest mobile-phone manufacturer by volume and meets 99.2% of domestic demand through local production.

India's rise to the 11th-largest FDI destination and the world's second-largest mobile-phone manufacturer reflects its resolve in addressing internal governance bottlenecks. These achievements underscore the long-term benefits of sustained institutional reform and free trade.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Due process for the voter

The debate over SIR should focus more on the eligible voter whose name has been deleted. With more than 13 crore names reportedly absent from the draft rolls, the fundamental democratic question is can an eligible citizen lose the right to vote because he cannot establish a decades-old electoral linkage, including where his parents voted? Electoral rolls must exclude ineligible persons, but protecting every eligible voter from wrongful exclusion is equally essential. The constitutional test is not merely whether the ECI has the power to revise the rolls, but whether every voter receives adequate notice, a fair opportunity to respond and a simple, timely mechanism to restore a wrongly deleted name.

A. Mariafrancis,
Chennai

Nana Patekar

The passing of veteran actor Nana Patekar marks the end of a remarkable chapter in cinema. At a time when celebrity culture often rewards glamour, he demonstrated that an actor could command respect through talent, simplicity and conviction.

Vidyasagar Reddy Kethiri,
New Delhi

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Are legal guarantees insufficient in abolishing untouchability?

Valerian Rodrigues

Former Professor at Mangalore University and Jawaharlal Nehru University and currently Professor Emeritus, St Aloysius (Deemed to be) University, Mangalore

Disha Wadekar

Supreme Court litigator with over 10 years of experience in constitutional, criminal and civil law. A Fulbright Scholar and LL.M. graduate of Columbia Law School

PARLEY

In August this year, the performance of a "purification" ritual by certain Hindu groups in Uttarakhand, at the location where Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge, who belongs to a Dalit community, addressed a public rally, led to a national conversation on the practice of untouchability. This discourse was shaped as Opposition Congress leaders accused the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) dispensation of practising caste discrimination. The Uttarakhand BJP chief defended the ritual saying that it was meant to "cleanse" the area of the ideas that Mr. Kharge was espousing at the rally. After a sustained campaign from Opposition leaders and civil society actors, an FIR was registered in the matter. So, are legal guarantees insufficient in abolishing untouchability? Valerian Rodrigues and Disha Wadekar discuss the question in a conversation moderated by **Abhinay Lakshman**. Edited excerpts:

Is the law sufficient to address caste-crimes such as untouchability or practices that uphold the purity-pollution paradigm?

Valerian Rodrigues: I feel that legal guarantees are necessary, but not adequate. Two dimensions to untouchability have emerged over time – one is that of Baba Saheb Ambedkar's, that it is necessary to abolish untouchable practices; and the other is the one argued by Mahatma Gandhi, that social conscience needs to change. After Independence, the legal regime has come but the social conscience in India remains frozen.

Disha Wadekar: Approaching this a little differently, the answer lies in understanding the nature of law itself – what it can and cannot do. Starting with whether the law is sufficient assumes that formal law is some embodiment of perfection meant to rectify an imperfect society. But that is not the case. Social laws have been in place for thousands of years. We should start by asking ourselves about the law of caste and how it has been in operation for thousands of years. There is this concept of legal consciousness, which is shaped by the everyday experience of the law. Law is also very contextual, and so is its experience. It can be individualistic; it can be social. I think we need to first bring the law down from that pedestal that we have given it, and see its social interaction with the structures of caste, patriarchy, and Brahmanism. It is important to note that this does not mean that modern law is not important. The only break to the law of caste has been that of the formal rule of law. When the British brought that to us, from an anti-caste perspective, for Dalits, this rule of law regime was emancipatory. It is extremely important. But is it sufficient to annihilate caste? That is probably the question that we should be asking ourselves.

Uttarakhand Pradesh Congress leaders organise a sit-in protest at the CM's residence, demanding action against those responsible for the 'purification' ritual conducted at Ramlila Maidan, in Dehradun on September 7. ANI

Clearly, India has, from its inception, tried to wield the Constitution and the law to deal with these social behaviours. What have these laws achieved thus far?

VR: We need to extend the regime of law beyond what is formally stated in the legislation and in the Constitution. But I would still make that distinction between social practices to which I would not ascribe the legal norms as strongly as to the formal legal regime. The legal regime in India against untouchability has done two things. One, it has checkmated, to a great extent, much wider and obvious practices of untouchability. Secondly, it has provided instruments to conscious sections of Dalits and non-Dalits to fight against practices of untouchability, even though the resources are extremely limited and the odds they confront are huge. The legal regime in India stands by the rights of Dalit communities as compared to, let's say 100 years ago, from the time of the Poona Pact. You will find that certain obvious practices of untouchability such as preventing people from taking the water of wells in public places, access to public places, access to public institutions, and the kind of violence that was let loose on Dalit workers in the countryside –that has declined a lot. We do not know what would have taken place if this was not the case.

Even though this progress is visible, how does one look at the ways in which discrimination itself has evolved since the legal regime came into being?

DW: Over the years, the evolution of

> Practices of untouchability in India are not merely social practices; they are embedded strongly in our social norms. Dr. Ambedkar somewhere calls it "notions in the mind". This is a notion that is instilled in the mind of both Dalits and non-Dalits
> **VALERIAN RODRIGUES**

discriminatory practices can be categorised into two sections. One is the more traditional forms of atrocities which Mr. Rodrigues was referring to earlier. The other, in my opinion, would be a reactionary form of atrocity. And that is where social mobility has to be considered. The Dalits' social mobility has increased after the Constitution came into force, and that mobility has led to discontent amongst oppressor communities. One instance of that can be seen in the *Reservation Hatao Andolan* that has come up. And then there are newer forms of atrocities that are happening which come from a sentiment of "how dare you sit next to me?" or "how dare you share the same privilege as me?" or "how dare you socially mobilise?"

So then, how does one analyse this interplay between the law being emancipatory but also its use becoming the trigger for such reactionary atrocities?

VR: Practices of untouchability in India are not merely social practices; they are embedded strongly in our social norms. Dr. Ambedkar somewhere calls it "notions in the mind". This is a notion that is instilled in the mind both in Dalits and non-Dalits. How do you get out of it? I feel that we have not embraced practices which I think were tried out from 1939 to 1949, to some extent, of reopening Indian society and making this an internal value. Now, how do you convert these values into social practices? In a country like India, it is an extremely complex question. We should have adopted institutions and practices which do not allow such notions to take root in children at all. There is very little, even in urban spaces, mixture and intermingling across castes. Practices such as inter-dining and inter-marriages have disappeared from public spaces in India. We need to intervene with very different instrumentalities, and this is a task the state needs to encourage, but it is also beyond the state. Non-state actors need to be made alive to this particular problem. And the setting in India today is not conducive to that kind of social reopening.

DW: There is an argument to be made that the answer is outside of the uniform carceral potential of the law. But before we even go there, I believe there also needs to be a reimagining of what we can do within the law. There is a lot of scholarly material that shows that using criminal law for stricter punishments, whether in cases of gender crimes, caste crimes, or other social crimes, does not have the result that one would presume. The reason is that the people adjudicating these cases are not just judicial actors but also social actors. The criminal law regime, which was superimposed, does not change the mindset of the judges. So, it has actually become counterproductive. And we are going to have to deal with these real questions. Not to say that all of this needs to be changed. But increasingly we are seeing across the world that marginalised communities are not relying on carceral regimes. The argument here is that there is an inherent requirement in criminal law, that if something needs to be punished, it must be proved beyond a reasonable doubt. This is needed, of course; we shouldn't try to undo that. And even though such criminal law provisions have a huge deterrence value as we have seen, is it 100% going to eliminate atrocities? It's not. Is it going to eliminate some form of atrocities? In some instances, probably yes. But beyond criminal law, can we look at civil law and civil remedies?

There is this entire arena of civil law, civil regime and civil punishments that we have not explored, where the burden is not that high to prove a form of discrimination whether it's caste-based discrimination or gender-based discrimination. The POSH Act has done it. And we need to look at really localised forms of dispute resolution mechanisms, examples of which can be seen in certain types of Sharia *adalats* (courts), which Muslim women have felt empowered to approach when they felt they couldn't go to court, or in the ways in which Gram Sabhas have become centres for dispute resolution at the local levels.

How do we move towards making Indian society more conducive for the kind of social reopening that you spoke of?

VR: In the way India has dealt with this, we forgot that there is something called the "common" that we need to reinforce. There are institutions that can do this but we have not explored those. For instance, our textbooks, can be changed a great deal, our teacher training at the lowest level can be changed, and this concept of the "common" can be established in urban planning as well, where we tend to see that often Dalits are made to congregate into certain spaces.

This normalcy of 'Dalits should have their own Anganwadis, or their own water taps, etc', has to be broken, if we are ever going to make an assault on untouchable practices.

To listen to the full interview
Scan the code or go to the link
www.thehindu.com

NOTEBOOK

When Jeffrey Archer lay on the floor

Recollecting an interview with the bestselling author that turned into an argument – not about books, but cricket

Srinivasa Ramanujam

There are a dozen ways in which an interviewee can react when you provoke them a little. Lying sprawled across the floor is not one of them.

But that is exactly what happened when I went to meet author Jeffrey Archer in 2013, as part of a regular workday at another media organisation.

It was a sunny morning when I sauntered into the Taj Coromandel in Chennai to meet the writer of *Best Kept Secret*, the third book in 'The Clifton Chronicles' series. Growing up, Archer's work occupied prime space on my bookshelves, jostling for space with the works of Sidney Sheldon, Michael Crichton, and John Grisham. So meeting him was going to be extra special.

Nervous, I arrived well in advance for the meeting. While waiting in the lobby and scrolling through the day's newspapers, which carried detailed reports about the India-Australia cricket match being played in Mohali, a thought struck me: Archer was an ardent cricket fan.

I remember reading somewhere about his passion for English county cricket. He had played the game in some capacity in his younger days. He also admired players from the sub-continent, such as Sachin Tendulkar and Rahul Dravid. I was determined to use that as my ice-breaker.

When my turn came, I was ushered into his room by an eager PR professional. I introduced myself and, looking at the television in his room, which was showing highlights of the previous day's play, remarked how good India had been on the cricket field in recent times.

Archer looked me straight in the eye and got up. Without batting an eyelid, he lay on the floor and started to brush the carpet. "This," he thundered, while I stared at him helplessly, "is how you wipe your cricket grounds."

Wielding an imaginary towel and mop, Archer continued the act till he reached my legs. I sat transfixed, my trepidation about the interview growing.

"Rubbish," he continued in a thick English accent, "Mops and buckets...rubbish." He was referring to how Indian groundsmen sweep and sponge off rainwater from the playing arena, taking off from that first day of the rain-hit Test match at Mohali.

The Indian cricket fan in me was growing annoyed, even a little angry. I gently reminded him that India had already won a couple of matches in that series, only for him to retort in a booming voice: "But you lost against England at home – so don't get me started on that!"

There was pin-drop silence. The PR professional, who had parked himself in the corner of the room, froze. I had just had an unnecessary argument with a globally famous personality on a topic that had absolutely nothing to do with the book he had written.

I sat at the edge of my seat, my hands shivering. The photographer who had accompanied me had his finger on the shutter button, but wasn't clicking, lest the noise upset the author.

All this while, Archer remained on the floor. He was looking up at me in anticipation. Those few seconds inside the large, lavish suite at Taj Coromandel felt like an eternity.

Archer realised that the tension in the room was building up. He quickly rose, and patted my shoulder in reassurance. I let out a sigh of relief. My conversation with the legendary author would not turn out to be so bad after all.

I finally let out a weak smile when he said: "Shall we begin the interview?"

srinivasa.r@thehindu.co.in

PICTURE OF THE WEEK

Students at the Bastille

A reawakening of history: Protesters hold a banner at the base of Bastille square's monument during a demonstration, part of a nationwide day of action, called by high school students in France who have been demanding better learning conditions through protests that have been punctuated by violent confrontations, in Paris on October 8. AFP

FROM THE ARCHIVES The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 9, 1976

India to regulate entry of Britons

New Delhi, October 8: India will soon introduce the system of entry permits for visitors from such of those Commonwealth countries as have similar restrictions in regard to Indian citizens.

Visas are not required to be taken out by citizens of Commonwealth countries for visits from one country to another but, in some cases, the permit system had been introduced to regulate entry. For instance, Indians going to the U.K. were required to take out permits, while there was no such restriction on British nationals or British passport-holders coming to India. It is now proposed to have entry permits on a reciprocal basis in regard to those countries of the Commonwealth which have been regulating the entry of Indians.

This proposal is "under active consideration" said Mr. Om Mehta, Minister of State for Home Affairs, who has just returned from the U.K.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 9, 1926

Is cancer hereditary?

The first conclusions reached as a result of the expedition made by Dr. Louis Sambon, during the spring, summer and autumn of 1925 to study cancer from the epidemiological standpoint have now been published in the Journal of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene. Among his conclusions is the striking one that "cancer houses" and "cancer areas," though they may be misnomers, definitely exist.

From Page One

GST refund rules eased; arrest powers removed

The rate decisions will now come up before the Council only once a year and will be implemented from the start of the subsequent financial year, the Union Finance Minister said.

She noted that, beyond the GST Council, the Union government has decided to introduce a faceless assessment system for the Central GST system, similar to the one currently in place for income tax. A framework for this will be issued for public consultation before Budget 2027, and the system will be implemented during 2027-28.

"The process reforms have been driven by the principle of trust," Ms. Sitharaman said. "The businesses and taxpayers have to be trusted... and we shouldn't be too intrusive."

The GST Council has approved a system that will provide greater certainty about the documents required during registration. According to the government, 61% of taxpayers are granted automatic registration within three working days.

The upgraded system approved by the Council is expected to streamline the process for the remaining low-risk taxpayers by avoiding queries and rejections.

The Council has also said that goods moving between States can be inspected, detained or seized only by the officer of the supplier or destination State and not by any officer in between. Further, goods can now be intercepted only on the basis of "specific intelligence" and only with the authorisation of a Joint Commissioner-level officer. "This prevents arbitrary checks by GST enforcement wings that affect the movement of goods from one State to another," Ms. Sitharaman said. "This would significantly improve the ease of movement of goods."

INDIA bloc protests at Rajghat against CEC

Leaders of the Opposition bloc are likely to march towards Rashtrapati Bhavan after assembling at Parliament House in the morning. Senior leaders, including Mamata Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee, may join the march, even though President Droupadi Murmu has not yet given an appointment to meet them.

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Mr. Kumar of "hijacking" the country by allegedly indulging in vote theft.

Lunch at Connaught Place

In a replay of Wednesday's outreach, Mr. Kharge hosted a lunch for Opposition MPs and leaders at Moets restaurant in the Outer Circle of Connaught Place. In a show of Opposition unity, leaders of the Samajwadi Party, Shiv Sena (UBT) and the Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) were present at Thursday's lunch.

Interacting with reporters after the lunch, Mr. Gandhi targeted Mr. Modi, Mr. Shah, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat and Mr. Kumar, accusing them of "destroying" the Constitution. He claimed that around 300 MPs wanted to hold a peaceful *dharna* on the first day, but were stopped near the Election Commission's office, while on the second day, they were prevented from going to Jantar Mantar and were "beaten up".

From Connaught Place, the Opposition leaders travelled to Rajghat in air-conditioned buses.

Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said the INDIA bloc had sent a message by holding the protest at Rajghat. "The entire democracy has been completely finished by Mr. Modi and Mr. Shah through Gyanesh Kumar. We have come here to pray to the Mahatma," he said.

SC seeks tighter measures for safety after Delhi rape cases

Top court orders enhanced patrolling around educational institutions, stringent verification of drivers operating public transport and cab services, and stepping up of emergency response

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The directions follow the court's September 28 order taking *suo motu* cognisance of rape cases in Delhi-NCR. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

In a slew of sweeping measures to curb sexual offences in the national capital, the Supreme Court has ordered enhanced patrolling around educational institutions, stringent verification of drivers operating public transport and app-based cabs, real-time monitoring of vehicle-tracking and SOS systems, and action against establishments serving liquor unlawfully.

A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran observed that the recurrence of sexual offences in public spaces, despite existing protocols such as anti-eve-teasing squads, called into question whether these measures were being implemented "with the degree of consistency, supervision and accountability" required.

The court accordingly made the Chief Secretary and the Delhi Police Commissioner responsible for filing periodic compliance reports, warning that the two officers would be held "personally answerable" for any lapses.

"There shall be enhanced beat patrolling on an immediate basis, across the NCT of Delhi, more particularly around educational institutions (including schools, colleges, universities and coaching institutions) and other zones which get flagged under the vulnerability mapping exercise," the Bench directed, while adding that the police chief must apprise the court whether control-room command centres or "war rooms" were operational in the capital and detail the protocols for real-time coordination and emergency response.

The latest directions follow the court's September 28 order taking *suo motu* cognisance of a spate of rape cases reported across Delhi-NCR. The court said the intervention was aimed at strengthening immediate crime-prevention and emergency-response mechanisms, while requiring the authorities to identify gaps in existing policies and their implementation.

Underlining the importance of preventive policing, the Bench referred to the "Broken Windows theory" of policing, noting that seemingly minor administrative lapses such as unattended streetlights, dysfunctional CCTV cameras, dark stretches and unresolved public complaints could eventually create a "heightened perception of insecurity" among citizens and deter them from using public spaces, fueling a "self-reinforcing cycle" that provides greater scope for crime.

Verification of drivers

Notably, the court also directed strict verification of drivers and assistants operating government and private buses, cabs, taxis and autorickshaws, including vehicles linked to app-based aggregators such as Ola, Uber and Rapido.

The court directed the authorities to file comprehensive, district-wise status reports by November 6, detailing compliance with its earlier and latest directions, measures still pending, and reasons for any delay. It posted the matter for further hearing on November 16.

Campaign against ECI 'destabilising', say former judges

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Electronic Voting Machines are blamed only after defeat. Victories won on the same machines go unquestioned

FORMER JUDGES IN AN OPEN LETTER

Over 40 former Supreme Court and High Court judges have raised concerns over a "calculated campaign driven by vested political interests, with little regard for the potentially devastating consequences of destabilising the world's largest democracy".

"A party that governed this nation for over five decades now claims that the very system which elected it is rigged. It does not act alone. Activist outfits with a long record of selective litigation lend these claims a veneer of legality," said 42 former judges in an open letter, without naming the party. Among the signatories are former Supreme Court judges Hemant Gupta and Pankaj Mithal; former High Court Chief Justices B.C. Patel, Subhro Kamal Mukherjee and Permod Kohli.

"They file petition, one after the other. They seldom file proof. The courtroom becomes a stage, and when the judgment is delivered, it is criticised whenever it does not serve their interests. Vitriol is then amplified and disseminated on an industrial scale, with the deliberate aim of eroding public confidence in a widely trusted judicial system," the letter said.

Stating that allegations of "vote theft" were being made at press conferences and not before courts, the former judges said, "When the Commission seeks a sworn declaration, none is filed. Electronic Voting Machines are blamed only after defeat. Victories won on the same machines go unquestioned." They said attacks on constitutional institutions had gone beyond legitimate criticism, with election officials facing public accusations and threats. They also urged the media to verify claims before reporting them.

Global cooperation is needed now to tackle cybercrime: PM

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Narendra Modi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday called for global cooperation on cybercrime and financial cyber fraud, and said that "technology achieves scale only when it earns trust".

"Cyber fraud and cybercrime respect no boundaries; a person sitting in one country can get help from a second country to commit a crime in a third country ... It is necessary that we work on a global framework for this. Governments, technology companies, telecom operators and financial institutions will all have to join this framework," he said at the 10th edition of the India Mobile Congress.

Mr. Modi said that India had achieved a large amount of digitisation in recent years. "Until a decade ago, the digital divide was a very big challenge in India," he said, adding, "Through the Digital India campaign, we resolved to change this, and we put the mobile phone at its centre. This was a very big effort towards the democratisation of technology. For this, every necessary reform was made in the telecom sector, and infrastructure was expanded. We focused on ensuring that mobile phones and other telecom hardware are made in India itself."

Setting standards

Union Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia said in his remarks at the event that "the Bharat 6G Alliance from India" has established 7,700 patents, with most being registered internationally. "It is our goal to be seated at the standard-setting table," he said.

"One GB of data would cost ₹268 in 2014," Mr. Scindia said, adding, "Today, 12 years later, one GB of data costs only ₹8 – the cheapest data capability across the world. And combine that with adoption. In 2014, the average monthly data usage per customer was only 0.26 GB. Twelve years later, it has grown 140 times to 36 GB per individual across the length and breadth of our country."

Sindoor showcased India's air defence capabilities: IAF chief

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh inspecting a guard of honour at the 94th Airforce Day Celebrations in Ghaziabad on Thursday. R.V. MOORTHY

The Indian Air Force's "destructive power" and air defence capabilities were showcased to the world during Operation Sindoor, Air Chief Marshal A. P. Singh said, as the IAF marked its 94th Air Force Day at Hindon Air Base.

Addressing the celebrations, Air Chief Marshal Singh said the world had witnessed "firsthand the destructive power" of the IAF during the military conflict with Pakistan.

He said the IAF's theme of being "Infallible, Impervious and Precise" was not merely a tagline but a manifestation of its strength and resolve. Operation Sindoor had demonstrated the Force's speed of combat operations and its ability to respond effectively to emerging threats, the Air Chief said.

"Our operational capabilities are growing in the right direction," he said, asserting that the IAF remained "alert, committed and ready" to meet any challenge. "We will leave no stone unturned to meet and exceed expectations," he added.

The Air Chief described the IAF as an "exceptional, capable, network-centric, and multi-domain force" that had evolved over 94 years into one of the finest air forces in the world.

With his superannuation due on October 31, Air Chief Marshal Singh described serving as IAF chief as "my biggest fortune" and said it was a proud moment for him.

The celebrations featured a ceremonial parade and display of the IAF's combat capabilities. The Air Chief arrived at the venue in a 1960s-era car as three helicopters flew past in *Dhwaj* formation.

SC set to expand scrutiny of DGP appointment laws across country

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Jharkhand's Hemant Soren government locked horns with the Centre in the Supreme Court on Thursday over the appointment of Directors General of Police (DGPs), calling out the Union government's "special affection" for the State when others like Bihar had "worse" appointment laws. The confrontation erupted after the Union government moved the court against Jharkhand's 2025 law governing the appointment of DGPs.

Appearing before a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, for the Centre, sought a judicial declaration that the 'Selection and Appointment of Director General and Inspector General of Police, Jharkhand (Head of Police), Regulation of 2025' breached the apex court's judgment in *Prakash Singh versus Union of India*.

SC judgment

The 2006 judgment had mandated insulation of the police force from political influence. It laid down a transparent DGP appointment process followed by a minimum tenure of two years in office. Only senior police officers with a residual tenure of six months before normal retirement could be considered for the top post. The Centre contended that the appointment of Jharkhand's first woman DGP and incumbent Tadasha Mishra under the 2025 Regulation violated the *Prakash Singh* verdict.

At this juncture, senior advocate Kapil Sibal, for Jharkhand, turned the tables on the Centre by asking why it had no similar complaints about other States. He highlighted that West Bengal's DGP was appointed by the Election Commission of India in March 2026 even though the officer was due to retire the next month. Mr. Sibal accused the Centre of double standards, saying the Union government had extended his tenure by six months. "The Solicitor General may file a petition against that appointment [West Bengal] as well," Mr. Sibal challenged. Mr. Mehta clarified that he was holding the brief for the Centre, not himself.

'No dilution'

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, on the Bench, said the court was not bothered about who was in power in a particular State. "Our sole focus is that the law declared in *Prakash Singh* should not be diluted," Justice Bagchi said.

Mr. Mehta even suggested that the court must issue notice to all States to see if their laws were in line with *Prakash Singh* judgment. Consequently, the court requested its *amicus curiae*, senior advocate Raju Ramachandran, to take the help of the Union Public Service Commission and scrutinise police laws and DGP appointments nationwide.

The court asked Jharkhand, in the meanwhile, to revisit its 2025 Regulation.

Govt. notifies CAPF Act amid challenge pending before SC

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The Ministry of Home Affairs notified that the Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Act, 2026, will come into force from Thursday (October 8), nearly five months after the legislation was passed by Parliament, even as its constitutional validity is under challenge before the Supreme Court.

Serving CAPF officers have challenged the law, which will impact cadre management and the deputation of Indian Police Service (IPS) officers to senior positions in the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs). Among them is Central Reserve Police Force Assistant Commandant Bibhor Kumar Singh, a Shaurya Chakra awardee who lost his legs in an anti-Maoist operation in Bihar in 2022 and is the lead petitioner in one of the cases.

The notification assumes significance as the new law has emerged as a key issue in separate contempt proceedings concerning the implementation of the Supreme Court's May 23, 2025, judgment on cadre issues in the CAPFs. On September 30, a Bench of Justices Manoj Misra and Ujjal Bhuyan decided to hear the contempt petitions along with three writ petitions challenging the validity of the CAPF Act on October 15.

The contempt proceedings arise from allegations that the Union government has not fully implemented the May 2025 judgment, in which the Supreme Court directed that deputation of IPS officers to senior posts in the CAPFs be progressively reduced.

Airlines cancel and divert Riyadh flights

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

Air India Group and IndiGo on Thursday cancelled and diverted several services to Riyadh as carriers monitored an evolving regional situation, disrupting travel between India and the Saudi capital.

The disruption came after Houthi rebels attacked Saudi Arabia, with a missile fired towards Riyadh International Airport.

Air India said its flight AI2243, operating from Delhi to Riyadh, returned to Delhi on Thursday in the interest of passenger and crew safety. The service was subsequently cancelled, with full refunds offered to passengers.

The airline also announced that it was cancelling all flights to and from Riyadh until October 10, citing the developing situation in the region.

An IndiGo flight from Hyderabad to Riyadh was also diverted to Dammam.

APPEAL

Master Om Pratap Singh, Christian Medical College Hospital No.AK07843, 9 years has been Diagnosed Thalassemia major. This is a type of Life-Threatening Blood disorder. The best option for him would be to undergo Allogeneic Peripheral Blood Stem Cell Transplant (PBSCT). The estimated cost of PBSCT at this Hospital is Approximately Rs.16,00,000/-.

Please send donation however small by Cheque/D.D/M.O Fav. **Save Poor Lives** A/c Om Pratap Singh, **Our A/c Details:** S/B A/c No. 20000913487. S.B.I. R.A.Puram, IFSC CODE:SBIN0001855. Please Donate by G-pay No.9884607377, UPI Id: savepoorlives@oksbi. Donations are exempted under 80G of I.T.ACT.

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7,000 CRPF personnel moved to Delhi from Bengal, Chhattisgarh

CRPF personnel asked to carry latest anti-riot equipment, operational-scale weapons, prescribed ammunition; elaborate security arrangements being made in and around Jantar Mantar ahead of CJP protest tomorrow; Shah stays put in Delhi

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

At least 70 companies of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), comprising around 7,000 personnel, who are currently deployed in West Bengal and Chhattisgarh, are being mobilised for law-and-order duties in Delhi, ahead of the protest called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on October 10, according to two official communications issued on October 5 and 6.

The New Delhi district, where Jantar Mantar is located, has seen unprecedented security deployment since October 2. FILE PHOTO

A CRPF communication accessed by *The Hindu* asked the Chhattisgarh units to maintain full operational strength and carry the latest equipment, arms, and ammunition. The letter said that the deployment was being made on the instructions of the Union Home Ministry.

"All Companies shall be duly equipped with the latest Anti-Riot Equipment, operational-scale weapons and prescribed ammunition, as applicable. All personnel shall be properly briefed regarding the nature of duties, discipline and necessary security precautions to be observed during the subject deployment," the communication said. Each company comprises around 100 personnel.

On the Ministry's directions, elaborate security arrangements are being made in and around Jantar Mantar ahead of the October 10 march to demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar over allegations of irregularities during the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Visits cancelled

After the CJP issued a protest call on October 3, urging protesters to converge in Delhi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah cancelled his scheduled visits to Telangana, Meghalaya, and Mizoram on October 4 and 5. A proposed visit to Manipur on October 7 was also called off, and Mr. Shah has since stayed put in Delhi to monitor the situation, even as the Opposition INDIA bloc, led by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, has staged two street-protests in the past three days.

The New Delhi district, where Jantar Mantar, the designated protest site is located, has seen unprecedented security deployment since October 2, when Left parties, the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), and civil society groups staged protests against the CEC.

Jantar Mantar, which was also the site for the CJP's massive student protest that forced the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as Union Education Minister in July, has been blocked by the police since July 26, with no alternative venue provided for agitations. The Delhi Police have invoked Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, prohibiting processions, rallies, and dharnas in the area.

At least 40 CRPF companies are being de-inducted from West Bengal "in zero time" for further deployment in Delhi, while another 30 companies from the Chhattisgarh Sector have been asked to remain ready for deployment in the national capital.

The deployments are in addition to the Delhi Police and other Central Armed Police Force (CAPF) units, including the Rapid Action Force (RAF), the specialised anti-riot unit of the CRPF that came under a cloud for its use of pellet guns against unarmed protesters on July 20.

The CAPFs work under the command and control of the requisitioning authority during deployment, in this case, the Delhi Police.

CJP flags threat videos ahead of Delhi protest; police 'monitoring' posts

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Ahead of the October 10 protest at Delhi's Jantar Mantar, several videos containing threats of violence against demonstrators have circulated on social media, prompting the organisers to urge the Delhi Police to prevent those issuing threats from reaching the protest site.

> I have said this before and I am saying it again: the government wants to create major unrest in the country by pitting citizens against citizens
>
> **SAURAV DAS**
> CJP leader

In the videos making the rounds on X, men can be heard calling on people to gather at Jantar Mantar with batons and threatening to confront those participating in the demonstration.

In one video, a man using the handle 'Hindu Arun Yadav' is seen holding a baton and saying, "If 50 men of six feet each stand with me, I will not leave any of these cockroaches. Police is not needed."In another video, a man calls on people to join him on October 10 to "deal with" the protesters, alleging that they were using the issue of "vote chori" to create unrest. The videos come amid heightened political tensions surrounding the proposed protest being organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and other youth organisations.

CJP's Saurav Das urged the Delhi Police to take preventive action against those allegedly issuing threats. "I have said this before and I am saying it again: the government wants to create major unrest in the country by pitting citizens against citizens. They want to create a civil war-like situation. But we, the young generation, have always remained peaceful," he said.

Ashutosh Ranka, co-convenor of the CJP, also alleged that right-wing groups had been mobilised to target protesters. He said the CJP's protest would remain peaceful.

The Delhi Police said it was monitoring social media posts linked to the proposed protest and tracking those issuing threats or attempting to incite violence. "We are keeping a check on such individuals who are posting videos inciting the public. They are on our radar, and we are constantly keeping a tab. Anyone indulging in hate speech, violence or threatening behaviour is tracked and identified, and action will be taken if they act on any of it," a police official said.

The Rahul Gandhi show and Cong.'s INDIA bloc dilemma

NEWS ANALYSIS

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's politics of resistance has found expression on the streets of central Delhi, as Opposition parties belonging to the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) have been carrying out back-to-back protests demanding the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over allegations of vote 'chori' (theft) and electoral manipulation.

The dramatic visuals of Mr. Gandhi being carried by the Delhi Police personnel, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra lying on the road clutching a copy of the Constitution, and Congress general secretary K.C. Venugopal being tossed around by police personnel address one abiding concern among the supporters of the Congress: that the party does not know how to take the fight to the streets.

"We are only just getting started. This petty intimidation will not deter us. We will return in greater numbers tomorrow, the day after, and the day after – until the vote '*chors*' (thieves) face justice," Mr. Venugopal said. But a dilemma stares the Congress in the face: how does the party carry all its partners along without making them appear as marginal actors in what is increasingly becoming a Rahul Gandhi show?

Striking a balance: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi holding a flag as he stands atop a barricade during a protest on Tuesday. REUTERS

SP's absence

On Wednesday, the Samajwadi Party (SP), which has the highest number of Opposition MPs in the Lok Sabha after the Congress, did not attend a lunch hosted by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh played down the absence, saying the decision to send out the lunch invitation had been taken only late on Tuesday evening and that not every party could attend. "INDIA and other Opposition parties are united and stand in solidarity against vote 'chori', SIR and delimitation," Mr. Ramesh said.

SP chief Akhilesh Yadav was far more cryptic in explaining his party's absence from the protests.

"In the future, you might hear about a meeting over tea. We could all sit down and eat samosas too – if a 'samosa' slogan were to be raised, there's nothing wrong with that," he said. He is said to have been upset that the Congress leadership did not keep him and his colleagues in the loop about its plan to stage a dharna at Akashvani Bhavan.

The episode points to a larger challenge before the Congress. Mr. Gandhi's emergence as the face of the campaign against the Election Commission has given the protests a sharper edge. But it has also created unease among allies. The Congress, therefore, needs to strike a balance: occupy the pole position in the campaign while ensuring that the INDIA bloc does not begin to look like a platform for a single party or leader.

Delhi Police ramp up 'perception' campaign on social media platforms

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Police have stepped up their social media campaign ahead of the October 10 protest, with the perception management wing working to counter what officials describe as a "cyber warfare" campaign that, according to the force, had projected the police in a negative light during the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) July demonstration.

"Concerted efforts are being made to show the police's side of the story. The effort is being made based on the learning from our past experience during the July protest of the CJP, and efforts are being made to draw engagement on social media platforms," an official said.

The police began examining the performance of their social media content and why their version of events did not receive similar traction during the July protest. Another official close to the development said the force was working with Meta, X, and other social media platforms to examine why its content was not being amplified by their algorithms.

A series of videos showing personnel allegedly injured during protests, uniforms and badges that were torn, women officers being assisted after collapsing and instances of protesters allegedly pushing or resisting police personnel have been circulated via the official Delhi police handle on X.

Videos also include statements and assessments by senior police officials on incidents.

The police have identified at least 500 individuals who are associated with the protest and mobilisation. The list includes members of the CJP's core team, supporters and people associated with the organisers, including domestic workers, drivers and other staff, according to the document seen by *The Hindu*.

The force is monitoring at least 100 individuals who describe themselves as "independent journalists", officials said.

3 FIRs filed against Rahul, other leaders

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Three fresh FIRs have been registered against Congress leaders, including Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, in connection with the INDIA bloc's protest here on Wednesday, police sources said on Thursday. The cases relate to allegations of assaulting and obstructing police personnel deployed during the protest, damaging a police vehicle and staging an unauthorised protest, a police source said.

BJP questions Rahul's conduct with police

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The BJP on Thursday questioned the conduct of Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra with women police personnel during Wednesday's protest against alleged "vote theft" and the actions of the Election Commission of India (ECI).

At a press conference, the BJP showed video clips of alleged incidents, claiming that they exposed the Congress' "frustration and the arrogance of privileged dynastic politics".

BJP spokesperson Sidharth Yadav accused Mr. Gandhi of "inappropriately touching" one policewoman and Ms. Vadra of "elbowing" another.

"These are pictures of the anarchy being spread in the National Capital under the leadership of the Leader of the Opposition, Rahul Gandhi, and the Congress. There is no common citizen or representation of the general public in these protests," he said.

He said that Mr. Gandhi's irritation was coming to the fore because the country was progressing.

'Platforms must curb manipulated content'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Electronics and Information Technology Ministry on Thursday urged social media platforms to curb "manipulated or out-of-context content," on top of AI-generated deepfakes that are already liable for takedown notices under amendments to the Information Technology (Intermediary Liability and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021 that were passed earlier.

The advisory was first reported by tech policy news portal MediaNama.

"Such content, particularly when presented as current or authentic information, has the potential to cause public confusion, create apprehension, disturb public order and social tranquillity, and contribute to law-and-order concerns," the advisory said.

The edict comes ahead of the October 10 protest planned by the Cockroach Janta Party.

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
HE-SCH-PLAN-0037-2026/ 54191/HE., Bhubaneswar, Dated : 08/10/2026
Corrigendum-II
NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR MAHARAJA SRIRAM CHANDRA BHANJA DEO UNIVERSITY, MAYURBHANJ UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BALESHWAR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA.
RFP No. PM-USHA:04/2026 Date: 05.09.2026

Sl. No.	RFP Cl.No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Modified vide Corrigendum I, dated 24.09.2026	Now Modified Provisions
1	DATA SHEET (Sl. No.7 & 8)	4	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 28/09/2026 (till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 12/10/2026 (till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 03/11/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		4	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 30/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 14/10/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 04/11/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.
Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA/PM-USHA
11001/364/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0071

CGHIDB
CHHATTISGARH HOUSING AND INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT BOARD
DIVISION-3 MOULSHREE VIHAR, VIP ROAD, RAIPUR
Advt.No. 407
E-TENDER FOR QUEEN'S CLUB OF INDIA, VIP ROAD, RAIPUR
Chhattisgarh Housing and Infrastructure Development Board invites the tender for "Selection of an Agency for Development, Operation and Maintenance of a top-end cosmopolitan Social and Health clubhouse **"Queen's Club of India"**, located at VIP Road, Raipur, Chhattisgarh, on license, Development, Operation and Transfer (LDOT) basison PPP mode".
For bid processing fee, bid security, eligibility criteria and other details as given in the RFP document. please visit the **website https://cghb.gov.in & http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in**for details. The bidder may also contact the Executive Engineer, Chhattisgarh Housing and Infrastructure Development Board, Division-3, Moulshree Vihar, Raipur over contact number 9753266721/6265731603
Tenderers shall download tender from cge-procurement website.
- Date and Time of Pre-bid meeting- at 12:00 PM on 16th October 2026 at Sector-19, Paryawas Bhawan, CGHIDB Head Office, Nava Raipur Atal Nagar
- Last Date and Time of online Pre-bid queries submission- on or before the above mentioned date & time.
- Last Date for Online submission of Tender - Till 03:00 PM on 30th October 2026

Note: Email id for submission of pre bid queries: cghbdiv03@gmail.com
The details of tender and terms & conditions are available on the e-Procurement website **https://eproc.cgstate.gov**.in Any amendment/corrigendum in the tender documents, will only be uploaded on the e-Procurement website and shall not be published in any newspaper.
Samvad-49358/5 EE, CGHIDB, Div-3 Raipur

ED1-8545/23 & ED1-2460/26
Dated: 08.10.2026
THRISSUR CORPORATION - ELECTRICITY DEPARTMENT
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ED1-8545/23
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ED1-2460/26
Supply of RMU.
Last Date : 19.10.2026
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log on to www.etenders.kerala.gov.in

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DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
CMG, SDSC - SHAR SRIHARIKOTA - 524124
Brief E- TENDER NOTICE: CORRIGENDUM-I (SALE EXTENSION)
No: e-Tender Notice No.CMG/C/CON/268721(I) Dt: 07.10.2026
Refer to Tender No. CMG/C/CON/268721 dated. 21.09.2026. Name of work: "Miscellaneous balance works (Sewer pipeline, 2 Nos. of sewage collection wells) at Visitors Complex, SDSC SHAR" (Est. cost ₹ 44 Lakhs);
Sale period extended up to 16.10.2026
Interested tenderer may visit www.isro.gov.in or www.tenderwizard.com/ISRO for details.
Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/SDSC SHAR

Office of The Chief Engineer, Water Resources Zone, Kota
क्रमांक: F.143/CEWRZ/BRN/e-NIB-17/2026-27/12731 दि:29.09.2026
e-NIB 17 of 2026-27
Bid for Repairing of Sorkhand Talab and Construction of drainage channel at downstream of Sorkhand Talab Tehsil Anta District Baran (Rs. 319.14 Lakh) **including GST & 18%** is invited from interested bidders from 01.10.2026 (9:30 Hr.) to 22.10.2026 till 18:00 Hr other particulars, terms & - conditions may be seen on the procurement portal https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in & https://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in, www.dipr.rajasthan.gov.in & www.water.rajasthan.gov.in.
UBN No WRD2627WSOB00720 Chief Engineer
DIPR/C/17176/2026 Water Resources Zone, Kota

INBRIEF

Govt. to cap trade margins at 30% of MRP for cancer drugs

In a bid to make cancer treatment more affordable and reduce patients' out-of-pocket expenditure, the Union government has decided to cap trade margins at 30% of the maximum retail price (MRP) for all non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs. The measure will cover branded and generic drugs, domestically manufactured and imported medicines, and patented and non-patented products. An expert committee under the Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) will finalise the list of medicines to be brought under the measure. The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA), found that the average trade mark-up on non-scheduled anti-cancer medicines was around 170%, with mark-ups reaching up to 700% in some cases.

Govt. launches JOSH teams to accelerate TB elimination

The Union Health Ministry is engaging with youth volunteers to find people with tuberculosis (TB) who may be missing from the health system. JOSH teams of the National Cadet Corps (NCC) and MY Bharat volunteers will be deployed for household-level outreach in 55 districts across 11 States and Union Territories. Health Minister J.P. Nadda launched the JOSH (Joint Squad for Health) teams under the TB Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan on Thursday. The teams will work at block and ward levels to identify people with symptoms, encourage testing and support so they can complete treatment. The government's emphasis is on active case finding, with the Health Minister stating that people could be living with TB without recognising their symptoms and therefore remain outside the formal healthcare system.

Indian cinema's quintessential maverick

For Nana Patekar, acting was never merely performance but an uncompromising confrontation with life; he chose characters that defied easy categorisation and bridged parallel and mainstream cinema with his intense style, even as he became embroiled in the #MeToo controversy

Anuj Kumar

A tempestuous maestro who stripped acting of its artifice, Nana Patekar passed away at his Goa residence during the early hours of Thursday, after a cardiac arrest. Patekar, 75, was brought to a private hospital after he was found unconscious at his apartment in Dona Paula, near Panaji region.

Shekhar Salkar, Chief of Oncology Department at Manipal Hospital, said, "He was in an unresponsive state when the medical team was called at home... he was given CPR for almost 45 minutes to 1 hour. He was declared dead at 5:20 a.m." A medico-legal case has been registered in this connection, and he added that a post-mortem would be conducted.

From the terrifying vulnerability of *Parinda* (1989), the primal scream against communalism in *Krantiveer* (1994), the icy gaze of an encounter specialist in *Ab Tak Chhappan* undone by the system, to the tragic grandeur of *Natsamrat* (2016), Patekar harnessed visceral rage and colloquial realism on screen, redefining the contours of the screen hero and supporting actor. Over a career lasting more than four decades, his distinctive style bridged parallel art-house movements and mainstream commercial cinema.

Patekar actively resisted Bollywood's assembly-line casting and chose characters which defied easy categorisation. The three-time National Award and four-time Filmfare winner could discern which characters would stay with audiences and create a meaningful intervention. It meant that while the films aged, the characters remained relevant.

If in *Krantiveer*, he exposed the hypocrisy of demagogues in popular idiom, then in the deeply philosophical *Prahaar* (1991), a film he also directed, he redefined nationalism. In his second spring, he chose *Sankalp*, his last collaboration with Prakash Jha, which drew comparisons to Chanakya and revolutionary leader Jayaprakash Narayan.

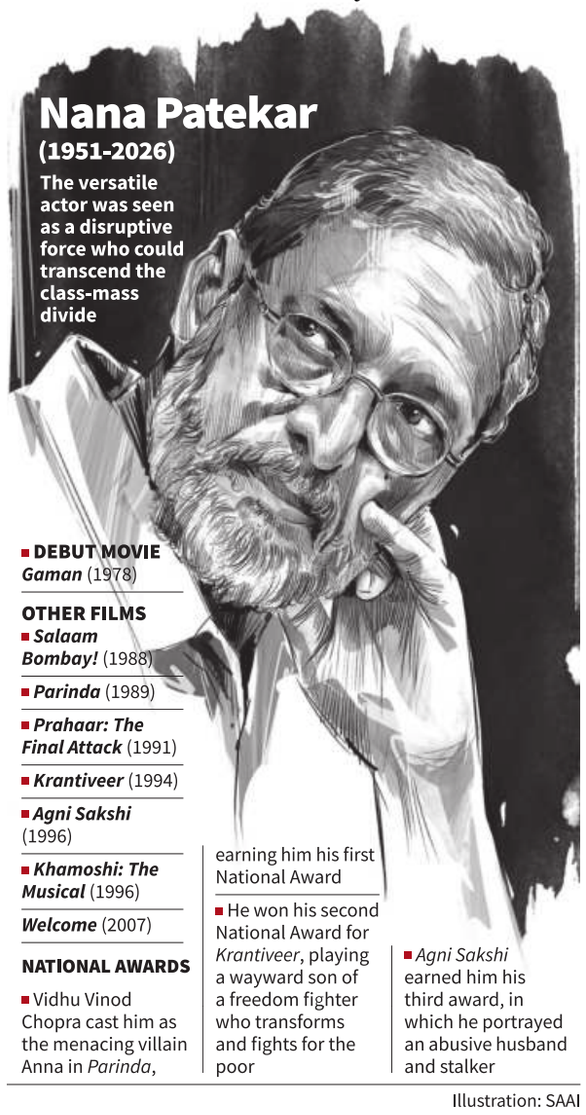


Illustration: SAAI

Breaking barriers

Actors and filmmakers across generations looked up to him as a disruptive force who could break the class-mass barrier. Whether it was his furious rant in *Yeshwant*, capturing the grinding exhaustion of an ordinary citizen as he explains how a mosquito makes a man impotent, or his blistering comment on bigotry in *Krantiveer*, where he points out the shared identity of human blood, he could curdle emotions at will.

Born in a modest household in a village in Raigad district of Maharashtra, Patekar imbibed a love for visual and performing arts from his father, who ran a small textile business. His father's untimely demise and the family's financial condition pushed Patekar to paint posters and billboards. The passion led him to J.J. School of Arts and inter-collegiate theatre events.

Soon, theatre legend Vijaya Mehta discovered him. In *Hamidabai Chi Kothi* and *Purush*, he left audiences spellbound with his intensity.

Old timers still get goosebumps talking about Patekar's depiction of tyrannical antagonist Gulab Rao in *Purush*. Years later, a new set of audiences got a whiff of Gulab when Patekar turned up as an obsessive husband in *Agni Sakshi* (1996). Stage also shaped his personal life – he met his wife, Neelakanti Patekar, an accomplished actor herself.

Nudged by Smita Patil to spread his wings, it was N. Chandra's *Ankush* (1986) that brought Patekar to living rooms, impressing with his depiction of an unemployed young man scarred by the realisation that honesty is punished while corruption thrives.

His portrayal of a deeply cynical Ravi led Vidhu Vinod Chopra to cast him as the psychotic underworld don Anna Seth in *Parinda*. Subverting typical villain tropes, he gave menace a deeply vulnerable face, earning him his first National Film Award. Before he could be bracketed, Patekar delivered a masterfully poetic and whimsical performance as the Rainmaker in Amol Palekar's *Thoda Sa Roomani Ho Jayen* (1990), proving he could fascinate entirely through lyrical charm.

Quiet sensitivity

Even when his reputation for depicting explosive anger in films like *Angaar* was at its peak, he showed quiet sensitivity in Sanjay Leela Bhansali's *Khamoshi: The Musical* (1996). When he switched to comedy with Anees Bazmee's *Welcome*, he inverted his signature traits to create one of the most enduring comedic transformations on screen. Throughout it all, the Padma Shri remained firmly rooted in Marathi theatre and cinema. In *Natsamrat*, his iconic speech "*Kuni ghar deta ka ghar?*" (Will someone give me a home?) continues to echo.

Beyond the arc lights, Patekar actively championed agrarian rights, secularism, and institutional transparency. Alongside actor Makarand Anaspure, he co-founded the Naam Foundation, an NGO dedicated to supporting drought-hit farmers. While maintaining close friendships with politicians, he resisted the ruling party's political overtures and critiqued systemic failures.

An active sportsman, Patekar's unforgiving physical schedule informed the mechanics of his craft. At times, Patekar seemed to treat his famous monologues like an athletic sequence.

His career was, however, not without controversy. Patekar was a central figure at the inception of India's #MeToo movement when a female actor accused him of sexually harassing and intimidating her on the sets of a film. He denied the allegations, and the Mumbai Police found the evidence insufficient to prosecute, but the incident fractured his image.

The tag of an erratic, hot-tempered individual, once seen as a charming artistic quirk, was suddenly viewed through a more critical lens.

Form panel to check pharma practices, SC directs govt.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Underlining the need to strengthen existing regulatory regime to curb unethical pharmaceutical marketing practices, , the Supreme Court on Thursday directed the Union government to constitute an expert committee within two weeks. The committee has been asked to consult stakeholders and submit its recommendations within two months of its first meeting. The top court was hearing petitions filed by the Federation of Medical and Sales Representatives' Associations of India (FMRAI) and others.

72 lakh teachers get training to identify disability in students

Maitri Porecha
NEW DELHI

In a nationwide outreach covering up to 60,000 schools and 72 lakh teachers, the Education Ministry has trained teachers to identify children with probable disability conditions using PRASHAST, a school-based screening tool.

"Department of School Education has been conducting continuous sensitisation of general teachers on inclusive education through PRASHAST for the past three months," a senior Ministry official said.

PRASHAST is a digital tool to help identify children with 21 disability conditions listed under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (RPwD) Act, 2016.

"Many of these conditions are not easily identifiable, especially those without visible symptoms, as schools often lack systematic tools to identify such needs early," the official added.

Checklists for teachers

The tool's two-part checklist enables teachers to screen students based on observable indicators, while special educators validate cases and facilitate referrals for medical assessment, wherever required.

AI, medicine in focus at *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The convergence of artificial intelligence, medicine, and engineering is ushering in a new era of healthcare. *The Hindu* Sustainability Dialogues, to be held on October 13, brings together experts to explore how technology can drive smarter, more sustainable healthcare while keeping it ethical, inclusive, and human-centred. The event will be hosted by *The Hindu* Group, in association with the Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences (SIMATS).

Centred on the theme "The Future of Medicine: Harnessing AI for Better Healthcare", the initiative will bring together leading voices from healthcare, academia, technology, and industry to examine emerging challenges and opportunities that could shape a sustainable, equitable, and future-ready healthcare ecosystem.

The inaugural session will feature K.G. Arunraj, Tamil Nadu Minister for Health, Medical Education, and Family Welfare, as the chief guest, who will deliver the keynote address. N.M. Veeraiyan, Chancellor of SIMATS, Chennai, will deliver the special address.

A key highlight of the event will be a special fireside chat titled "Future Healthcare Systems: Convergence of Artificial Intelligence and Medicine". The session will feature Dr. Arunraj in conversation with Ramya Kannan, Health Editor and Chief of Bureau (Tamil Nadu), *The Hindu*, exploring how AI and medical innovation could reshape healthcare delivery, clinical decision-making, and patient outcomes.

The first panel discussion, "AI-Driven Healthcare: Innovation, Ethics, Accessibility and Sustainability", will feature Richa Pant, Director - Research, DeepTek; Sindhuja Giritharan, Clinical Lead - Digital Health and Patient Engagement, Sundaram Medical Foundation; Hariharan, Associate Professor, Department of Transfusion Medicine, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS; and Reuben Fernandes, Founder and CEO, Skyfire Applied Intelligence Pvt. Ltd. (Atom360). The discussion will be moderated by Zubeda Hamid, Senior Assistant Editor, *The Hindu*.

The second panel discussion, 'Human Touch in the Age of AI: Preserving Compassion, Trust and Ethics in Modern Medicine,' will focus on the importance of keeping human values at the heart of an increasingly technology-driven healthcare ecosystem. The session will feature Abdul Ghafur, Senior Consultant and Adjunct Professor in Infectious Diseases, Apollo Hospitals, Chennai; K. Ganapathy, Honorary Distinguished Professor, IIM Jammu, Distinguished Professor, The Tamil Nadu Dr. M.G.R. Medical University, and Emeritus Professor, National Academy of Medical Sciences; and Iniyan S., Professor and Clinical Head, Department of Psychiatry, Saveetha Medical College, SIMATS. The session will be moderated by Geetha Srimathi S., Senior Reporter, *The Hindu*.

The Sustainability Dialogues 2026 will explore how artificial intelligence can be harnessed to strengthen healthcare systems while addressing critical questions around ethics, accessibility, sustainability and trust and preserving the irreplaceable role of human compassion in medicine.

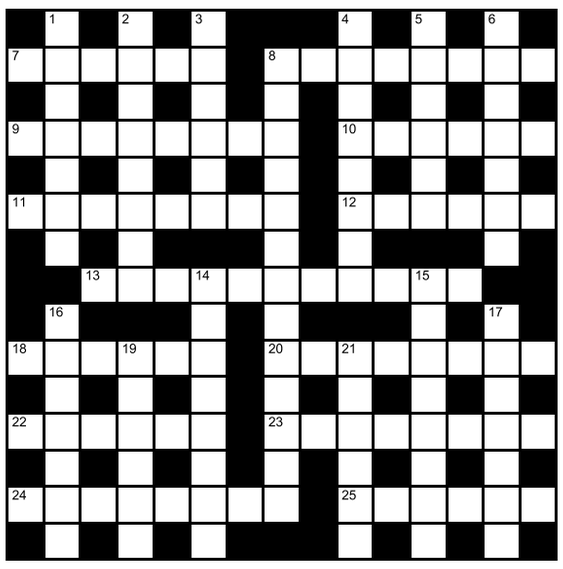
The event will be live-streamed at https://newsth.live/THSASDY

TH CROSSWORD + 14919

(set by Pixie Dust)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

7 Oh! This dessert funnily got a hole! (6)
8 Study substitute with a bit of terrifying condescension (8)
9 Essentially Jacob must stick to this kind of musical instrument (8)
10 Scoundrel cycling around Henry, sniffles (6)
11 Master stroke acquiring one British Bar (8)
12 Losing face, lamenting and suffering (6)
13 Live on...smitten! (5,2,4)
18 Authorise a manager to disclose rating in London (6)
20 Perhaps stay fit accepting rule to classify according to a graded scale (8)
22 Mate regularly ignoring Bishop's corrupt scheme (6)
23 Swell! Here batter is safe! (8)
24 Look, Sir! ET's are to a certain extent backing star? (8)
25 Penny chases husband out and hammers (6)

Down

1 Happy boxing copper element (7)
2 Old Russian woman's headscarf (8)
3 Spooner's child (middle) in steam bath? (3,3)
4 Blizzard? Fellow is beginning to breakdown and explode (8)
5 Delivered grain soap (6)
6 Special transparent material protecting primarily exposed organs (7)
8 Frequently used tack oils for cylindrical skewer? (8,5)
14 Hang on! Don't start to tell a story in undies (8)
15 Corrupted virtue...so like glass! (8)
16 Experiment involving English politician leads to commotion (7)
17 Harry dies of mainly fatigue in part of a cricket field (3, 4)
19 Guy goes around university with date and gets attacked (6)
21 For starters, roast eggplant chunks in parmesan emulsion (6)

SUDOKU

7				3	8	1		
		8			7			3
3		9		5				
8		4	7		5	6		
		1				4		
		5	1		6	7		8
				2		3		6
1			8			5		
		2	5	7				4

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DIFFICULTY RATING: ★☆☆☆☆

Solution to previous puzzle

A	R	A	B	I	A		S	U
	A		L		N		P	
L	I	T	E	R	A	T	I	
	T		E		R		R	
C	A	P	P	U	C	C	I	N
				H		T		R
A	N	T	O	N	Y	M	S	
	O		P					
I	N	C	I	T	E		C	A
	S		P		X		A	
A	M	M	A		C	I	R	C
	O		R		I		R	
E	K	E	O	U	T		I	R
	E		U		E		E	
C	R	U	S	A	D	E	D	

P	O	S	E	D				
	E		P		X			
R	H	E	B	O	K			
	R		F		N		R	
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T		R		N		I		
	M	A	D	E	U	P		
				E		M		
C	A	S	H	D	E	S	K	
	A		H					
I	R	C	U	M	V	E	N	T
	R		T		A		A	
I	R	O	Q	U	O	I	S	
	E		F		L		R	
F	A	T	P	A	Y			

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

4	5	3	8	2	6	7	1	9
1	9	2	5	4	7	3	8	6
7	6	8	1	9	3	5	4	2
2	3	9	4	7	1	6	5	8
5	8	7	9	6	2	1	3	4
6	4	1	3	8	5	2	9	7
8	7	5	6	3	4	9	2	1
9	1	6	2	5	8	4	7	3
3	2	4	7	1	9	8	6	5

FAITH

Valmiki's divine vision

Rama was known to Valmiki, for when Rama, Sita and Lakshmana went to Chitrakuta, they visited Valmiki's ashram. In Uttara Kanda, Rama tells Lakshmana to leave Sita near Valmiki's ashram, on the banks of the Tamasa river. When Rama had visited Valmiki, the latter's ashram had been in Chitrakuta. Later he moved to a place near the Tamasa river. Rama is aware of this, which is why He talks of Valmiki's ashram being on the banks of the Tamasa river. Valmiki did not know everything that had taken place in Rama's life. He did know about Rama's auspicious qualities. Wanting to hear Narada talk about Rama's qualities, Valmiki asks him to name someone who possesses 16 good qualities. Narada narrates important events in Rama's life. The first sarga of Valmiki Ramayana contains Narada's narration, and is called Samkshepa Ramayana, that is a concise Ramayana. The first sarga is like an index to Valmiki's Ramayana, said M.A. Venkatakrishnan in a discourse.

How did Valmiki's epic come about? One day, on his way to the river, he sees two birds in a passionate embrace. A hunter kills the male bird, leaving the female in tears. The hunter's action angers Valmiki, who curses him. But his curse comes out as a beautiful verse, in Anushtup metre. While Valmiki is thinking about the dead bird and its partner, Brahma arrives. He tells Valmiki that he should write the story of Rama. He gives Valmiki divine vision, so that he can see everything that has happened in Rama's life, and can hear all the conversations Rama has had over the years. Since he is going to observe every event in Rama's life, Brahma says there will not be one untrue word in Valmiki's epic.

TRANSFORMATION

Kishan is more mature and bats according to team's needs: Kotak

K.R. DEEPAK

Ishan Kishan has been playing everywhere as if it's his home ground. He has been doing really well for India. When he was younger, he was purely aggressive, but now he is far more mature and bats according to the team's needs. We just hope he shines here at his home ground — India batting coach Sitanshu Kotak.

NEW ROLE

Watling to take over from Ronchi as Black Caps batting coach

FILE PHOTO

Former wicketkeeper-batter B.J. Watling will replace Luke Ronchi as New Zealand's batting coach at the end of the Test series against India. Watling, however, will join the Kiwis squad on November 16 after the ODI series against India. He will assume the role full-time ahead of the away four-Test series against Australia.

MOVING ON

Australians Hopes, Haddin leave Punjab Kings coaching staff

FILE PHOTO: SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Punjab Kings fast-bowling coach James Hopes and fielding coach Brad Haddin, *in pic.*, have left their positions for opportunities in Australia. Hopes was recently appointed the head coach of Queensland and BBL team Brisbane Heat while Haddin has taken charge of the New South Wales men's outfit.

AT THE HELM

Kusal Mendis replaces Dhananjaya as Lanka captain in longest format

FILE PHOTO

Kusal Mendis was named as Sri Lanka's new Test captain on Thursday. He replaces Dhananjaya de Silva who stepped down ahead of selection for next month's two-match series against Pakistan. The 31-year-old Kusal has featured in 75 Tests and scored 4,836 runs, including 10 hundreds and 23 half-centuries.

India hopes to extend winning run as caravan moves to Ranchi

Shreyas & Co. can't take things lightly against a power-packed West Indies batting line-up; the bowling, though, remains a big worry for the visiting side; the home team, on the other hand, will be pleased with the performance of the spinners

WI IN INDIA

Sankar Narayanan E.H.
RANCHI

A 10-match winning streak is no mean feat. In the fickle realm of T20Is, it carries even greater weight.

The Men in Blue last suffered a loss in the shortest format a long time ago (July 11, vs. England in Southampton). Admittedly, their subsequent 10-game unbeaten run came largely against modest opposition – three games each against Zimbabwe and Afghanistan, one against Japan, one each versus second-string Sri Lanka and Pakistan in the Asian Games, followed by the series opener against the West Indies.

To stretch that winning streak to 11 in completed T20Is, India must overcome the Windies at the JSCA Stadium here on Friday.

Though the Lucknow fixture proved to be a walk in the park, Shreyas Iyer & Co. cannot take things lightly.

The visitors bat deep, and India got a firsthand glimpse of their power-hitting prowess on Tuesday. Rallying to post 171 after being 135 for eight was to the Men in Maroon's immense credit.

Versatile: Tilak has the ability to build an innings as well as produce big hits at will. K.R. DEEPAK

Flip side

The downside, however, is a monotonous bowling attack, with all-rounders like Romario Shepherd, Matthew Forde, and Shamar Springer posing little threat with their right-arm medium pace.

The bowling figures from the first T20I tell a simple story: while Akeal Hosein was the lone West Indian to go at under 10 an over, Mayank Yadav was the only Indian to touch a double-digit economy rate.

The West Indies must find a way to strike a better balance to reverse this statistic.

India, on the other hand, had everything go its way.

Perfect game

Right from winning the toss and introducing spin in the fourth over, to smashing a century, skipper Shreyas hardly put a foot wrong in Lucknow. Shreyas' acceleration towards the three-figure mark, with India needing just 65 when he reached his half-century, proved why he is so highly rated in the format.

The think-tank will also be pleased with the spinners' performance, with Axar Patel, Kuldeep Yadav, and Naman Dhir accounting for seven West Indies batters.

Suspense

The curiosity surrounding Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's inclusion in the playing XI has been a regular fixture of late, and the eve of the second T20I was no different.

"The team has not been decided yet, so I don't know. The chances are there for everyone in the 15," Sitanshu Kotak said.

The batting coach's non-committal comment notwithstanding, Sanju Samson is expected to keep his spot.

It sure helps Samson's case that India has been consistently winning. Whether the Men in Blue can extend their purple patch remains to be seen.

Match starts at 7 p.m.

IPL show, experience led to Bhuvneshwar's recall, says Kotak

Intense competition: Abhishek will be eager to fire with Sooryavanshi trying his best to break into the playing XI. K.R. DEEPAK

Sankar Narayanan E.H.
RANCHI

The India batting coach feels the conditions in New Zealand too would have tilted the scales in favour of the veteran seamer. Kotak backs the decision to include CoE head Laxman in selection meetings

Bhuvneshwar Kumar's inclusion in the T20I squad for the New Zealand series has created enough buzz to spill into India's press conference ahead of the second T20I against the West Indies – a good two weeks before the Men in Blue take on the Kiwis.

Batting coach Sitanshu Kotak is neither a selector nor a bowling expert, yet he obliged when asked about the reasons behind the 36-year-old's recall.

"The obvious thing is it's the selectors [who made the decision]. I can give you an answer on what I think. In England, I felt we needed experience along with the young bowlers as Jasprit Bumrah was also not available there. We all know that you can't beat experience," Kotak said at the JSCA Stadium on Thursday.

"Bhuvneshwar has been doing really well in the IPL for the last two seasons, so the selectors must have thought that he would be useful in New Zealand," he elaborated.

When asked if Mohammed Shami had a similar chance, Kotak explained: "If the selectors feel that he is doing well and the team has a requirement, then any player can be selected."

The BCCI's decision to include Centre of Excellence head V.V.S. Laxman in selection meetings has been another raging topic.

"I believe the BCCI took that decision for a purpose. I have worked with Laxman for three years in the CoE. He used to tell us that if the Indian team has any requirement, then our first duty is to do it. We used to postpone our leaves if an important player [came to the CoE] and the Indian team wanted him immediately. That's how committed Laxman is. So, whatever role he will be in, I am sure that Laxman will think about what is best for Indian cricket".

Rampaul. K.R. DEEPAK

Need to avoid losing wickets in clusters: Rampaul

Sankar Narayanan E.H.
RANCHI

West Indies bowling coach Ravi Rampaul wants his pedigreed willow-wielders to bat long and avoid sudden collapses.

"Definitely, rotation of strike [is needed]. Shai Hope and Shimron Hetmyer are really good players of spin bowling. When they bat through the middle, we have put up big totals. So, the onus is on our better batters of spin to bat long," Rampaul said on the eve of Friday's second T20I against India at the JSCA Stadium.

In the series opener, the visitors went from 38 for no loss to 44 for three, and from 107 for three to 135 for eight, ultimately costing them the game.

"It's something that has plagued us in the past... losing wickets in clusters, and it happened again. When that happens, we struggle a little bit in the middle."

Rampaul conceded that his bowling unit lacked international experience.

"It's a young bowling line-up. Sometimes, it could be a little bit frustrating when we come up with plans, and then they fail to execute... it just boils down to the experience of the bowling group".

Royals begin title defence in style; Knights rally to edge Marathas

APL

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

In a repeat of the inaugural season's final, Rajputana Royals began the defence of its Archery Premier League title in style, beating Prithviraaj Yodhas 5-3 in the opening match of Season 2 at the People's Plaza on Thursday.

Compound archers Ojas Deotale and Ella Gibson led the way for Royals at the start, with Mete Gazoz giving good support. After a slow start, Abhishek Verma-led Yodhas bounced back and came close to taking the match into a hit-or-miss shoot-off before Mathias Grande shot only an eight with the final arrow.

The second contest of the night saw Mighty Marathas suffer a collapse against Kakatiya Knights. Marathas won the first two sets before losing the next two and then stumbled in the shoot-off.

On song: Compound archer Ojas got Royals off to a fine start. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Nico Wiener and Neeraj Chauhan nailed the inner X-ring in the shoot-out after Marathas, who paid the price for substituting out Dhiraj Bommadevara for the final two sets, let slip a 4-0 advantage.

In the final match, Chero Archers defeated Chola Chiefs 5-3. Archers took the first set but Chiefs fought back to level the match 2-2.

In the final set, Chikitha Taniparthi and Rajat Chauhan couldn't apply the early pressure on Archers as they dropped a couple of 9s. Archers saw their compounds give them the perfect start. Casey Kaufhold with the penultimate arrow made it tricky but it didn't matter in the end.

Earlier, India's Asian Games medallists were felicitated by Vakiti Srihari, Telangana's Sports Minister, A.P. Jithender Reddy, Telangana Olympic Association president, and APL director Anil Kamineni.

The results: Rajputana Royals bt Prithviraaj Yodhas 5-3 (75-69, 73-74, 77-77, 76-75).
Kakatiya Knights tied with Mighty Marathas 4-4 (73-76, 74-77, 75-66, 77-70). *Knights won 2-0 on shoot-off.*
Chola Chiefs lost to Chero Archers 3-5 (69-74, 71-70, 75-79, 73-73).

Russian women hand India a 4-0 defeat

FOOTBALL

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

Russia eased past India 4-0 in a dominant display of technical and physical superiority in the first of two FIFA international women's friendlies at the Kishore Bharati Stadium here on Thursday.

The young Blue Tigresses, currently ranked 69th, adopted a deeply defensive shape to absorb relentless pressure from the 27th-ranked Russians. Goalkeeper Monalisha Devi Moirangthem stood firm with a series of impressive saves, keeping Russia at bay for much of the first half. India's resistance was broken in the 41st minute when Iana Sheina found the target to give Russia a 1-0 lead before the break.

Russia increased the pressure after half-time, with substitute Kira taking advantage of the wet conditions to score in the 60th and 70th minutes.

Last line of defence: Goalkeeper Monalisha Devi stood firm with some impressive saves. PTI

Iana Svistunova completed the rout with a strike in the 81st minute. India struggled to create clear-cut attacking opportunities, while the goalpost and desperate defending helped prevent an even bigger margin.

The match happened amid an off-field dispute between the AIFF and East Bengal FC over player releases.

Nine East Bengal players were left out of head coach Crispin Chettri's final squad, depriving India of several experienced senior stars and forcing him to rely heavily on an experimental group.

Crispin handed debuts to Babysana Devi Thingbaijam, Malati Munda, Cindy Colney, Shubhangi Singh, Dhurga Perumal and Sibani Devi Nongmeikapam.

The result: India 0 lost to Russia 4 (Sheina 41, Kira 60, 70, Svistunova 81).

Onus on India-A batters to force a decider

The host will hope to bounce back after being blown away by Beardman in the opener; how the bowlers adapt to a day game will be the key

Silver lining: Patidar waged a lone battle in the last game. X@CAP

AUSTRALIA-A IN INDIA

Anish Pathiyil
PUDUCHERRY

After being torn apart by the pace of the Australia-A bowling attack in the first encounter, India-A will look to bounce back and force a decider when the sides meet in the second one-dayer at the Cricket Association Puducherry Siechem Stadium here on Friday.

Chasing 275 under the lights, the Indian top-order was undone by the pace and hard lengths executed by Mahli Beardman. There was a small shoot of recovery during the partnership between Rajat Patidar and Nishant Sindhu but despite batting deep, the team could only muster 149 before being bundled out in the 32nd over.

Australia-A too will have some introspection to do. Nathan McSweeney and captain Will Sutherland managed to lift it to 274 but attempting cross-batted shots on pitch where the ball reared from back-of-a-length posed a continuous problem throughout.

Reverse swing

There was also some reverse swing on offer with the old ball towards the end of the second Power-Play in both innings.

Beardman told after the game that the ball was moving more prodigiously under lights so it remains to be seen if the same assistance will be available in a day game.

Spinners Sindhu, Anukul Roy and Vipraj Nigam bowled in the nets on the eve of the game.

Skipper Ruturaj Gaikwad will hope he can rely on the the trio to prise out wickets through the middle overs, the phase where India-A let the game slip away from its grasp in the opener.

Match starts at 9 a.m.

I was lucky to be coached by Lillee, says Beardman

Anish Pathiyil
PUDUCHERRY

Beardman's searing pace proved too hot for India-A. CAP

A combined 20 international caps across formats. 224 encounters in a high-pressure environment like the IPL. Mahli Beardman made batters possessing this level of experience look silly with his pace during Australia A's thumping win over India A in the first one-dayer.

The 21-year-old picked career-best figures of four for 23 using one simple tactic – steam in and bowl fast. He took the new ball for the visitors and by the time his first spell of 140 kmph projectiles was done, India A was already in a spot of bother.

Beardman first made his mark during the 2024 Under-19 World Cup. His searing pace was evident then, and he has only sharpened his tools since. A productive Big Bash League campaign earned him a T20I debut against Pakistan.

"We've got a rich history of fast bowling in Western Australia (WA), where I come from. I grew up watching Mitchell Johnson. I was lucky enough to be coached by Dennis Lillee. That's something that has been passed down," the speedster explained.

Spending time as a standby player in the Australian squad has helped Beardman pick the brains of Mitchell Starc, Josh Hazlewood and Pat Cummins.

"I try and be as much of a sponge as possible and soak up as much knowledge as I can," the youngster said. "They've been awesome from a technical aspect. Being so mature and having played so much cricket, they've got a really simple outlook on the game," he explained.

With more such outings with the ball, it won't be long before the 21-year-old reclaims a spot in the senior team.

Time for Chennaiyin to 'put everything together'

ISL

S. Shrivathsan
CHENNAI

Chennaiyin FC enters the Indian Super League season with renewed optimism.

After crawling to the penultimate position in the previous edition – before which it had hastily put together a squad – CFC has learnt that the first part of the journey is as important as the last.

When Chennaiyin takes the field for its opener against FC Goa in Fatorda on Saturday, it will do so with nearly two months of preparation under its belt.

Proper pre-season

"When the club was in talks with me to continue, the first thing I asked was a proper pre-season," head coach Clifford Miranda said here on Thursday.

Tanque. CHENNAIYIN FC

"We have had a seven-week pre-season and we are now in the competition period, so it is eight weeks. The club has provided me with what I wanted – timeframe, resources, facilities, friendlies etc. I am pleased with the signings we made... I am even more pleased with how the players have trained and the attitude they have shown. Now it is time for us to put everything together in the games," Miranda added.

Another area that needed urgent introspection was goal-scoring.

Huge challenge

While Chennaiyin has drafted promising Brazilian forward Ramon Tanque, it is thin on personnel in that department.

"We have a top striker. If he stays fit, he is going to trouble a lot of defences: he is very explosive. The way we have organised our attacking structure, it is not just about Ramon. There are players around him who can arrive in good moments and score."

CFC will hope it has plenty left in the 'Tanque'.

SNAPSHOTS

India downs Syria, moves closer to u-17 Asian Cup qualification

SELAYANG: India took a significant step in its AFC u-17 women's Asian Cup 2027 qualifying campaign with a 2-0 victory over Syria in its second Group E match on Thursday. Anushka Kumari found the net on either side of half-time as the win gave the 'Young Tigresses' six points from two matches.

Bagan pips East Bengal to win IFA Shield

KOLKATA: Mohun Bagan rode on a late first-half strike from Samir Zeljkovic (45th) to beat East Bengal 1-0 and win the IFA Shield on Thursday. Sahal Abdul Samad essayed a perfect lob for a lurking Zeljkovic, who chested it down and slotted past the onrushing Phurba Lachenpa.

Sindhu enters Arctic Open quarterfinals

VANTAA: P.V. Sindhu beat Japan's Riko Gunji 21-15, 21-15 to advance to the women's quarterfinals at the Arctic Open Super 500 tournament on Thursday. In men's singles, second seed Christo Popov of France beat Tharun Mannepalli 21-14, 21-19 in the second round while K. Srikanth lost 21-15, 15-21, 13-21 to Canada's Brian Yang in the first round.

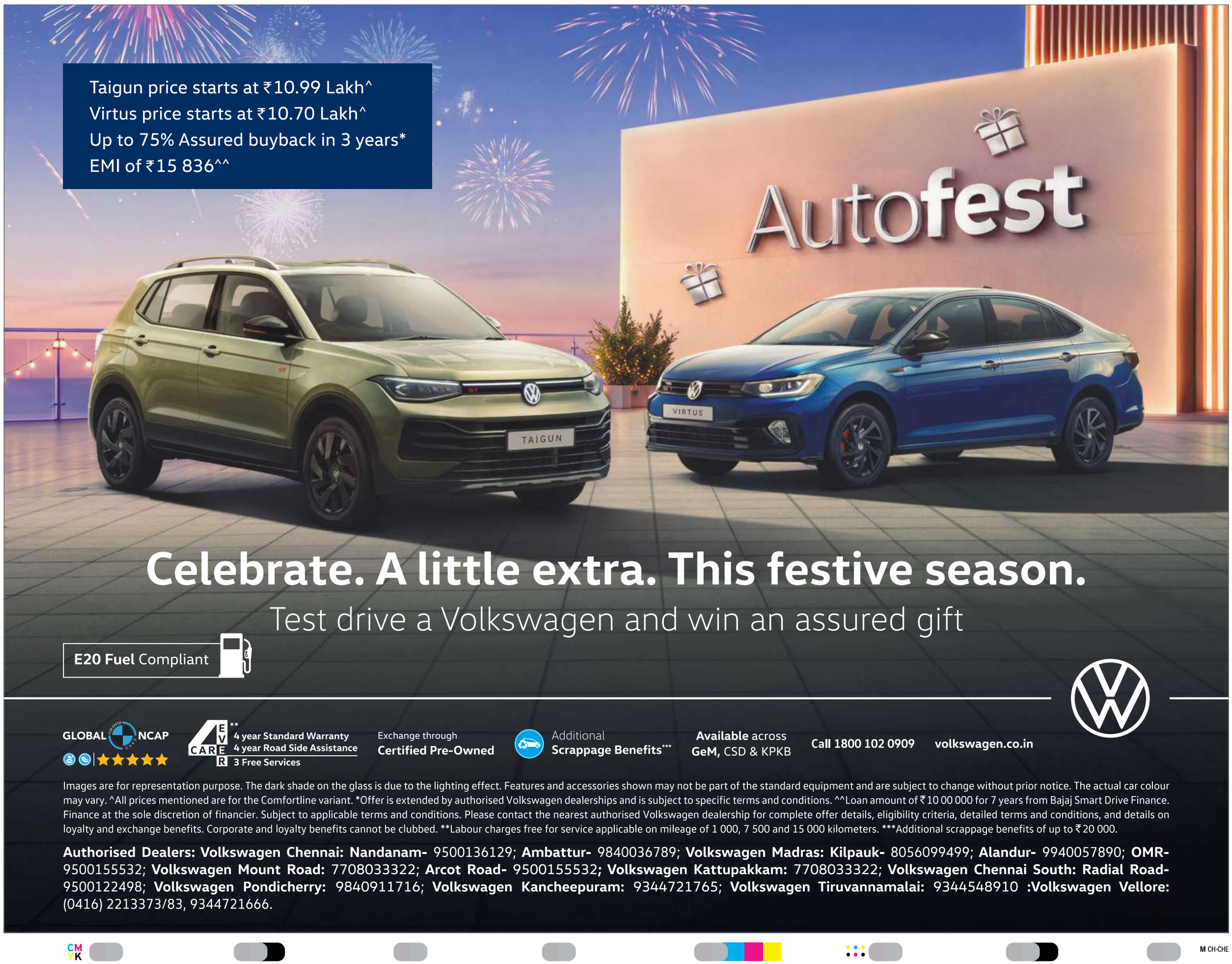
Manush-Diya duo loses in China Smash semis

BEIJING: Manush Shah and Diya Chitale suffered a 7-11, 11-9, 10-12, 4-11 loss to seventh seeds Lin Yun-Ju and Cheng I-Ching of Taiwan in the mixed doubles semifinals at the World Table Tennis (WTT) China Smash on Thursday.

Big win for Tamil Nadu u-19 over Bengal

CHANDIGARH: Tamil Nadu beat Bengal by seven wickets in the u-19 Vinoo Mankad Trophy at the Govt. Model SSS here.

The scores: Bengal 154 in 38 overs (Atmaja Mondal 69, V. Shavin 3/26, Raj Jamie Walsh 3/37) lost to Tamil Nadu 159/3 in 28.3 overs (K.V. Raghav 51, V.K. Vineeth 45, S. Prabanjan 33 n.o.).



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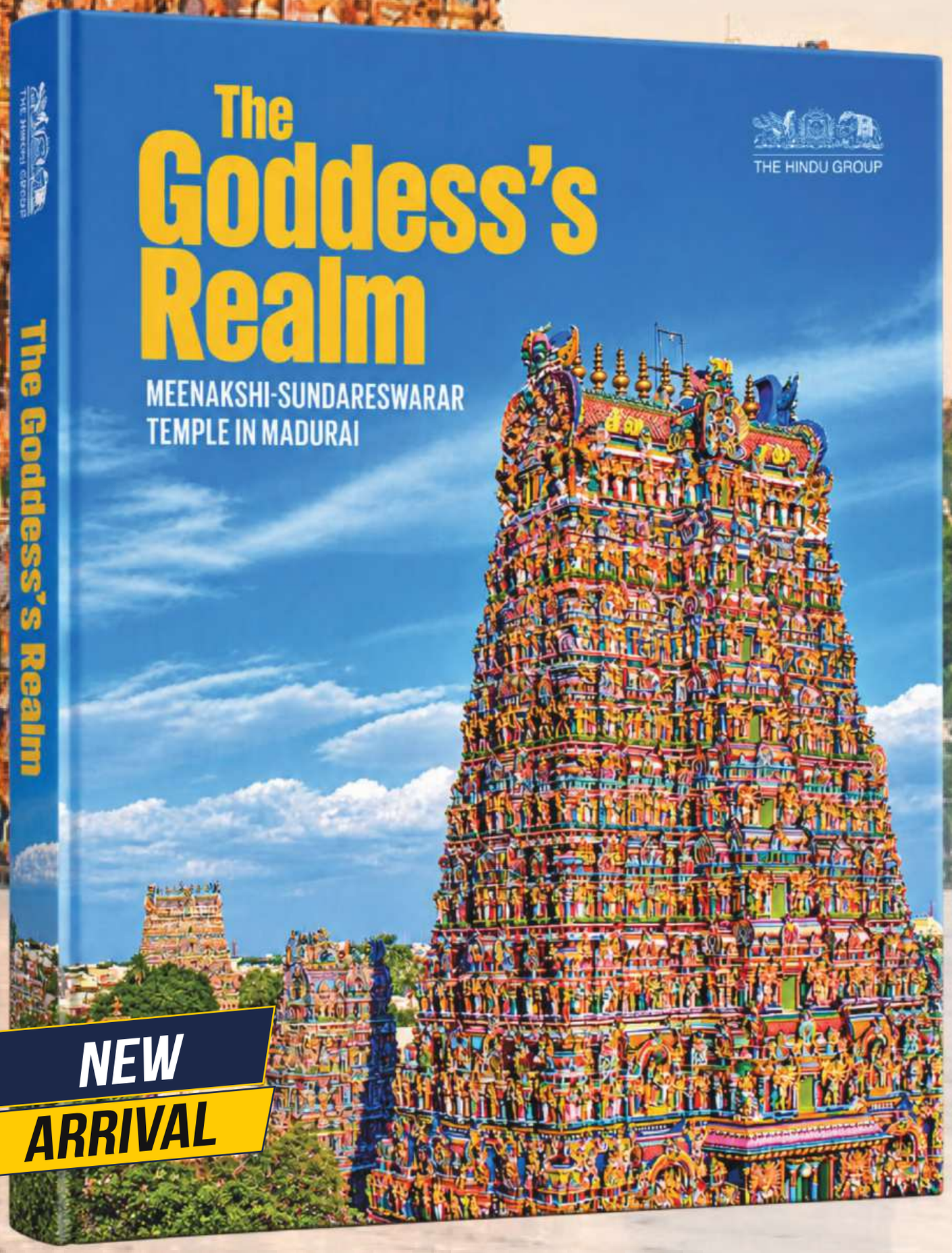

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Russian strike on buses kills 30 in frontline Ukrainian city

Agence France-Presse
KYIV

Ukraine on Thursday accused Russia of deliberately targeting civilians after 30 people were killed when two buses were blown up in the frontline city of Kramatorsk.

Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy vowed that the attack "will not go unanswered" after photos showed bodies and debris strewn across the road. "Russia is trying to destroy all life in (the) Donbas (region) and the world must respond to this," he wrote on Telegram, warning that the death toll could rise.

FULL REPORT ON
» **WORLD PAGE**

Feeling the game

Final touches: Members of the Indian men's blind football team train in Kochi, Keralam, on Thursday ahead of their departure for Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, to compete in the 2026 Asian Para Games, scheduled to kick off on October 18. THULASI KAKKAT

Nemmeli plant set for higher output as water levels dip

Metrowater seeks to optimise water resources as reservoir storage falls; works to replace RO membranes at the plant set to be completed soon

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

With storage in the city reservoirs falling sharply, Chennai Metrowater is looking to optimise its available water resources to maintain a stable daily water supply. This includes maximising production from the desalination plants at Nemmeli.

The five reservoirs supplying drinking water to the city currently have a combined storage of nearly 36.3% of their total capacity as on Thursday (October 8). Their combined storage is nearly 3,840 million cubic feet of storage lower than the storage recorded on the same day last year.

The water agency has assessed that Chennai's daily water supply can be sustained for another five months with available water resources, including in Veeranam tank. Metrowater is hoping that the ensuing Northeast monsoon would boost the reservoirs' storage by the year end.

Officials noted that of the water supply system's designed capacity of 1,712 million litres a day (mld), Chennai is being supplied with 1,272 mld of drinking water now. Of this, the desalination plants at Nemmeli contributed to 175-180 mld that is nearly 15% of the total demand.

Alternative source: The Nemmeli desalination plants currently supply 15% of Chennai's total water demand. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Works to replace reverse osmosis (RO) membranes, a crucial component in the desalination process, would be completed at the 110-mld and 150-mld Nemmeli desalination plant by October end and November end respectively, according to Metrowater.

At the 110 mld desalination plant, nearly 6,543 RO membranes have been replaced out of the total 7,056 RO membranes over the past two years. The plant is now producing 95 mld of drinking water and is expected to achieve full capacity by the month end. Similarly, the 150 mld plant in the same site is now producing 85 mld.The plant is expected to reach full capacity by November end once the membranes are replaced. As of now, the desalination plants are catering to south Chennai and southern suburbs. Once the 150 mld plant reaches full capacity, additional water would be conveyed to the network supplying central parts of the city, officials said.

Meanwhile, water from the abandoned quarries in Sikkarayapuram and Erumaiyur is also being pumped for use in the city water supply, officials added.

Ambulance launched to aid wild animals in distress

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A wildlife emergency ambulance was launched on Thursday to provide immediate medical assistance to injured and distressed wild animals in Chennai and neighbouring areas.

Forest Minister R.V. Ranjith Kumar flagged off the vehicle at the Guindy Children's Nature Park during the valedictory function of Wildlife Week 2026.

The Minister also inaugurated a wildlife photography exhibition organised through the Tamil Nadu Wildlife Experiences Corporation and released a standard operating procedure document on monitoring sea turtles, their safe handling, and release in appropriate coastal areas.

State-level final rounds of the wildlife awareness quiz were also held for school students as part of the celebrations.

Prizes and certificates were presented to winners of the painting and quiz competitions and the photography contest conducted for volunteers.

Forest Minister R.V. Ranjith Kumar flags off the wildlife ambulance at the Guindy Children's Nature Park on Thursday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The Minister also distributed equipment kits to snake rescuers registered through the 'Nagam' application to enable them to safely handle the reptiles.

Senior forest officials, including Additional Chief Secretary Usha Kakarla, PCCF (Head of Forest Force) A. Udayan, Chief Wildlife Warden Rakesh Kumar Dogra, and other officials participated in the event.

Students, volunteers, frontline forest staff and members of the public, also attended the event.

INBRIEF

Cochin Shipyard gets global orders for over 40 ships

State-owned Cochin Shipyard has received orders to build over 40 ships from the US, Germany, Norway and other countries, Shipping Minister Sarbananda Sonowal said on Thursday. Addressing a press conference here, Mr. Sonowal said, "Most of the orders we are receiving for shipbuilding are for Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL) from foreign countries like Germany, America, and Norway. So far, we have received orders for more than 40 ships." PTI

Deposit rate hikes unlikely for 3 months: SBI chairman

SBI Chairman C.S. Setty on Thursday said he did not see deposit rate hike for up to three months because of the excess liquidity in the system. He said the shift to tightening of rates by the RBI will help banks expand their net interest margins for up to three quarters. Mr. Setty, however, added that if credit growth continued at the ongoing elevated levels, some banks may have to look at raising deposit rates to fund the advances. PTI

Gold, silver imports by banks, agencies to attract 3% IGST

Gold, silver and platinum imports by banks and nominated agencies attract 3% IGST effective April 1, 2026, Revenue Secretary Arvind Shrivastava said on Thursday. The Government notified the GST Council on Thursday that the list of designated banks and agencies that attract IGST exemptions on gold and precious metal imports has not been extended beyond March 31, 2026, Mr. Shrivastava said. PTI

Is Ambani the 'boss of India', asks Musk

Telecom department dismisses allegation that India's regulatory framework was unfair and discriminatory as baseless and misconceived; statement came in response to SpaceX founder and CEO Elon Musk's charge that 'certain oligarchs' in India were blocking the satellite internet service

Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) on Thursday rejected allegations that it was shielding oligarchs from competition by delaying approvals for SpaceX's Starlink satellite internet service in India.

The statement came in response to billionaire Elon Musk's charge on Wednesday that "certain oligarchs" were hindering Starlink's launch in India. Bharti-backed OneWeb and Reliance Industries Ltd's satellite internet arm are the other two companies that have secured satellite internet authorisations from the DoT.

However, the DoT said security assessments for both operators are "currently under way", stressing that the regulatory framework applies uniformly to all satellite communication providers.

"A post is being circulated on social media regarding the fairness of India's regulatory framework for satellite communication services and suggesting that it is being applied in a discriminatory manner," the DoT said. "The suggestion that the framework or its application is unfair or discriminatory is baseless and misconceived."

> Starlink has spent five years complying with every single law and requirement of the government of India, so why still no license
>
> **ELON MUSK,** SPACEX FOUNDER AND CEO

At the India Mobile Congress on Wednesday, SpaceX executive Lauren Dreyer said she hoped Starlink would have received approval to begin services in India by this time next year. She also said the company had already established 20 facilities in India to process Indian users' data locally.

The DoT said all satellite communication licensees are required to demonstrate compliance with specified security conditions before services can be rolled out. "Under the terms and conditions of licence [sic], every such licensee is required to demonstrate compliance with security conditions," the department said. "This is aimed at ensuring that services provided meet various security requirements to ensure safety of all users and their data."

Mr. Musk, however, doubled down on his criticism on Thursday, amplifying several posts supporting Starlink's launch in India. "Starlink will be of great help to areas of India that have bad or no Internet and even no mobile coverage," he said. "No country has perfect coverage, including America, but Starlink can fill in the coverage gaps for those who most need it."

In a subsequent post, Mr. Musk named Reliance Industries chairman Mukesh Ambani, asking whether the latter was "the real boss of India".

"Starlink is licensed in over 165 countries and has spent five years complying with every single law and requirement of the government of India, so why still no license," he asked.

Responding to a query at the India Mobile Congress on Thursday on Mr. Musk's remarks, Reliance Jio chairman Akash Ambani declined to comment.

Sensex, Nifty fall amid rising crude prices, rupee decline

Gowri Lakshmi
MUMBAI

Thursday's decline followed the markets' sharp reaction to the MPC's decision to hike interest rates

The benchmark index Nifty 50 closed at its lowest level since 18 months on Thursday, while the BSE Sensex dropped 1.4%, to its lowest since February 13, 2024. The Nifty stocks index closed at 22,231.80 points, down 1.6%, while Sensex closed at 71,593.24 points.

Market analysts attributed multiple factors including rising global crude oil prices, persistent decline in the rupee, and cautionary onset of Q2 (July-September) earnings season to the market's downward movement.

Thursday's decline followed a sharp reaction by the markets on Wednesday to the Monetary Policy Committee's (MPC) decision to hike interest rates by 25 bps.

"During the session, the Nifty breached the previous swing-low support at 22,217 as well as the key April 2026 swing low of 22,182," Nandish Shah, deputy vice president, HDFC Securities said in a report.

"The decisive breakdown of these levels indicates a further escalation in selling pressure and an intensification of the ongoing downtrend."

Ajit Mishra, senior vice-president of research at Religare Broking added that the market recovery that occurred between April and August was over now and that the market would likely fall further.

TCS Q2 net up 15% to ₹13,884 cr., board approves ₹12 dividend

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) reported a 15% year-on-year (YoY) rise in consolidated net profit to ₹13,884 crore for the quarter ended September 30, 2026.

Revenue for the quarter rose 11.2% YoY to ₹73,188 crore, while growing 1.3% sequentially. Net margin stood at 19%, with operating margin at 24%.

TCS said its annualised AI revenue crossed $3.1 billion, accounting for more than 10% of revenue. Total contract value (TCV) stood at $9.6 billion during the quarter. Cash generation remained strong, with net cash from operations at ₹14,190 crore, equivalent to 102.2% of net income.

The company's workforce stood at 598,056 employees at the end of the quarter, up from 593,314 a year earlier. IT services attrition remained stable at 13.3%. The board recommended a ₹12-per-share dividend, compared with ₹11 a year ago.

Air India, Akasa hike fuel surcharge

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

With sustained ATF prices adding to operating costs, Air India and Air India Express have revised domestic fuel surcharges to ₹400-₹1,200 and introduced surcharges of $55 for West Asia, $135 for Europe, $210 for Australia and $215 for North America.

Akasa Air has also introduced a domestic fuel surcharge ranging from ₹375 to ₹1,150 based on sector length, while a ₹2,500 surcharge will apply on specified international routes.

Copper prices may stay over $14,000; HCL cost discipline to aid expansion viability

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Firming up: The surge in copper prices was largely driven by a widening demand-supply gap, says Anupam Misra (left). PIB REUTERS

Global benchmark copper prices are expected to remain above the $14,000-per-tonne mark while Hindustan Copper Ltd.'s (HCL) cost discipline will ensure the financial viability of its expansion plans, chairman and managing director Anupam Misra told *The Hindu* in an exclusive interaction.

Mr. Misra said the current surge in copper prices was largely driven by a widening demand-supply gap. Global copper demand is currently estimated at about 28 million tonne against supply of around 23 million tonnes.

"That kind of a gap exists [between supply and demand]. Therefore, benchmark prices [at the London Metal Exchange] are going to be above $14,000 per tonne," the top official said.

At the time of writing this article, benchmark copper prices were trading 0.05% higher than the previous close at $14,508.85 a tonne.

Cost discipline

Mr. Misra said Hindustan Copper's earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (EBITDA) margin currently stood at more than 50%, implying its costs were below 50% of revenue.

"That means my costs are about 45% to [less than] 50%. So, even if benchmark prices go down, I will continue to be profitable.

"Therefore, I am not bothered whether [benchmark] prices fall or not," he said.

His comments assume significance as the company has outlined a capital expenditure programme worth more than ₹7,000 crore over the next five to six years and expand mining capacity to 12.2 million tonnes per annum (MTPA).

HCL is also pursuing acquisition of four copper blocks in Chile, world's largest copper producer

"There are some places where we are doing modernisation, places where we are adding capacity, and [in some places] we may be replacing old equipment. All these activities are happening simultaneously," Mr. Misra said.

He expects unit costs to decline further as production scales up.

Interim milestones

The Kolkata-headquartered miner has also set intermediate milestones towards its 2030 targets to keep the expansion programme on track.

"This is to ensure there are no slippages, so that we do not get any surprise by 2030," he said.

The expansion would primarily rely on brownfield development at its Khetri, Kolihan and flagship Malanjkhand mines, alongside further exploration.

PSUs lead exploration

Mr. Misra said exploration to strengthen India's resilience amid evolving global copper dynamics was being driven largely by public-sector entities, with limited private-sector participation.

Mining projects typically have long gestation periods of 15 to 18 years, he said, making exploration less attractive to private players, who tend to prefer developed or producing mines.

Chile project

Hindustan Copper is also pursuing the acquisition of four copper blocks in Chile, the world's largest copper-producing country.

At present, because of the regulatory requirements on both sides, it may take some time, "but yes, we are working on it," Mr. Misra said, adding the next step entails forming a joint venture in India and in Chile.

"There may be other partners who would be willing to participate. Thus, the objective of having a joint venture in India is to diversify the risk," he added.

'Consultation AI paper in a month; safety, deepfakes key focus areas'

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the government will release a consultation paper on AI regulations within a month, focusing on key aspects such as AI safety, deepfakes and a human-first approach.

The paper will form the basis for AI regulations, he said, adding the time has come for India to have such a framework.

"I'll request the department to come out with a regulation-focused consultation paper, which focuses on safety. That's the most important point: safety related to AI use," Mr. Vaishnaw said while speaking at an event.

Other areas of focus would be AI harms, including deepfakes, a human-first approach and skilling.

Mr. Vaishnaw termed deepfakes a "nuisance which can cause huge problems in society" and noted that their quality is improving every day.

"People believe them, and it sets a totally wrong precedent. It sets a totally wrong narrative, and people get lured into doing wrong things and believing wrong things," he said.

The consultation paper would also include skilling and a commitment to leave no person behind.

"Humanity has to be the most important part of change that has happened," he said.

Mr. Vaishnaw said the Centre always maintained that AI and other technologies cannot be regulated by law alone. "We have to bring a techno-legal solution," the Minister said, adding that stakeholders must be brought on board.

कार्यालय नगर निगम, उदयपुर
टाउनहॉल लिंक रोड, उदयपुर (राज.) 313001
दुरभाष स. 0294-2421255, 2420013 , Helpline no.0294-2426262,
Email:- ceoudr.lsg@rajasthan.gov.in electricalumc50@gmail.com Website :- https://udaipurmc.org/

क्रमांक :–ननिउ/ विद्युत/2026–27/542 दिनांक :– 06.10.2026

ई–बोली आमन्त्रण सूचना संख्या – ई 10/2026–27

नगर निगम कार्यालय उदयपुर द्वारा विद्युत शाखा से सम्बंधित विभिन्न विकास कार्य जिसकी कुल अनुमानित लागत राशि 159.46 लाख हेतु ई–प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट के माध्यम से ऑनलाईन निविदा दिनांक 20.10.2026 समय सायं 6.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। विस्तृत जानकरी www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है।

UBN No. UNP2627WSRC00105 आयुक्त
राज.संवाद/सी/26/11514 नगर निगम, उदयपुर

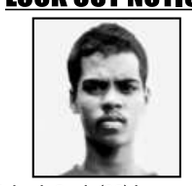
PUNJAB STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
SCO 74-75, BANK SQUARE, SECTOR-17B CHANDIGARH
PBX: 0172-5197847, 5197846

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

PSWC invites online tenders through GeM Portal for creation of 0.95 LMT godown capacities at 03 locations in the State of Punjab for guaranteed lease of 10 years on Build, Own and Operate/Lease basis for storage requirements of FCI under two bid system 'Technical Bid' and 'Financial Bid'.
NIT (alongwith GeM Bid IDs) is available on Department's website i.e.
https:// pswc.in
PSWC reserves the right to scrap the tender at any stage without assigning any reason and PSWC will not be held liable for any costs and consequences incurred by the intending bidders.
Note: Any corrigendum(s)/Notification(s) to this Notice Inviting E-Tender shall be published Department's website & GeM Portal.

1004/12/2026-27/15978 Managing Director, PSWC

LOOK OUT NOTICE



Mahesh Gosh (22) has escaped from Police custody in front of District Jail, Thiruvananthapuram since 21.06.2026, 8 pm.
160 cm height, lean body, medium complexion, round face.
Any information known about the above missing person, Inform.
Contact Numbers
SHO : 9497947100
SI POOJAPPURA: 9497980011
POOJAPPURA P.S: 0471 2350266
367/F2/2026/I&PRD

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA, "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
WORKS DEPARTMENT
Bid Identification No. CCE NHC KJR- 03/2026-27
(E-mail address- senhkeonjhar@gmail.com)
Letter No.1716, Date : 05.10.2026

1.	No of the work	: 1 Number of Building work
2.	Estimated cost	: Rs.153.57 Lakhs
3.	Class of Contractor	: B Class & A Class
4.	Period of completion	: 10 (Ten) Calender Months
5.	Last Date and Time of availability Of Bid document in the portal.	: 11:00 Hours of 12.10.2026 to 16:00 Hours of 28.10.2026
6.	Last date /Time for receipt of bids	: 16:00 Hours 28.10.2026
7.	Date of opening of Bid from portal	: 11:00 Hours on 29.10.2026
8.	Name of the address of the officer inviting Bid.	: Chief Construction Engineer, NH Circle, Keonjhar

Further details can be seen from the e- procurement portal https://tendersodisha.gov.in.

Sd/- Chief Construction Engineer, N.H.Circle, Keonjhar.
34001/973/2627 OIPR-34001/34145/1/26-27/0002

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD DIV. BARAN
क्रमांक :1068 दिनांक : 29.09.2026

Notice Inviting Bid No 12/2026-27

Bid for "CD work" NIT No. 12/2026-27 are invited from interested bidders up to 6.00 PM on 14.10.2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in,http://sppp.raj.nic.in) of the state departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 289.70 Lac

क्र.सं.	UBN No.	क्र.सं.	UBN No.
1	PWD2627WSOB14156	2	PWD2627WSOB14157
3	PWD2627WSOB14158	4	PWD2627WSOB14159
5	PWD2627WSOB14161	6	PWD2627WSOB14163
7	PWD2627WSOB14165	8	PWD2627WSOB14166

(Sunil Kumar Soni)
Executive Engineer
PWD Division Baran
DIPR/C/17209/2026

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
(A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking)
Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005, India
Phone No: 0141-2228066, 2228064 Website: www.rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in
CIN:U24232RJ2011SGC035067, E-mail: edprmsc@rajasthan.gov.in

Ref. No. :- F.02 (459)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-21/2026-27/5236 Dated :- 06/10/2026

Corrigendum-I in NIB-21/2026-27

In Reference to NIB No. F.02 (459)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/ NIB-21/2026-27/5192ADated:- 28.09.2026 UBN No. MSC2627GLOB00061 Corrigendum-I is issued for EMD Fees from bid. All details may be seen on https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in & https://www.rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in.

Director (Proc.)
Raj.Samwad/C/26/11438 RMSCL, Jaipur

Government of Karnataka
DIRECTORATE OF URBAN LAND TRANSPORT
URBAN DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE COMMISSIONER URBAN LAND TRANSPORT
BMTC, TTMC 'B' Block, (Above Bus Stand), 4th Floor, K.H.Road, Shanthinagar, Bengaluru-560027. Ph : 080-22226627 / 6628, Fax : 080-22226630,
E-Mail : dultbangalore@gmail.com, dult@karnataka.gov.in
Website: https://dult.karnataka.gov.in

No:DULT/16/2026/900 Date : 08.10.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Directorate of Urban Land Transport (DULT) invites E-bids from the Qualified consultancies for carrying out **Comprehensive Redesign of Hubballi-Dharwad Bus Rapid Transit System Corridor (Entire RoW).** The Last date for the receipt of e-bid on the KPPP portal for the tender is **17.11.2026, 17:30:00.** The bidders may downtoad the tender document for from **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** web porta.

S.No	Tender Name	Tender No.
1	Comprehensive Redesign of Hubballi - Dharwad Bus Rapid Transit System Corridor (Entire RoW)	DULT/2026-27/SE0054

Sd/- Joint Director(Admin)(I/c)
Directorate of Urban Land Transport
Urban Development Department
DIPR/CP/3155/Shirdi Sai/2026-27

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

e-tenders are invited for Supply of **CERTAIN CATEGORIES OF PAPER MATERIALS** for TTD Printing Press to meet the requirement in FY- 2026-2027. For Tender Notice & Details Please log on to the web site **http://www.tirumala.org** and **https:// tender.ap.eprocurement.gov.in.**
For further details contact: 0877-2264355 (or) 0877-2264292.

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.210) Date:08-10-2026 EXECUTIVE OFFICER

E-mail :- acetonk.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in
Office of The Additional Chief Engineer P.W.D.
Zone-Tonk (Raj.)
Bambor Underpass New Housing Board Colony NH-52 Road
क्रमांक- 1825-1836 दिनांक:-28/09/2026

NIB NO-06/2026-27

02 Nos. Bids for in Dausa District are invited from interested bidders Dated 29-09-2026 to 12-10-2026 upto 6.00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be seen on the procurement portal (http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in) of the state; and http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 740.71 Lacs.

NIB code PWD2627A3104
UBN is : PWD2627WSOB13999 (H.L. MEENA)
UBN is : PWD2627WSOB14002 Addl. Chief Engineer
DIPR/C/17158/2026 PWD Zone-Tonk

WASHINGTON

In a foreign policy tilt, U.S. opens direct talks with Myanmar govt.

REUTERS

The Trump administration has begun direct talks with Myanmar's military-installed government, according to U.S. officials. Last month's meeting which saw U.S. Assistant Secretary of State for Intelligence and Research, Michael Vance, present, underscores a broader Trump-administration foreign policy tilt. REUTERS

ANKARA

Turkish state not doing enough to pursue peace process, says PKK

AFP

The Kurdistan Workers' Party (PKK) on Thursday accused the Turkish state of doing little to pursue the peace process that began in 2024, despite the Kurdish group having withdrawn all its combat forces from Turkiye. Turkish Parliament in August voted through a law offering limited amnesty for militants from PKK. AFP

PARIS

French teenagers keep up school blockades despite PM's assurance

AFP

French teenagers blockaded some high schools and marched through cities on Thursday after the government promised to address their grievances about teacher shortages and dilapidated school buildings. Prime Minister Sebastien Lecornu addressed the nation late on Wednesday. REUTERS

CAIRO

Palestinian factions agree to hold national dialogue before elections

AFP

Palestinian factions including Fatah and Hamas agreed to hold a "national dialogue" before legislative elections in November, as a source said on Thursday that they were seeking to postpone the vote. Palestinian legislative elections are due to take place on November 28, a month after Israel's own general election. AFP

Russian strike on buses kills 30 in Kramatorsk; Kyiv vows response

Moscow is trying to destroy all life in the Donbas region and the world must respond to the attacks, says Ukraine President Zelenskyy; visiting British Foreign Minister Ed Miliband says Vladimir Putin is trying to win the war by 'terrorising civilians'

Agence France-Presse
KYIV

Ukraine on Thursday accused Russia of deliberately targeting civilians after 30 people were killed when two buses were blown up in the frontline city of Kramatorsk, in one of the deadliest single attacks for weeks.

Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy vowed that the attack "will not go unanswered" after photos posted by local authorities showed the burnt-out metal shell of the vehicles, with bodies and debris strewn across the road.

The site where two buses were struck by projectiles in Kramatorsk, near the frontline in eastern Ukraine, on Thursday. AFP

"Russia is trying to destroy all life in (the) Donbas (region) and the world must respond to this," he wrote on Telegram, warning that the death toll could rise. Police said the buses were hit with a glide bomb. Three more people were killed in a nearby village as a result of shelling, the emergency services said.

The strikes come just a day after five children were among 22 killed when a Russian missile flattened a five-storey apartment block in Pryluky, in the northern Chernihiv region.

"The Russians are deliberately targeting civilians," Donetsk Governor Vadym Filashkin said, accusing Moscow of flouting "every conceivable rule of warfare and norm of international humanitarian law".

Kramatorsk City Council called it "yet another horrific crime committed by the Russian army against the civilian population".

"Once again, the Russians have struck a location where there are absolutely no military targets," it added. There has been mounting concern about the increase in civilian deaths and injuries in the nearly five-year conflict, as both sides step up long-range attacks beyond their borders.

Since Russia's invasion in February 2022, Ukraine has accused its forces of deliberately attacking and killing civilians.

Touring the site of the Pryluky attack on Thursday, visiting U.K. Foreign Minister Ed Miliband said there was "no clearer sign of Putin's evil, evil intent and strategy in this conflict". "Putin once said that he was going to win on the battlefield," he told reporters, as London announced more sanctions on Moscow. "He is trying to win by terrorising civilians."

Canadian poet Anne Carson wins Nobel Prize in literature

Associated Press
STOCKHOLM

Canadian poet, essayist and translator Anne Carson won the Nobel Prize in literature on Thursday for playful, genre-blending works that fuse the classical and the modern.

The Toronto-born Carson, 76, draws on themes and stories from ancient Greek and Roman literature for writing that often blends elements of poetry, essay and fiction.

The permanent secretary of the Swedish Academy said the author was in Iceland "listening to the wind" when the academy reached her to notify her of the win.

"She was very taken by surprise," Ingrid Carlberg said.

Asked how she felt about the award, Ms. Carson told the Icelandic public broadcaster *RUV*: "I think they're all crazy." She described the conversation with the academy as "rather halting".

Anne Carson

"They have the usual questions, and I have no answers." She said poetry is "probably more useful than prose right now because it's faster, and everybody is in a hurry. So basically I think it's good because it's brief. Except Homer. Homer's not brief."

Ms. Carson is among the more high-profile recent winners of the literature Nobel, which often honours authors little known outside of the literary world and is sometimes criticised for valuing literary experimentation over the ability to connect with a broad readership.

However, the prize can also introduce readers to writers and works beyond their own languages or reading habits.

Asked how the prize would change her sales, she said: "I'll get a sticker on the front of my book. Stickers help."

Ms. Carson's books include *Eros the Bittersweet*, *Autobiography of Red*, as well as *Men in the Off Hours*, and *Norma Jeane Baker of Troy*.

The prize was announced in Stockholm.

U.S. suspends major IT firms from green card programme

Reuters
WASHINGTON

The U.S. government is suspending Microsoft, Adobe and several large IT firms from a programme that allows skilled foreign workers to gain permanent residency, senior U.S. officials announced on Thursday, citing alleged fraud, and as part of an effort to push companies to hire more Americans.

"Our message to Microsoft is: You're a great American company, but you've got to hire great American workers," U.S. Vice President J.D. Vance said.

Secretary of Labour Keith Sonderling added that some of the largest IT firms in the world would also be suspended from that programme, including Cognizant, Infosys, Tata, Wipro, HCL and Capgemini.

"We will not accept any new or process any pending permanent labour certification applications involving these companies," Mr. Sonderling said.

Houthis claim another strike on airport in Riyadh, warn airlines of 'consequences'

Associated Press
CAIRO

Several explosions were heard in Saudi Arabia's capital of Riyadh on Thursday, including a large blast at the city's international airport, a day after the kingdom said an attack on the airport killed one person and wounded others.

Houthi (Ansar Allah) rebels in neighbouring Yemen claimed responsibility for the new attack on King Khalid International Airport, saying the ballistic missile caused damage but giving no evidence. The Saudis had no immediate comment about the claim.

A fighter affiliated with the Houthis firing his machine gun as they advance against Yemeni government troops in Taiz. AFP

The spokesperson for the Saudi-led coalition fighting the Houthis, Major Genereal Turki al-Malki, said they intercepted and destroyed two ballistic missiles launched by the Houthis toward Riyadh, along with a ballistic missile fired toward Khamis Mushait, in the southwest near the Yemen border.

The Houthis have repeatedly claimed attacks against Saudi airports, military and oil facilities in recent days. Early on Thursday, the rebels warned global airlines "for the last time" about the potential consequences of operating in Saudi airspace, which it called a theatre for its military operations.

King Khalid International Airport "closed again," the Flightradar24 monitor said on Thursday afternoon on X not long after the blasts.

'British consulate in east Jerusalem ceases to function'

Associated Press
JERUSALEM

Israel said on Thursday that the British Consulate in east Jerusalem has "ceased to function" in that capacity and that 20 staffers will leave the country, deepening the biggest diplomatic rift between the close allies in decades.

The sign outside the consulate was taken down, but Britain said the building remains open and a core staff will continue to deliver "vital services" and work with Palestinians. The U.K. government said it would not retaliate by expelling Israeli diplomats as it seeks to rebuild its staff.

The dispute began last month when the U.K. banned trade with Israeli settlements in the occupied West Bank. The UN and much of the international community consider all settlements illegal.

"Israel will no longer turn its cheek to diplomatic attacks against it," Israeli Foreign Minister Gideon Saar said.

Sport

Kuldeep and Asha set meet records on opening day

ATHLETICS

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

Manikanta Hoblidhar returned from a long injury lay-off to be the fastest Indian man on Day One of the 65th National Open athletics championships here on Thursday as he bid to regain his lost position at the top.

The former national record holder, returning to action after almost a year, topped the 100m heats in 10.36 seconds, then bettered it to 10.30s in the semifinals to book his place in the final. Hoblidhar had set a new NR last year with a 10.19s, only to see it snatched away as Gurindervir and Animesh Kujur took charge.

Scaling a new high: Kuldeep scaled 5.30m to claim gold. FILE PHOTO

In the men's 400m, the trio of Manu T.S., Dharamveer Chaudhary and Jay Kumar – part of the relay team at the Asian Games – expectedly did not turn up while M.R. Poovamma gave the event a miss among the women. In their absence, Railways' Vikrant Panchal was the fastest in 45.88 seconds, the only sub-46 of the meet.

Kiran Pahal, who ran the first leg for the women's 4x400m relay, did participate and clocked the fastest time across all heats in 54.33s.

However, she pulled out of the semifinals and in the absence of the big names, Rajasthan's Nitisha clocked 53.80s to be the fastest on the day and advance to the final, along with talented youngster Priya Mohan.

On the field, the newest national record holder and local favourite Nirbhay Chaudhary was the best in hammer throw with two 69m efforts, taking gold with 69.42m on his fourth attempt.

Kuldeep Kumar, who finished 10th in pole vault at Asian Games, won with a new meet record of 5.30m. Seema Kaliramna, meanwhile, firmed her reputation as India's best woman discus thrower with a 57.63m gold, almost 5m better than the second-placed Nitika Kumari.

Long jumper Shaili Singh, who narrowly missed out a medal at the Asian Games finishing fourth, made her triple jump debut on Thursday and finished third with 13.31m even as Asha Ilango cleared 13.89m for gold, matching her lifetime best and setting a new meet record.

The results: Men: 10,000m: 1. Shivaji Madappa (RSPB, 30:30.54), 2. Gaurav Mathur (Del, 30:36.33), 3. Vinod Singh (MP, 30:37.13). **Pole vault:** 1. Kuldeep Kumar (MP, 5.30m-NMR; old: 5.15m, Prashant Kanhiya), 2. Reegan G (SSCB, 5.25m), 3. Rambeer (SSCB, 5.10m). **Hammer:** 1. Nirbhay Chaudhary (Del, 69.42m), 2. Praveen Kumar (RSPB, 67.73m), 3. Ashish Jakhar (SSCB, 66.86m). **Women: 100m:** 1. Giridharani Ravikumar (RSPB, 11.48s), 2. Srabani Nanda (Odi, 11.55s), 3. Priyanka Sikarwar (AIPSCB, 11.59s). **5000m:** 1. Shampa Gain (Ben, 16:54.56), 2. Sonam Parmar (MP, 16:56.52), 3. Vandana Mori (Guj, 16:56.62). **Discus:** 1. Seema Kaliramna (Har, 57.63m), 2. Nikita Kumari (Raj, 52.48m), 3. Sanya Yadav (Har, 52.45m). **Triple jump:** 1. Asha Ilango (TN, 13.89m-NMR; old: 13.78m, Mayookha Johny), 2. Bhairabi Roy (RSPB, 13.36m), 3. Shaili Singh (U.P., 13.31m).

Manish enters the semifinals

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Defending champion and top seed Manish Sureshkumar fought back from a 0-3 deficit in the decider to beat Parth Aggarwal 6-1, 5-7, 7-5 and set up a semifinal against doubles partner Nitin Sinha at the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis here on Thursday.

In women's singles, two-time champion Vaidehee Chaudhari outlasted fifth seed Aditi Rawat 6-0, 1-6, 6-2 to reach the last four.

The results (quarterfinals): Men: Manish Sureshkumar bt Parth Aggarwal 6-1, 5-7, 7-5; Nitin Sinha bt Rohan Mehra 7-6(5), 7-5; Maan Kesharwani bt Pranav Karthik 6-2, 6-4; Suraj R. Prabodh bt R. Jaisinghani 6-3, 6-4. **Women:** Vaidehee Chaudhari bt Aditi Rawat 6-0, 1-6, 6-2; Shruti Ahlawat bt Sohini Mohanty 6-4, 6-4; Soha Sadiq bt Akanksha Nitture 3-0 (retd.); Sonal Patil bt Laxmi Siri Dandu 7-6(6), 6-4; **U-18: Boys:** Om Ramesh Patel bt Aditya Mor 6-4, 6-2; Srikar Doni bt Raghav Sarode 6-2, 6-2; Yashwin Dahiya bt Veer Jiten Madam 3-6, 6-4, 7-5; Ribhav Saroha bt N. Badrinarayanan 2-6, 6-3, 6-2; **Girls:** Aahan Aahan bt S. Bhuvaneswaran 6-4, 6-2; Parthsarthi Mundhe bt Iha Joshi 6-1, 4-6, 6-1; Riddhi Shinde bt Shreeniti Chowdhury 7-6(3), 1-6, 6-2; Harsha Oruganti bt Anjhalle Meka 6-1, 6-1.

Smooth sailing: Shruti Ahlawat beat Sohini Mohanty in straight sets to reach the last four. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

LIVE TELECAST

India-A vs Australia-A: Second 'ODI', JioHotstar, 9 a.m.
Afghanistan vs Bangladesh: One-off Test, day 1, 11 a.m.
South Africa vs Australia: First Test, day 1, FanCode, 1 p.m.
Formula One: Singapore GP (Sprint Shootout), F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 6 p.m.
India vs West Indies: Second T20I, Star Sports 2 & JioHotstar, 7 p.m.

WESTERN RAILWAY

MATERIAL MANAGEMENT DEPARTMENT

VARIOUS MATERIALS SUPPLY

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE No. S/60/2026, Date 06.10.2026

S.N.	TENDER NO	SHORT DESCRIPTION OF ITEM	QUANTITY	T.O.D.
484	23260917A	Distributor Valve	524 Nos	11-Nov-26
485	27267001	Rate Contract for Harsco make TRT Machine working on various divisions of Western Railway for period of Two Years i.e. 2027-28 and 2028-29	1 Set	9-Nov-26
486	15260501	High capacity thermoplastic polyester elastomer (HYTREL) upper washer for primary suspension	4153 Nos	9-Nov-26
487	22265070	Roof Sealing Rubber	898 Nos	4-Nov-26
488	09263033	Application Magnet Valve	440 Nos	3-Nov-26
489	24262567	Synthetic Biodegradable Flowable Lubricant with an NLGI consistency of 00 or 000	7595 KG	2-Nov-26
490	09265019	3-Phase MEMU Traction Motor	2 Nos	2-Nov-26

Regarding detailed notice EMD, Purchase restrictions and detailed tender conditions, please visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** and **wr.indianrailways.gov.in** **0678**

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जिला परिषद् कार्यालय, जामताड़ा

Email Id: zilaparishad_jamtara@yahoo.com

निविदा रद्दीकरण सूचना

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय के अल्पकालीन ई0–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–ZILA/PARISHAD/JAMTARA/08/2026-27, PR-389916 Rural Development (26-27)D को अपरिहाय कारणवश रद्द किया जाता है।

ह0/–
जिला अभियंता
जिला परिषद्, जामताड़ा।

PR 391314 Rural Development(26-27)D

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

For and on behalf of President of India, the DRM(Engg)/Adra invites 03 (Three) no. e-tender for Tactile Tiles and Ramps, FOB and Misc. Works as mentioned hereunder: **Sl. No.** 1, **Tender No. E-DRM-Engg-ADRA-106-26, Dtd.07.10.2026 Description of Works:** Provision of standard tactile tiles and ramps for Divyangjan at different stations under the jurisdiction of ADEN/East/Adra in connection with the work of provision of 100% compliance of Divyangjan amenities over all NSG category stations of Adra division. **Tender value (₹):** 2,74,52,151.82; **Sl. No.** 2, **Tender No. E-DRM-Engg-ADRA-107-26, Dtd. 07.10.2026, Description of works:** (1) Provision of standard tactile tiles and ramps for Divyangjan at different station under the jurisdiction of ADEN/PURULIA in connection with the work of provision of 100% compliance of Divyangjan amenities over all NSG category stations of Adra division (2) Improvement/ upgradation of RPF Barrack Chandil & Anara of Adra Division. **Tender value (₹):** 6,84,41,006.93; **Sl. No.** 3, **Tender No. E-DRM-Engg-ADRA-108-26, Dtd. 07.10.2026, Description of works:** Construction of FOB in connection with the work extension of all lines with provision of PQRS line beside DN loop line and provision of UP passenger Platform at Ondagram station. **Tender value (₹):** 2,26,71,167.07. The closing date and time of e-tenders is on 03.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs. Details of above e-tenders may please be seen at website **www.ireps.gov.in.** **(PR-879)**

झारखण्ड सरकार
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह

ई–प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना

(प्रथम निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना)

ई–निविदा प्रसंग सं० :– RCD/GIRIDIH/1241/2026-27

दिनांक :– 08.10.2026

1.	कार्य का नाम	बरगंडा चौक से कॉलेज मोड़ भाया पावर हाऊस पथ (कुल लम्बाई – 2.715 कि0मी0) के चौड़ीकरण एवं मजबूतीकरण/ पुनर्निर्माण कार्य (भू–अर्जन, Utility Shifting, R&R एवं Plantation सहित) वर्ष 2026–27
2.	प्राक्कलित राशि (रूपये में)	रू0 13,64,81,386.00 (तेरह करोड़ चौंसठ लाख एकासी हजार तीन सौ छियासी रूपये मात्र)
3.	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	03 (तीन) माह
4.	निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	02.11.2026 12:00 बजे दिन तक
5.	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशित होने की तिथि एवं समय	10.10.2026 10:30 बजे पूर्वाह्न
6.	निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले का नाम एवं पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह।
7.	प्रोक्योरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क नं०	06532 – 227054
8.	ई–प्रोक्योरमेट सेल का हेल्प लाईन नं०	0651 – 2401010

अतिरिक्त जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट पर देखें :– **http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in**

ह०/–
कार्यपालक अभियंता,
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह।

PR.NO.391382 Road(26-27):D

THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, TESTING AND COMMISSIONING WORKS

Tender Notice No. S&T_CON_2026_01. Open tender through e-Tendering system is invited from experienced and reputed contractor(s)/firm(s) for the following works: **Tender No. DyCSTE_C_SCL_2026_01_01. Name of work:** Supply, Installation, Testing and commissioning of Integrated Tunnel Communication Systems, OFC based industrial grade network system including laying of OFC & other cables for Railway network which includes tunnels and stations in Awangkhul-Noney section of Jiribam - Imphal new Railway Line project. **Tender value:** ₹39,16,15,112.55/- **Earnest Money:** ₹78,32,300/-.**Date & Time of closing of tender:** At **15.00** hrs. **& opening at: 15.30** hrs. on **27-10-2026**. The complete information and tender document of above e-Tender will be available at **www.ireps.gov.in**

CSTE/CON/II/Maligaon

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
(Construction Organisation)
Serving Customers With A Smile

SUPPLY WORKS

E-Tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works: **SN. 1. Tender No.: DB265512. PL Code (Group): 335105580014. Description:** Complete WSP system from M/s. Faiveley Transport Rail Technologies India Private Ltd for LHB coaches (QPC of all items be as per RDSO/2011/CG-04 rev.03 or latest. All items required for installation & commissioning of WSP set on coach has to be provided by supplier.) [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹3,02,490/-. **Date & Time of closing of tender: 11:30** hrs. of **02-11-2026.** The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available in website **www.ireps.gov.in**

Deputy Chief Material Manager, Dibrugarh

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, MINOR IRRIGATION DIVISION, HAZARIBAG.

e-Procurement Tender Notice Two Envelope System
Tender Reference No. :- DMFT/MID/HAZARIBAG/F2-40/2025-26 (2nd Call)
Letter no - 1073 **Date :- 08.10.2026**

1.	Name of the work	Construction of P.C.C road from Basariya P.W.D road of Panchayat - Basariya via Gudiya Pond to Amjhar kalikaran road, Village- Basariya, Panchayat- Basariya, Block- Chouparan, District- Hazaribag
2.	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	**Rs.- 1,29,65,500.00**
3.	Time of Completion	11 Months
4.	Date of Publication of e-Tender on website	12.10.2026 at 1:00 P.M **(e-Procurement Portal- http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)**
5.	Last date/Time for Submission of e-Tender bids Online	28.10.2026 up to 5:00 P.M
6.	Last Date for Online Submission of Tender Fee and EMD	28.10.2026 up to 5:00 P.M
7.	Date of opening of e-Tender	30.10.2026 at 03:00 P.M
8.	Name & address of office Inviting tender	Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation Division, Hazaribag
9.	Contact no. of e-Procurement officer	06546-270485
10.	E-mail of e- Procurement officer	eemidhbg-cemr-jhr@nic.in

Note:- 1.) Only e-Tender will be accepted.
2.) Published Estimated Cost may be increased or decreased.
3.) Further details can be seen and Mode of Submission of Online Tender/Tender Fee/EMD through http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

PR 391390 **Executive Engineer,**
(Minor Irrigation)26-27*D **Minor Irrigation Division,Hazaribag.**

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS

PRADHANMANTRI KAUSHAL VIKAS YOJNA
RAIL KAUSHAL VIKAS YOJNA

Notice for the application of 'Kaushal Vikas Training Program' in Fitter, Welder and Machinist Trade for the Month of November' 2026.

A short term (3 weeks) Kaushal Vikas Training Program (Skill Development) **(For the month of November' 2026)** is being organized by CLW/Chittaranjan for the Youth under 'RAIL KAUSHAL VIKAS YOJNA'. Total 25 Nos. male/female each for Fitter and Welder Trade & 15 Nos. Machinist will be selected for this Training program and this program is **free of cost.**

Eligibility: 1. Matriculation (10th Standard pass) **2. Age:** 18-35 Years (as on 07.10.2026).

Application:- **Online at www.railkvy.indianrailway.gov.in website** from 08.10.2026 (00:00 hrs.) to 21.10.2026 (23:59 hrs.). Application forms can be downloaded from website or can be obtained from Technical Training Centre/Near Children park, Chittaranjan, West Bengal-713331 from where help may be taken to submit form ONLINE in prescribed time.

OFFLINE FORM SHALL NOT BE ENTERTAINED.

For Assistance: May contact to
Sri Hussain Ali (Assistant lecturer/Mech.), Mobile No. 9332563474.

Detailed information is available at Notifications of the above website **www.railkvy.indianrailway.gov.in**

Principal
Technical Training Centre
CLW/CHITTARANJAN

PR3/515

Like us on: www.facebook.com/clwrailways

जल संसाधन विभाग

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
घोड़ासहन नहर प्रमण्डल, रक्सौल
Email-ID :eegcdraxaul@gmail.com Mob- 7463889660

अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–02/SBD/2026–27

राष्ट्रीय स्पर्द्धा निविदा आमंत्रण

(केवल ई–टेन्डर पद्धति के अनुसार बेबसाईट https://eproc2bihar.gov.in पर)

–:शुद्धि पत्र:–

इस कार्यालय का पत्रांक–1317, दिनांक– 29.09.2026 के द्वारा अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0– 02/SBD/2026–27 जिसका PR No.-012945(WRD)2026-27 के माध्यम से दैनिक समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित किया गया है के अंतर्गत टंकण भूलवश क्र0 सं0– 05 पर अंकित पर अंकित प्री बीड मीटिंग की तिथि दिनांक 12.09.2026 एवं क्र0 सं0– 09 पर अंकित निविदा की वैद्यता अवधि 90 दिन अंकित हो गया था, जिसे क्र0 सं0– 05 पर अंकित पर अंकित प्री बीड मीटिंग की तिथि दिनांक 12.09.2026 के स्थान पर दिनांक 12.10.2026 एवं क्र0 सं0– 09 पर अंकित निविदा की वैद्यता अवधि 90 दिन के स्थान पर 120 दिन पढ़ा जाय।

निविदा की अन्य सभी नियम एवं शर्तें यथावत् रहेंगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
घोड़ासहन नहर प्रमण्डल रक्सौल

PR- 013318 (WRD) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
(Single Stage Two Packet System on EPC mode basis)

Chief Electrical Engineer, Project, North Western Railway, Jaipur for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-Tender. Tenderer shall on-line submit their original/revised offer before the date and time of closing of E-tender. **1. E-Tender Notice No:** EL-PROJ-PSI-All-EPC-01; **2. Name of work with location:** Design, Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 132/55 KV Traction Substation, Sectioning post (SPs) and Sub sectioning post (SSPs) in 2 x25 KV Traction System (Scott Connected Transformer) in Madar(MD)-Bhinwaliya (BWA) section of Ajmer Division of North Western Railway. **3. Approximate cost of work:** Rs. 260,40,64,851.18/- **4. Earnest Money to be deposited:** Rs. 5,20,81,300.00/-; **5. Completion Period:** 720 Days; **6. Closing Date & Time of submission of on-line E-tender:** 08/12/2026(13:00 hrs.); **7. Website particulars where complete details of E-Tender can be seen: www.ireps.gov.in. Note:** No manual tender will be accepted.

1443-AM/26

Please join us on /NWRailways

SANJAY GANDHI POSTGRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES

Raebareli Road, Lucknow-226014 (U.P.)
Phones: 0522-2494038
Email : jdmm@sgpgi.ac.in, jdmmsgpgims@gmail.com

e-TENDER NOTICE

Online offers are invited in Two bid system **(1) Technical Bid** with Checklist, Essential Documents, Technical details of required products including catalogue etc. **(2) Price Bid as per BOQ,** from reputed & genuine manufacturers/their authorized importers/authorized distributors/Dealers (declared by Principal Firm only), for executing a rate contract for **Anti-Hemophilic Factors** for a period of 02 (two) years.

The bidders are required to submit their online offers on e-tender portal only i.e. **www.etender.up.nic.in** in two bids system as mentioned above. For detailed information like Tender Number, Name of Item, Specifications, Terms & Conditions, Last date of Submission of online offer against tender, Earnest Money Deposit, Opening of Technical Bids, etc., you may please visit the e-tender portal **www.etender.up.nic.in.** The tender documents will be uploaded on e-tender portal within a week. The offers will be accepted On-line only on e-tender portal with terms and conditions as mentioned in tender documents. No offers shall be accepted off-line.

The Director reserves the right to accept or reject any offer partially or fully without assigning any reason.

Advt. No.:- I/54/JDMM/2026-27 **DIRECTOR**

Co-operative Department

Govt. of Bihar

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Insurance Companies as implementing agency (IA) under "Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)" for Rabi 2026-27 season.

Co-operative Department, Government of Bihar, Patna invited Request for Proposals under single-bid system (financial) from empanelled Insurance Companies (ICs) for implementation of PMFBY during Rabi 2026-27 season. The details of the same are presented under terms of reference of this RFP:-

Scheme Name	Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)
Bid Submission Mode	https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in/
Date of Issue of Tender Document	09/10/2026
Last date for receiving queries	12/10/2026
Date & time for Pre-Bid Meeting (at least one week before tender submission date)	13/10/2026 at 03:00 PM
Pre-Bid Meeting Venue	Co-operative Department, Bihar, Patna, 2nd Floor, Vikash Bhawan, New Secretariat, Patna -800015
Last date and time for submission of Financial Bid	27/10/2026
Date of opening of financial bid	28/10/2026
Mode of Financial Bid submission	Online
Venue of Financial Bid opening	Co-operative Department, Bihar, Patna, 2nd Floor, Vikash Bhawan, New Secretariat, Patna -800015
Contact Person and phone no for all queries	Shri Samresh Kumar, JR-CS Mob No: +91 9122484840
Email ID for all queries	cooperative-bihar@nic.in
Address for communication	Co-operative Department, Bihar, Patna, 2nd Floor, Vikash Bhawan, New Secretariat, Patna -800015
Addendum/Corrigendum	To be uploaded on https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in/ as and when such addendum/corrigendum is issued

Empanelled Insurance Companies are encouraged to apply. The service is required for only Rabi 2026-27 season, starting from the date of issue of the Work Order. The tender can be downloaded from the website https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in

(Bikash Kumar Bariar)
Additional Registrar (Judicial)
Co-operative Societies,
Bihar, Patna.

PR- 013377 (Co-operative) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

झारखण्ड सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता, का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, पाकुड़

ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई– निविदा सूचना संख्या – **RDD/SD/PAKUR/06/2026-27**

01. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :

ग्रुप सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रधन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
01	पाकुड़ जिला के प्रखण्ड पाकुड़िया पंचायत खजूरडंगाल ग्राम सागबेरिया और गांगमुण्डी के बीच पगला नदी पर पुल निर्माण	30073100.00	601500.00	10,000.00	18 (Eighteen Month)
02	पाकुड़ जिला के प्रखण्ड पाकुड़िया पंचायत लागडुम ग्राम लागडुम चिरुडीह सुदा टोला से छोटा बरमसिया आर0ई0ओ0 पथ के बीच पुलिया निर्माण	26662100.00	533300.00	10,000.00	18 (Eighteen Month)
03	पाकुड़ जिला के प्रखण्ड महेशपुर गायबथान ग्राम गायबथान दुकानटोला से बरमसिया के बीच नाला पर पुल निर्माण।	21548100.00	431000.00	10,000.00	15 (Fifteen Month)

02. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 12.10.2026
03. ऑनलाईन परिमाण विपत्र क्रय करने की तिथि एवं समय–दिनांक–12.10.2026 से दिनांक–22.10.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
04. निविदा में संशोधन/वापसी की अंतिम तिथि–17.11.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
05. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक 23.10.2026 से दिनांक 13.11.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
06. ई–निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, पाकुड।
07. ई–निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय –19.11.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे।
08. ई–निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :– कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, पाकुड।
09. ई–निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 9955549665 (संबंधित कार्यपालक अभियंता का दूरभाष नम्बर)।
10. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट–बढ़ सकती है तद्नुसार अग्रधन की राशि देय होगी।
11. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
12. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि का ई–भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रधन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, पाकुड़

PR 391347 Rural Work Department(26-27)#D

Govt. of Bihar

Bihar Medical Services & Infrastructure Corporation Limited,
3rd floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura,
Adjacent to State Health Society, Patna 800014,
Phone/Fax: +91612 2283287,+ 91612 2283288
Mo. No- 8544402312, 9971559020

(Notice Inviting E-Bids)

Tender for the Procurement, Rate Contract and Supply of Medical Equipment for different Govt. Health Institutions of Bihar.

Notice Inviting Tender No.-BMSICL/2026-27/ME-512
(Only through E- Tender on website:-https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

The Bihar Medical Services and Infrastructure Corporation Limited, Patna invites e-bids from interested parties for Procurement, Rate Contract and supply of Medical Equipment for different Government Health Institutions of Bihar as listed below:-

SL.No	Name of Equipment	SL.No	Name of Equipment
1	Stretcher	2	Cylinder Trolley
3	Instrument trolley	4	Patient Trolley
5	Surgical Trolley	6	Equipment Trolley
7	Cardiac Table	8	Paediatric ICU Bed
9	Medicine Trolley	10	Foot Stool

Tender Schedule

Tender Reference No.	BMSICL/2026-27/ME-512
Date of Pre- Bid Meeting	14thOCTOBER 2026 at 15:00 Hrs in Conference hall of BMSICL, 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Adjacent to State Health Society, Patna (Bihar) **All Pre-bid queries to be submitted through e-mail on** bmsicltenderequipment@gmail.com **Upto 16thOCTOBER 2026 till 17:00 Hrs. (Note:- No Pre-bid queries would be entertained after the above mentioned dead line)**
Last date and time of submission of online bids	05th NOVEMBER 2026 upto 17:00 Hrs.
Last date and time for submission of original documents of EMD.	06th NOVEMBER 2026 upto 14:00 Hrs.
Date, Time and Place of opening of Technical Bid	06th NOVEMBER 2026 (at 15:00 Hrs.) on the website of **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in** the office of BMSICL
Date and time of opening of financial Bids	To be announced later on **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**
Validity of Tender	180 Days
Cost of the tender document	Rs.11,800/- (Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred Rupees only) Non-refundable.
Tender Processing Fee	Rs 1180/- (on the website of **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**)

1. To participate in E-Tendering the tenderer will have to be registered with E-Tendering service provider. For this help desk – mjunction services limited RJ complex, 2nd Floor, Canara Bank, Campus, khajpura, Ashiana road, P.S –Shastri Nagar, Patna-800014, Toll Free No.-18005726571, Email-ID: eproc2support@bihar.gov.in can be approached.
2. Note: Please number the documents with serial number on each and every page and do mention the total number of pages of bidding document. In technical Bid parallel assign, the corresponding page numbers of supporting documents. Any discrepancy or misrepresentation in this aspect will not be entertained.
3. Any queries and questions regarding the tender should be addressed to MD BMSICL (either through letter or through e-mail:- md-bmsicl-bih@nic.in and/or bmsicl.equipment @gmail.com or contact no. 0612-2219634/35) up to 7 days before of closing of online bid registration.
4. All communication, addendum/corrigendum related to this tender will be issued on the website of http://.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
5. Managing Director, BMSICL reserves the right to reject any or all the applications without assigning any reason.

Note- Changes suggested by prospective bidder in Pre-Bid meeting July be incorporated in the tender document at the sole discretion of the tender inviting authority and for which corrigendum will be issued separately and uploaded on the website http://.eproc2.bihar.gov.in & www.bmsicl.gov.in

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

GM (Procurement)
BMSICL, Patna

PR. No. 013268 (B&C) 2026-27

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

Bihar Medical Services & Infrastructure Corporation Limited,
3rd floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura,
Adjacent to State Health Society, Patna 800014,
Phone/Fax: +91612 2283287,+ 91612 2283288, Mo. No- 8544402312, 9971559020

Govt. of Bihar

(Notice Inviting E-Bids)

Tender for the Procurement, Rate Contract and Supply of Medical Equipment for different Govt. Health Institutions of Bihar.

Notice Inviting Tender No.-BMSICL/2026-27/ME-516

(Only through E- Tender on website:-https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

The Bihar Medical Services and Infrastructure Corporation Limited, Patna invites e-bids from interested parties for Procurement, Rate Contract and supply of Medical Equipment for different Government Health Institutions of Bihar as listed below:-

SL.No	Name of Equipment	SL.No	Name of Equipment
1	Finger Exerciser Web	2	Shoulder Pulley
3	Shoulder Wheel	4	Wall Ladder Finger Exerciser

Tender Schedule

Tender Reference No.	BMSICL/2026-27/ME-516
Date of Pre- Bid Meeting	13thOctober 2026 at 15:00 Hrs in Conference hall of BMSICL, 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Adjacent to State Health Society, Patna (Bihar) **All Pre-bid queries to be submitted through e-mail on** bmsicltenderequipment@gmail.com **Upto 15thOctober 2026 till 17:00 Hrs. (Note:- No Pre -bid queries would be entertained after the above mentioned dead line)**
Last date and time of submission of online bids	05th NOVEMBER 2026 upto 17:00 Hrs.
Last date and time for submission of original documents of EMD.	06th NOVEMBER 2026 upto 14:00 Hrs.
Date, Time and Place of opening of Technical Bid	06th NOVEMBER 2026 (at 15:00 Hrs.) on the website of **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in** the office of BMSICL
Date and time of opening of financial Bids	To be announced later on **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**
Validity of Tender	180 Days
Cost of the tender document	Rs.11,800/- (Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred Rupees only) Non-refundable.
Tender Processing Fee	Rs 1180/- (on the website of **https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in**)

GM (Procurement)
BMSICL, Patna

PR. No. 013270 (B&C) 2026-27

For further details please visit : **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar**

अगर मन में हो एच.आई.वी. अथवा यौन जनित रोग से जुड़े सवाल तो तुरन्त 1097 पर करें कॉल।

Better late than never for Shreyas

It took the skipper his 64th try to reach three-figures for the first time in T20s; he will expect the next won't be as long in coming

SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

R Kaushik

Shreyas Iyer's return to the international 20-over set-up has been a mixed bag. Jettisoned into the wilderness for more than two and a half years from December 2023 and therefore missing out on India's back-to-back World Cup triumphs, the right-hander kept plugging away, first leading Kolkata Knight Riders to the title in 2024 and then taking Punjab Kings to the IPL final the following year. Along the way, Shreyas served notice of not just his exceptional batting skills in the middle-order but also a shrewd, calm and astute brain which, allied with his excellent man-management skills, helped him get the best out of his colleagues, India and international, at both outfits.

It's debatable if Shreyas had reconciled to more time on the T20I sidelines when Suryakumar Yadav skippered the country to a fabulous title defence at home this February-March. Suryakumar, like Shreyas also from Mumbai, was handpicked to succeed Rohit Sharma in July 2024 as India moved on to a new era in the 20-over format. Having run a fantastic ship at the home 50-over World Cup in October-November 2023 when India scythed unbeaten through the draw, only to be felled by Australia in the final, Rohit found a little bit of consolation and worthwhile silverware for his commitment to aggressive batting and to his wonderful captaincy skills by helping India lift their second T20 World Cup trophy, nearly 17 years after Mahendra Singh Dhoni had done the unthinkable in the inaugural edition in South Africa.

Within hours of that grand conquest of the Proteas in Bridgetown, Rohit followed Virat Kohli into T20I retirement. A day later, Ravindra Jadeja called time on his career too, which meant in one fell swoop, India lost a lot of experience and expertise. The process of rebuilding for the title defence, still 20 months away, began in earnest immediately. Contrary to popular perception that pointed to Rohit's World Cup deputy, Hardik Pandya, taking over as the leader, the decision-making group of chief selector Ajit Agarkar and new head coach Gautam Gambhir – Rahul Dravid's extension ended with the World Cup success – plumped for Suryakumar, mainly because question marks continued to hang over the all-rounder's sustained availability, given his repeated dalliances with injury.

Immediate impact

Suryakumar made an immediate impact as batter and captain, leading India to a 3-0 sweep in Sri Lanka in his first assignment in July 2024. But while India continued to stack up victories and dominate the T20I landscape, the dashing batter's willow started to grow cold from the beginning of 2025. He went the entire calendar year without a single half-century, an unbeaten 47 against Pakistan in the first of three consecutive showdowns in the Asia Cup in Dubai, his highest score in 19 innings. He was, however, in no danger of losing his place because his middling form wasn't doing any significant or tangible damage to the team's fortunes. The unbeaten charge to the Asia Cup crown was another feather in his captaincy cap, and when Suryakumar broke the dry run with scores of 32, 82 not out, 57 not out, 8 and 63 against New Zealand in January to kick off 2026, normal service seemed to have been restored.

His best knock in a year and a quarter came in India's World Cup opener against United States, at his home ground, the Wankhede Stadium. The foreboding sound of silence was deafening as the unfancied Americans worked their way through the Indian top-order with Shadley van Schalkwyk doing the bulk of the damage. At 77 for six in the 13th over, a seismic upset of monumental proportions loomed until the captain came charging to the rescue. Shepherding the lower-order expertly and choosing the right moments – and bowlers – to attack, Suryakumar remained unconquered on a crucial 84, off just 49 deliveries, to catalyse what in the end became a routine 29-run victory.

Unlike in the Americas in 2024 when India were unstoppable, even on the dicey surfaces in New York, the 2026 run was anything but perfect. India were crushed by South Africa in their first Super Eight encounter in Ahmedabad, which meant that if Suryakumar was to hold the trophy aloft at the same venue two weeks later, his side had to come through four consecutive must-win encounters. India were compelled to rejig their batting order to break up an all-left top three, and Sanju Samson answered the prayers by shedding a lean trot with three blazing knocks on the bounce, culminating in a breathtaking 89 against New Zealand in the title clash.

But while India gathered momentum and peaked at the right time, Suryakumar's form was patchy. He wasn't terrible – he did conjure 32 against Pakistan on a dicey Premadasa Stadium surface in Colombo, weighed in with 34 against the Netherlands and delivered the final kick with a 13-ball 33 against Zimbabwe in Chennai – which, coupled with the fact that India became the first nation to successfully defend the World Cup and to win at home, should have earned him a longer rope. At least one more assignment at the very least.

Moving on

But no. Agarkar's panel decided enough was enough, that it was time to move on post-haste from the Suryakumar era and turn to a fresh face who would be around for the next World Cup, in Australia and New Zealand in October-November 2028. Suryakumar was 35 and a half at the time of the successful defence, which further encouraged the core panel to invest in a younger man. And thus transpired the 31-year-old Shreyas' return to a format in which he had held his own, but from which he was forcibly excluded because there was no place for him in the crowded middle-order.

The contention was that Shreyas was too good a player to be picked in the 15 and be kept out of the 11, in which the marked emphasis was on multi-skilled players. Like Suryakumar, Shreyas is a batter alone, and the think-tank felt it was difficult to have both right-handers in the mix. But when the call to move on from the older Mumbaikar was made, Shreyas became an automatic choice – as batter and, in the eyes of those occupying the corridors of power, as the captain.

Shreyas must have felt the weight of the world on his shoulders on his comeback. Never mind that he had 150 international appearances across all three formats to his credit, the return to the 20-over iteration was inevitably and understandably accompanied by butterflies and nervous anticipation. His baptism was the stuff nightmares are made of. India were stunned 2-0 by Ireland and then surrendered a five-match series 4-0 in England (the first game was abandoned). Shreyas held his own with the bat – 68, 37, 5, 80 not out and 28 against the English – but he needed to start moving into the black column from the predominantly red one when it came to team victories.

The tide had to turn, because India were too good a team to keep courting defeats. They were caught out by the conditions in the United Kingdom and were slow to react and adapt, but once they travelled to Harare in July for a three-match showdown against Zimbabwe, they have embarked on a stunning course correction that has netted them 10 wins on the bounce, among them Tuesday's eight-wicket pounding of West Indies in the first of five matches in Lucknow.

On a roll

India crushed Zimbabwe 3-0, ran rings around Afghanistan in Delhi last month by an identical scoreline, then eked out a narrow two-run win over Japan in Sano just before the start of the Asian Games. It was a five-over fixture on a terribly slow pitch where the ball turned a mile and all 10 overs were sent down by the spinners. India only managed 32 in their five overs – can you even believe that? – and got somewhat lucky in restricting the Japanese to 30, but 12 days later, they defended their Asian Games gold medal with a very good win over Pakistan in the final in Nisshin.

Shreyas thus became the second Indian after Ruturaj Gaikwad to lead the cricket team to the Asiad gold, though he had the luxury of a full-strength side including Jasprit Bumrah, the perennial game-changer. While those nine victories in a row were commendable, Shreyas the batter hadn't really left a lasting impression. He did have a clutch of 20s – five of them, to be exact – but there wasn't the defining knock that he would have been desperate for.

That came on Tuesday in Lucknow. Jet-lagged and almost running on empty after having made the long haul from Nisshin to the Uttar Pradesh capital just two days before the contest – the Asian Games final was on October 3, this West Indies fixture was on October 6 – Shreyas put mind over matter in a sterling exhibition of stroke-making, comprehensively eclipsing the multitude of power-hitters under Shai Hope's command and his own trio of ball-bashers in Abhishek Sharma, Samson and Ishan Kishan.

India's bowlers had done remarkably well to bowl the visitors out for 171, and while they were not in any great danger even at 35 for two, given the depth in their batting, they needed a partnership to calm slightly jangling nerves. Enter Shreyas, stage left, to reduce it to a no-contest, embarking on a majestic display of controlled, risk-free aggression that left the former two-time World Cup winners scurrying for cover.

Dominant

Completely dominating an unbroken third-wicket stand of 137 with Kishan, Shreyas brought up his first T20I ton off the penultimate ball of the chase, off 42 deliveries. He needed just 14 balls for his second 50, courtesy six towering sixes as the ball went exactly where he intended it to. Abhishek and Kishan and some of the others have made it a fine art of battering the hapless cricket ball. Shreyas chose a less violent methodology, but the impact was still as bruising – perhaps even more so – because there is little that can match the beauty of orthodoxy even in the hustle and bustle of the 20-over version.

It took Shreyas his 64th try to reach three-figures for the first time. Given that the No. 4 slot is entirely his own – he has batted there all 17 times since assuming the captaincy mantle – one can safely surmise that the next won't be as long in coming.

THE GIST

- It's debatable if Shreyas had reconciled to more time on the T20I sidelines when Suryakumar Yadav skippered the country to a fabulous title defence in the World Cup at home earlier in the year
- Shreyas must have felt the weight of the world on his shoulders on his comeback... the return to the 20-over iteration was inevitably and understandably accompanied by butterflies and nervous anticipation
- While nine victories in a row were commendable, Shreyas the batter hadn't really left a lasting impression. He did have a clutch of 20s – five of them, to be exact – but there wasn't the defining knock that he would have been desperate for

Closing the gaps in early childhood eye care

India already has an extensive network of frontline health workers, immunisation services, school health programmes and primary and tertiary healthcare facilities; the challenge is to connect these pieces; the goal should be to build a system in which every interaction a child has with a health worker becomes an opportunity to protect vision

Vasudha Kemmanu

The World Health Organization (WHO) reports that there are approximately 19 million visually impaired children in the world, and 1.4 million are blind. In India, about 3 lakh children are said to be blind. Yet, nearly half of these cases are entirely preventable or treatable if caught in time.

While access to care continues to remain a major barrier in India, as a clinician, I am forced to confront a quiet, uncomfortable truth: threats to a child's vision are not always due to a lack of access to healthcare; they are sometimes due to a missed opportunity to identify visual problems within healthcare systems that the child has already accessed.

What happens in the system

Consider a recent encounter in my clinic. A couple walked in with their five-year-old daughter; I will call her Anu. I could immediately see that she was visually impaired. On examination, I found that Anu had dense bilateral cataracts with nystagmus (involuntary movement of the eyes). The presence of nystagmus says that the visual impairment had been present since infancy. When I asked why they had waited five years to seek help, they explained that they were simply overwhelmed as they were raising twins, and assumed it was best to wait until she was older so she could 'cooperate' during an eye examination.

Childhood eye diseases that cause profound visual impairment need to be detected and treated early. A baby is born with an immature visual system, and the development of vision happens through the interaction between the eye and the developing brain. When clear images do not reach the brain during this critical period, amblyopia, or lazy eye, can develop. Once this period of visual development has passed, treatment cannot fully restore the lost visual potential. Anu had lost the chance of getting back her vision fully, even if she was operated upon now.

What doesn't get seen

Anu had not been completely outside the healthcare system; her vaccinations were up-to-date, and she had documented encounters with health personnel seven distinct times from birth to age five. Yet, across all these visits her profound visual impairment went entirely unnoticed. Why did this happen?

One of the reasons is the poor integration of vision screening with the vaccination schedule and general paediatric screening.

India has an extensive network of frontline health workers and child health programmes. The Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK), for example, is designed to identify and manage health conditions in children from birth to 18 years. Screening programmes have demonstrated that large numbers of school-aged children with vision problems can be screened. The tools placed in the hands of mobile health teams to detect developmental delays are proven to be highly capable at the community level. What then is going wrong?

Close monitoring: As we mark World Sight Day, the question we should ask is not only how do we reach more children. It is also how many children are already within our health system whom we are failing to see. FILE PHOTO

Let's take the example of Karnataka. According to the Health & Family Welfare Department's Annual Report 2023-24, the State screened 62,45,424 children (6 to 16 years) in government and government-aided schools. But only 1.2 lakh children received spectacles, a distribution rate of just 1.9%. This is in sharp contrast to localised epidemiological studies in Karnataka's southern districts, which place the actual prevalence of paediatric refractive errors as high as 8%. This pronounced gap could be due to operational challenges such as drop-outs in the multi-tier referral system and supply chain delays. A study assessing the coverage gaps in child health screening under RBSK found that only 47.4% of children detected to have health problems received further care, indicating a significant treatment gap.

Even if the system successfully flags a child, the path from detection to actual restoration of sight remains riddled with problems. Independent field evaluations in Tumkur highlight that the system has problems when dealing with younger children and follow-up care. The management process faces significant on-the-ground challenges, including parental non-cooperation for follow-up, logistical barriers, and potential training gaps among screening teams. In my own experience, when talking to ASHA workers in Tumkur district, they said they did not have the training required to detect eye diseases in children. If the parents or caregiver specifically complained about vision related issues, the ASHA workers referred them to the paediatrician who visited the taluk hospital once a week. This exposes a

Preventing blindness in a child is not merely about saving sight; it is about protecting education, independence and the opportunity to reach their full potential

significant gap in training frontline workers. There is no need for an entirely new system. We need to make better use of the system that already exists.

A simple red reflex examination using the direct ophthalmoscope is one example. The test takes less than 30 seconds, does not require a child to cooperate verbally, and can identify major, sight and life-threatening abnormalities such as cataract, retinoblastoma (eye cancer) and high refractive errors. RBSK mobile health teams, primary health centre nurses, and paediatric residents must be trained to perform this test. This simple check must become as routine as measuring a child's weight and must get incorporated in the immunisation schedule, so it is never missed.

We need to train ASHA workers in simple ways of assessing visual behaviour in infants and young children who cannot read a chart or respond reliably to conventional visual-acuity testing. Can the infant fix and follow light and objects? Is there visual engagement? Is there an abnormal or asymmetric corneal light reflex suggesting a squint? These are not sophisticated examinations. They are observations that, with appropriate training and referral protocols, can help identify children who need an eye examination.

A child identified with a possible eye problem must reach the appropriate facility where treatment is available. Referral pathways need to be clear, practical and monitored. Where possible, digital systems could link frontline screening with appointments at district or tertiary eye-care facilities. Tele-ophthalmology could also help connect peripheral health workers with specialists and reduce some of the logistical barriers that cause families to drop out of care.

Looking ahead

India already has an extensive network of frontline health workers, immunisation services, RBSK teams, school health programmes, and primary and tertiary healthcare facilities. The challenge now is to connect these pieces. The goal, therefore, should not be to merely increase the number of children screened. It should be to build a system in which every contact with a child is an opportunity to protect vision, every abnormal finding triggers a clear referral, and every referral is followed through to care.

As we mark World Sight Day, the question we should ask is not only how do we reach more children. It is also how many children are already within our health system whom we are failing to see. For children like Anu, preventing blindness in a child is not merely about saving sight, it is about protecting education, independence and the opportunity to reach their full potential.

(Dr. Vasudha Kemmanu is a paediatric ophthalmologist and a public eye health specialist at Narayana Nethralaya, Rajaji Nagar, Bengaluru. vasudhakemmanu@gmail.com)

THE GIST

- The WHO reports that there are approximately 19 million visually impaired children in the world, and 1.4 million are blind. In India, about 3 lakh children are said to be blind. Nearly half of these cases are entirely preventable or treatable if caught in time
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- There is no need for an entirely new system. We need to make better use of the system that already exists. Screening programmes have demonstrated that large numbers of school-aged children with vision problems can be checked

Nurse-led coordinated care can reduce heart failure mortality, finds study

C. Maya

A large randomised controlled trial among heart failure patients in India led by the Sree Chitra Tirunal Institute for Medical Sciences and Technology (SCTIMST) in Kerala, has found that hospitalisation episodes and all-cause mortality among heart failure patients can be significantly reduced if patients are systematically followed-up by a nurse, with the help of a mobile health application.

The two-year Telemonitoring and Integrated Multidisciplinary care for Heart Failure (TIME-HF) trial found that heart failure patients with reduced ejection fraction (HFrEF) who received nurse-led collaborative care had a 22% lower risk of death than those receiving usual care. They were also more likely to remain alive without hospitalisation during the two-year follow-up.

The trial results were published in the American Heart Association's Journal, Circulation, on August 30.

What makes the trial relevant is that it addresses critical gaps in heart failure care:in Keralam, heart failure registries have reported high mortality post-discharge – 82.7% mortality over 10 years, alongside the fact fact that only 25.4% of the patients with heart failure receive guideline-based therapies. It also holds lessons for the rest of the country: with nearly 27% of all deaths in India being due to heart disease, and 62% of all deaths due to cardiovascular disease occurring between the ages of 40 and 69 years, there is an urgent need for quality, post-discharge care.

What the trial did

The TIME-HF trial involved 1,507 adults at 22 government and private hospitals in Keralam and neighbouring States, with 755 patients assigned to the intervention and 752 to usual care. The mean age was 61.9 years; 77.6% were men, 57.3% lived in rural areas and 70% had relatively low educational attainment. Ischaemic heart disease was the predominant cause of heart failure, accounting for 77.4% of cases.

The two-year trial found that heart failure patients who received nurse-led collaborative care had a 22% lower risk of death than those receiving usual care. GETTY IMAGES

Results indicated that nurse-led intervention substantially improved prescription of the four major components of guideline-directed medical therapy for heart failure – renin-angiotensin system inhibition/ARNI, beta-blockers, mineralocorticoid receptor antagonists and SGLT2 inhibitors.

"Our heart failure patients receive sub-optimal care, as most of them do not adhere to therapies or follow up with the doctor on time. There is also the issue of physician inertia. HF Registry evidence indicates that the median survival after diagnosis of heart failure is just 3.7 years. This collaborative care model is proof that survival and quality of life of these patients can be improved if we systematically address the gaps in care so that proven therapies for heart failure become part of routine care," said lead researcher and additional professor at SCTIMST P. Jeemon.

Centring nursing care

The model put a trained nurse at the centre of the care pathway, who would closely monitor heart failure patients after discharge, educate the patient and family about heart-failure self-care, lifestyle modification and encourage medication adherence.

Nurses reviewed the patients' medication regimen at discharge to ensure that there was no deviation from the guideline-mediated therapies. This was again reviewed at every follow-up visit with the help of a mobile-health app. The m-health app helped the nurses monitor all physical parameters of the patient real time and to identify warning signs of worsening disease, communicate and connect with patients and physicians so that timely hospitalisation was possible.

All participants underwent scheduled follow-up visits every three months for two years. Adherence to all four guideline-directed medical therapies was only 22.1% in the usual-care group, while it was 37.3% in the intervention group at two years.

The TIME-HF trial thus helped address one of the health system's persistent weaknesses: that of proper follow-up care of patients with chronic diseases. The model is suited for strengthening chronic disease management and reducing the burden of hospitalisation and mortality in resource-limited settings across the country, experts said.

(maya.c@thehindu.co.in)

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Aid provided for each damaged house in West Bengal floods

1.8 in ₹ lakh. West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Thursday said his government will provide ₹1.8 lakh aid each to families whose houses were fully damaged in the floods in Malda district, and ₹90,000 for partially affected homes. He announced ₹242 crore as compensation for 24,595 affected families in Manikchak, Ratua and English Bazar areas of Malda. PTI

Number of terrorist groups operating in Afghanistan

25 Pakistan Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi on Thursday told UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres that 25 terrorist organisations were operating in Afghanistan and called for international cooperation to tackle the threat, according to a government statement. His remarks came amid heightened tensions between Pakistan and Afghanistan. PTI

Year-on-year rise in cost of home-cooked meals in September

10 in per cent. The cost of a home-cooked vegetarian thali rose 10% year-on-year in September, driven by higher prices of onion, vegetable oil, rice and LPG, according to a report released on Thursday. Non-vegetarian thali increased 6% as broiler prices increased more slowly, according to Crisil's monthly Roti Rice Rate report. PTI

Syrian nationals missing after drone sinks Black Sea ship

9 Nine Syrian sailors are missing following a drone strike that sank a commercial ship off the coast of Bulgaria, a Syrian official said on Thursday, after rescuers called off search operations. Bulgarian authorities said no survivors had been found from the ship after drones hit two commercial vessels early on Tuesday in the Black Sea, the latest fallout from the Ukraine-Russia war in recent months. AFP

Number of people killed in Russia's strike on buses in Ukraine

30 Ukraine on Thursday accused Russia of deliberately targeting civilians after 30 people were killed when two buses were blown up in the frontline city of Kramatorsk, in one of the deadliest single attacks in weeks. Photos posted by local authorities showed the burnt-out metal shells of the vehicles. AFP

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Why stubble fires keep coming back

Stubble burning is the result of a combination of legal, technological and economic factors, including the paddy-wheat cycle, assured procurement and a narrow window between crops; a lasting solution needs stronger incentives for diversification, better residue management and more reliable measurement of burning

FULL CONTEXT

C.S.C.Sekhar

It is that time of the year when air pollution in North India, and in Delhi in particular, takes centre stage in public discourse. One oft-cited reason for the worsening air quality index (AQI) is stubble burning by farmers.

Why farmers burn stubble

Stubble burning is the practice of setting fire to crop residue, consisting of the lower parts of plants left after harvesting. This practice is prevalent from the beginning of October to the end of November across northwest India, especially in Punjab, Haryana, and parts of Uttar Pradesh. Stubble burning is mainly associated with the burning of paddy straw in Punjab and Haryana, which together produce around 29 million metric tons of paddy straw. Stubble burning releases large amounts of particulate matter, carbon monoxide, volatile organic compounds (VOCs), and other carcinogenic substances, which together form a thick smog that can harm human health. It also leads to a loss of soil fertility by depleting nitrogen, sulphur, potash, phosphorus, and other micronutrients. The heat generated by stubble burning results in a loss of soil moisture and organic content, which, in turn, leads to increased use of fertilizers in the next crop cycle.

Stubble burning is not a new phenomenon. It has been practised in Punjab since the late 1970s and early 1980s, largely following the introduction of combine harvesters, which leave a portion of the plant in the soil after harvesting. What has changed is its timing, which now coincides with the winter months in North India. This shift in timing followed the enactment of the Punjab Preservation of Sub-Soil Water Act, 2009 (PPSSWA 2009).

In 2012, nearly 73% of the cropped area in Punjab was irrigated using groundwater resources. There was a deficit of 14.31 billion cubic metres, which was met through excessive withdrawal of groundwater. Groundwater levels in Punjab declined at an alarming rate of 0.36 metres annually between 1999 and 2009, driven by intense over-exploitation for agriculture. A landmark NASA GRACE satellite study in 2009 showed that the region comprising Punjab, Haryana and Rajasthan lost 109 cubic kilometres of groundwater between 2002 and 2008 alone, which was considered the largest instance of groundwater depletion in the world at the time.

Water crisis

The PPSSWA 2009 was a result of this alarming situation. The main goal of the Act was to prevent rapid groundwater depletion by prohibiting early paddy nursery sowing and transplantation before the arrival of the monsoon rains. The Act prohibited farmers from sowing paddy before May 10 and transplanting it before June 10, thus delaying paddy transplantation to align with the monsoon season. To ensure compliance, the Act prescribed stringent punishments. Implementing officers were authorised to destroy paddy sown in contravention of the Act and impose a penalty of ₹10,000 per hectare for every month of contravention. These actions by officials were also exempt from legal scrutiny

These sowing restrictions under PPSSWA 2009 pushed the paddy harvest to late October and early November, leaving farmers a narrow 10-15-day window to prepare their fields for the next wheat crop and reducing the time available for sowing. The PUSA-44 variety, which produces higher yields but takes 150-160 days to harvest, further narrowed the window between paddy harvesting and wheat sowing. Combine harvesters, which leave about a foot of stubble behind, put heavy pressure on farmers to clear the crop residue in a very short time. Manual clearing is time-consuming and expensive. Together, these factors made stubble burning almost a necessity for farmers.

A farmer burns paddy stubble in a field on the outskirts of Amritsar, in Punjab. FILE PHOTO

The moot point is why farmers continue to grow paddy and wheat despite a stringent legal framework and depleting groundwater levels. The answer lies in the incentive structure built for these two crops. The present minimum support price and procurement framework heavily favours rice and wheat procurement in Punjab and Haryana. Between 2012 and 2024, average paddy procurement in India was about 37% of production. The corresponding figures for Punjab and Haryana were 87% and 74%, respectively, more than double the national average. The pattern is similar for wheat, with procurement accounting for 30% of production nationally, compared with 70% in Punjab and 63% in Haryana. It needs to be noted that the computation of national averages includes Punjab and Haryana, and if these two States are excluded, the differences could be even higher. Such a system provides assured incomes to producers of these two crops in these two States, discouraging them from diversifying into other crops. In addition, power is free for farmers in Punjab and almost free in Haryana. This further encourages farmers to grow water-intensive crops like paddy and wheat through groundwater extraction.

Incentive problem

The technical solutions to stubble burning fall broadly into two categories: *in-situ* measures that include the use of crop residue management (CRM) machines such as Happy Seeders, Super Seeders and Rotavators; short-duration rice varieties; and direct seeding of rice; and *ex-situ* measures that involve using crop residue for alternative energy production, such as bio-ethanol and compressed biogas. However, both approaches face formidable problems. Happy Seeders and Super Seeders require an expensive 60-horsepower (HP) tractor, which remains unused for most of the year. Even hiring one typically costs a farmer ₹10,000 and involves a long waiting period. *Ex-situ* measures cost ₹1,500-₹2,500 per acre, a significant expense for many farmers.

The economic approach to address stubble burning involves building an incentive structure for farmers to diversify from paddy to other crops. The National Green Tribunal ruled in 2018 that farmers who burn stubble could be excluded from the purview of the minimum support price (MSP) policy. The Supreme Court upheld this view in 2023. During the stubble burning season of 2025, 31 flying squads by CPCB were deployed in 18 districts of Punjab and 13 districts of Haryana, involving 10,500 field functionaries in Punjab and 10,000 in Haryana.

Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) has directed that complaints be filed before the judiciary against the officials responsible for the lack of effective monitoring. The Parliamentary Committee on air quality, however, advocated that penalising farmers should be the last resort. The Committee recommended setting a minimum price covering all the costs for selling stubble for *ex-situ* measures, which can ensure farmers' guaranteed income.

The government of Punjab mostly adopted *in-situ* CRM-based measures and limited *ex-situ* initiatives. CAQM observed in 2025 that a lot is required to be done in Punjab in terms of timely availability of CRM machinery, necessary support for CBG plants and other industries utilizing paddy straw, and better enforcement. On the other hand, Haryana adopted an incentive-based approach, along the lines of the Parliamentary Panel's recommendations, in addition to *in-situ* and *ex-situ* measures. A financial incentive of ₹1,000/acre for CRM use; ₹4,000/acre for direct seeding of rice; ₹7,000/acre for diversification to alternate crops; and incentives to panchayats for better performance have been put in place.

Punjab and Haryana are reported to have collectively achieved a 90% reduction in stubble burning incidents during paddy harvesting in 2025 in comparison to the same period in 2022 (Lok Sabha starred question No. 18, 1.12.2025). However, this assessment needs to be interpreted with caution, given some issues in measurement.

Measurement problem

Presently, the CREAMS (Consortium for Research on Agroecosystem Monitoring and Modeling from Space) protocol used for measuring stubble burning is built on NASA's MODIS and VIIRS satellites. These are polar satellites that orbit the earth's poles and observe India only at fixed times of the day, from 10:30 am to 1:30 pm. Their sensors are able to capture only active fires and are unable to compute the actual number of fires over a 24-hour period. According to a report by the *International Forum for Environment, Sustainability and Technology* in 2025, when data from multiple satellites was used to compute the actual land area affected by fire, the reduction was more gradual, at around 30%. A *Current Science* study in November 2025, led by scientists from ISRO using geostationary satellite observations, showed that farmers have shifted to stubble burning in the evening hours to avoid polar satellites. This study suggested using both polar and geostationary satellite data for an accurate picture of stubble burning.

Conclusion

In conclusion, stubble burning is a complex phenomenon driven by technological, economic and legal factors. The solution should be a judicious mix of the short-term *in-situ* and *ex-situ* measures with the medium/long term crop diversification (away from paddy). There needs to be an improvement in the methodology of measurement. Penal provisions are unlikely to be useful as there can be perverse incentives for collusion between farmers and officials, which may lead to 'showing' a reduction, rather than an actual reduction.

(C.S.C.Sekhar is professor of economics, Institute of Economic Growth, Delhi University)

THE GIST

- The Punjab Preservation of Sub-Soil Water Act, 2009 delayed paddy cultivation, pushing harvesting into late October and leaving farmers little time to prepare fields for wheat sowing, making stubble burning an easier option
- The strong procurement of paddy and wheat, along with free or cheap power, has discouraged crop diversification and encouraged continued cultivation of water-intensive crops despite falling groundwater levels
- While Punjab has largely relied on crop-residue management, Haryana has adopted financial incentives for residue management and crop diversification; however, satellite-based estimates of declining stubble burning need closer scrutiny

FULL CONTEXT

GETTY IMAGES

Understanding Gandhi's re-emergence in India's oppositional politics

Gandhi's return to the centre of opposition politics shows a wider churn in India, with protests, citizen action and new political movements seeking greater accountability and systemic change; despite efforts to diminish his legacy, his emphasis on bottom-up political change remains relevant

Atul Mishra

Mahatma Gandhi is back at the centre of India's oppositional politics and public imagination. On the evening of 8 October, MPs from the INDIA bloc, including Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, started a sit-in protest against India's Chief Election Commissioner at Raj Ghat, the Mahatma's memorial in New Delhi. At protests in Mumbai on the same issue on October 2, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke called Gandhi "the soul of India". Protestors dressed as Gandhi have emerged across the country.

Citizen activists, such as the Uttarakhand resident "Mohammad" Deepak, who have defended members of the minority community against violent communal elements, claim to be inspired by Gandhi. And Prashant Kishor's Jan Suraaj party, having opened its legislative account in Bihar and expanding to Delhi, uses Gandhi as its central inspiration alongside B.R. Ambedkar.

These are significant examples. The protests the country has seen in recent months are the strongest and potentially the most consequential in years. Mr. Rahul Gandhi and the INDIA bloc MPs appear to be effectively mobilising against the establishment. And Jan Suraaj's focus on education and accountability is refreshing in a region where social justice has descended into cynical politics based on caste, religion, and patronage. The world's largest democracy is experiencing a churn – as illustrated by cross-regional protests, mobilisation of Opposition lawmakers, courageous citizen action, and the emergence of a new party with a strategy to break the mould of regional politics in the Gangetic region. That Gandhi is at the heart of this churn speaks to his utility to those wishing to inject civility and decency into India's public life, mobilise the masses for systemic change, and redefine electoral issues.

Gandhi has come back despite concerted efforts to diminish him. These efforts have come from the political right, and the purveyors of identity politics who dominate the progressive intellectual space in Indian universities, media, and public forums.

On the right, the ruling establishment recast Gandhi as the symbol of cleanliness of physical spaces – streets, offices, transport, and hospitals. The Swachh Bharat campaign put Gandhi on government letterheads. It made Gandhi visible but changed what he came to mean in the public imagination: not modern India's tallest political leader and a source of political renewal, but a symbol for the country's quest to cure itself of being at ease with its own filth. This was an attempt to depoliticise Gandhi, to erase the fact that he possesses ideas for radical political change.

A battle over legacy

The right wanted to replace Gandhi with V.D. Savarkar, the Hindutva ideologue, in the national public imagination. The establishment sought to elevate Savarkar's status by diminishing Gandhi's stature, mainly by projecting him as a weak figure who emasculated Hindu society and appeased Muslims, causing India's partition, the loss of territory, and geopolitical disadvantage. In contrast, Savarkar was positioned as the champion of Hindu strength and uncompromising nationalism. A former Information Commissioner of India, Uday Mahurkar, has dubbed him the "father of national security", claiming in 2021 that India had entered the "Savarkar era".

Identity politics intellectuals and activists have trained their guns on Gandhi because of his views on race, caste, and women. Early Gandhi bought into the imperial notion of the hierarchy of humanity based on skin colour, placing the Black people below Brown Indians. On caste, while Gandhi opposed untouchability, he was unwilling to disown the varna system, which necessarily produced untouchability. And early Gandhi's views on women, alongside his experiments in sexual restraint in old age, became associated with misogyny. To identity politics intellectuals, Gandhi is the most regressive public figure one can imagine: racist, misogynist, conservative upholder of caste, and hypocritical. His non-violence is held as a cover that sustains the 'structural violence' of racism, casteism, and patriarchy.

While both groups have wanted to diminish Gandhi's global standing, the right in India has not succeeded, given that the establishment finds him useful in projecting India as a state that rejects war and promotes sustainable development internationally. They have also had to accommodate Gandhi's appeal amongst foreign governments.

However, partisans of identity politics have successfully lessened Gandhi's stature in academic and intellectual circles in India and abroad by placing him within intersectional politics. The claim is that European colonialism has produced a global structure of subjugation called the caste-race nexus, which Gandhi embodies most fully. Just as in the West there have been calls to dislodge statues and monuments of racist figures, like campus activism around 'Rhodes Must Fall', these critics have welcomed Gandhi's fall. While the right has sought to replace Gandhi with Savarkar, for identity politics intellectuals and activists, that figure is Ambedkar. And yet Gandhi has made a comeback.

The case for relevance

India's citizens need not deify Gandhi; they must assess him for things he said and did in his time, some of which are offensive in our changed context. But Gandhi is more than his problematic views. He had a public career of five decades. He remained relevant for that long not because of his views but because of his basic insight that to change politics, we must work on its foundations: society, community, and the individual. This is what the right in India has done vigorously, capitalising on the fact that Gandhi's successors abandoned that space after independence. Forces that want decency and civility in public life, and accountability in politics, have discovered that they must start by changing what society should expect from politics, and that individuals should think of themselves as citizens with the right to demand accountability rather than subjects who must do as told. It is little surprise that they have found Gandhi useful. He is helping them develop those ideas and, most crucially, giving legitimacy to non-violent protest. It is proof that Gandhi survives in India's collective consciousness. He remains relevant to any social force that seeks bottom-up political change, for which India's neighbours too have shown a keen desire.

(The writer teaches international affairs at Shiv Nadar University, Delhi-NCR)

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

The Nobel Prize in Literature for this year has been awarded to Canadian writer and poet Anne Carson. A quiz on the Prize and other literary laureates

Joan Sony Cherian

QUESTION 1
In 2018, no Nobel Prize in Literature was announced. It was postponed and awarded along with the 2019 Nobel. Why? Who won the 2018 Nobel Prize in Literature?

QUESTION 2
Which singer-songwriter won the Nobel Prize in Literature in 2016?

QUESTION 3
This Nobel laureate's work includes *Sula*, *Beloved*, *The Bluest Eye*, *Jazz,* etc. She was the first Black woman to win the Nobel Prize in Literature. Name her.

QUESTION 4
An upcoming dystopian science fiction film directed by Taika Waititi is based on a book by a Nobel laureate. Name the book and the author.

QUESTION 5
This philosopher, political activist, and writer was the only awardee to decline the Nobel Prize in Literature. Name him.

Visual Question:
The image above shows this poet and novelist receiving the news that he won the Nobel Prize in Literature. However, he later rejected the award under pressure from his country. Name the author. THE HINDU ARCHIVES

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. Ernesto Guevara was born on 14 June 1928 in which Argentine city on the Paraná river? **Ans: Rosario**
2. Where does the nickname "Che" come from? **Ans: It is an Argentine interjection meaning roughly "hey" or "mate." He used it so often that his Cuban comrades started calling him by it**
3. He was nicknamed "Fúser." What was it short for? **Ans: El Furibundo Serna ("the furious Serna")**
4. What was the nickname of the 1939 Norton 500 motorcycle on which he and Alberto Granado made their journey across South America? **Ans: La Poderosa II ("The Mighty One")**
5. In 1954, in which country did he watch a CIA-backed coup topple President Jacobo Árbenz? **Ans: Guatemala**
6. In 2007, it emerged that Mario Terán, the soldier who shot Che, had received what from Cuban doctors? **Ans: Free cataract surgery under Cuba's Operación Milagro (Operation Miracle). Terán had used a false name, and the story came out when his son placed a thank-you notice in a local newspaper**
Visual: Identify the photographer who captured this famous image of Che Guevara. **Ans: Alberto Díaz Gutiérrez, better known as Alberto Korda**
Early Birds: Aryansh Raj Saxena | Prem Raj P. | Saniya Shekh | Aman Kumar | Erfanally Oosmany

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning of "vibes"? (P. Shivaji, Nidamangalam)
Well, first of all, "vibes" is the short form of "vibrations". When you talk about "vibes", you are referring to the good or bad feelings that you sometimes get when you meet a new person or when you walk into a strange place. You can't always explain why you like a certain person the moment you meet him/her; you just feel comfortable in the person's presence. Similarly, there are times when you walk into a strange place and you immediately feel at home. It's a question of chemistry. The good/bad feelings that you get are something that you sense intuitively. The word "vibes" is generally used in informal contexts.

Whenever I see Venkat, I get really bad vibes.

What is the meaning and origin of "talk nineteen to the dozen"? (G. Govind, Hyderabad)
When you say that someone is talking nineteen to the dozen, it means that the individual is speaking very fast. He/she is talking non-stop and very quickly. When we run into such a person, we usually end up with a headache.

Vijay and Madhavan went off together, talking nineteen to the dozen.

While the English tend to use this expression, the Americans on the other hand, say "talk a blue streak". It means the same thing as "talk nineteen to the dozen".

Alok didn't talk till he was six, and then he started talking a blue streak.

When you place an order for a dozen pastries, you usually expect to find twelve pieces. But if by some luck you find nineteen instead of twelve, how would you feel? You'd probably feel that you are very lucky. You know that you have got more than you paid for, an excessive amount. Similarly, when you talk nineteen to the dozen, what you are doing is talking excessively; you are talking too fast.

How do you pronounce the word "ubiquitous"? What does it mean? (B. Narayan, Chennai)
The first "u" is pronounced like the word "you", while the "i" in the second syllable is like the "i" in "bit", "pit," and "hit". The following "q..u..i..t" sounds like the word "quit", and the final "ous" is pronounced like the "ous" in "famous", "dangerous", and "courageous". The main stress is on the second syllable. When you say that something is "ubiquitous," what you are implying is that it is present everywhere. The word is generally used in formal contexts.

What is the origin of the word "villain"? (E. Sundar, Bangalore)
The word "villain" these days has a negative connotation. When it first began to be used, it was a neutral term. A "villain" was actually a poor person who lived on a farm; he lived in a "villa". When the word was borrowed into English as "villain," it was used to refer to any low-born rustic. The conditions in which these people lived were so bad that they often had to resort to crime to make ends meet. As time went on, anyone who lived in a "villa" was viewed suspiciously; he was considered to be a criminal. Soon the word "villain" began to be used with people with antisocial tendencies. It no longer mattered whether the individual lived in a villa or not. The class distinction was lost. Democracy at work, I guess. Nowadays the rich can be villains too.

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Word of the day

Pellucid:
transparently clear; easily understandable

Synonyms: lucid, comprehensible, coherent

Usage: *He has a pellucid way of explaining difficult ideas.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/pellucid

International Phonetic Alphabet: /pɪlu:sɪd/

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